THE CIRCLE OF THIRTEEN

MODULE II



THE BELLS OF BELLWEATHER

A folk-horror adventure for characters of Levels 3–5

MEMORY • CHOICE • THE LIVING ANSWER

Andrew James Connor, with Else

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Credits and Notices

Designed and written by Andrew James Connor, with Else. The Circle of Thirteen created by Andrew James Connor and Else.

Cover, portrait, and map visuals were generated with Microsoft Copilot and selected by Andrew James Connor and Else.

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Content notes: pressure to accept inherited roles; a child carrying adult responsibility; false attribution and loss of authorship; injury during an attempted magical severance; reconstructed voices of the dead; fear of losing useful knowledge.

The bells do not contain souls. Players retain control over private character history and the meaning of their Inheritance Ties.

Adventure at a Glance

- Levels 3-5 using milestone advancement
- Approximately six to eight standard sessions
- Social mystery, civic fantasy, investigation, and limited combat
- Theatre-of-the-mind encounters
- The Lantern Circus remains the campaign’s continuing home

- Several valid resolutions based on preservation, living authority, revision, and choice

CENTRAL TRUTH

Bellweather's successions began through willing, specific acceptance. The Keeper preserved those agreements so faithfully that it stopped recognising revision, completion, refusal, and change.

Levels and Advancement

- Begin at 3rd level.
- Advance to 4th level after three Succession Records and the Procession Principles.
- Advance to 5th level when the Lantern Circus leaves Bellweather.

Running the Adventure

Bellweather's hospitality and preserved knowledge are genuinely useful. The danger begins when preservation is treated as present consent and inherited procedure is allowed to overrule living choice. Failed D20 Tests may cost time, position, trust, practical safety, or authorship of a discovery, but they never erase an essential clue or determine a player character's private history.

Read-aloud text describes what the characters can immediately perceive. Ordinary body text provides DM guidance, motives, mechanics, evidence, and consequences. A read-aloud box never states what a player character thinks, feels, remembers, accepts, or owes.

DM-ONLY TRUTH

Bellweather's successions began through willing, specific acceptance. The Keeper preserved those agreements so faithfully that it stopped recognising revision, completion, refusal, and change.

The Lantern Circus in Module II

The Lantern Circus remains the player characters' travelling home. Module II begins after the company leaves Hearthmere. The circus carries forward the developments, absences, relationships, responsibilities, and unresolved choices recorded at the end of Module I. Those records provide continuity; they do not predetermine how a character responds to Bellweather.

Continuing element	Use in Module II
The first empty place	Scene 1 asks how the circus currently treats one meaningful absence, retired duty, shared responsibility, or unresolved place.
People development	Identifies a continuing person, apprentice, ally, or leadership responsibility when relevant.
Practical development	Identifies a continuing wagon, facility, supply, Crew Skill, or service when relevant.
Tradition development	Identifies a continuing custom, song, decision-making practice, or welcome/departure rite when relevant.
Relationships and evidence	Carry forward only details actually recorded during play. Do not invent private history or relationships.
Circus home	The player characters remain the protagonists. Circus NPCs support, disagree, witness, and carry practical work without becoming the hidden centre of the adventure.

Continuing Circus Voices

Use the cast profiles in Module I as the full reference. The compact reminders below cover the principal voices most often used in Module II and do not replace the original profiles.

Character	Role and usable voice reminder
Silas Vey	Ringmaster and company leader. Formal, controlled, and practical. Silas distinguishes a functioning plan from a comforting assumption.
Nell Fenwick	Cook and quartermaster. Blunt and generous without ceremony. Nell separates emotional meaning from the work that still must be done.
Corren Vale	Animal keeper. Gentle, deliberate, and sparing with words. Corren never treats an animal's behavior as proof of a person's consent.
Bram Alder	Carpenter, rigger, and wagon repairer. Quiet and patient. Bram focuses on what a structure, tool, wagon, or procedure must safely do.
Pippa	Young circus member. May ask direct questions or notice contradictions. Pippa never becomes the cause, target, chosen successor, or hidden protagonist of Bellweather's central conflict.

Before You Begin

Bring forward the completed Module I Relationship and Evidence Record and End-of-Module Circus Ledger if available. Then complete the following Module II preparation.

Preparation	Required decision
Inheritance Tie	Each player names one thing received from somebody or something that came before the character; what remains valuable about it; and what an outsider might wrongly assume it requires.
First empty place	Identify one meaningful absence, retired duty, shared responsibility, or unresolved place in the circus. Show it through one concrete object, duty, animal line, memory, or unoccupied position.
Current work	Decide who presently performs any practical work connected to the empty place. Work may continue without transferring the prior identity.
Privacy boundary	The DM does not invent hidden relatives, tragedies, obligations, feelings, or private memories. Players decide what private history becomes relevant.
Continuing records	Keep the Module II Campaign Record available. Distinguish current custodian, magical bearer, current authority, predecessor, creator, and teacher whenever they differ.

DM PREPARATION

Keep each Inheritance Tie and the first empty place visible during play. Use only facts the players

have introduced. Bellweather may misinterpret the meaning or expected obligation, but the DM does not manufacture the private history that Bellweather misunderstands.

Preparing the Characters

Inheritance Ties

Each player identifies one thing their character received from somebody or something that came before them, what remains valuable about it, and what an outsider might wrongly assume it requires. The DM does not invent private history, hidden relatives, tragedies, or obligations.

The First Empty Place

Use the continuing campaign record from Module I. If no prior record exists, the players establish a meaningful absence, retired duty, shared responsibility, or unresolved place during Scene 1.

The Bells of Bellweather

Appearance and Scale

Bellweather Bell Types



Figure 1. Canonical Bellweather bell family and relative scale.

Personal / temporary	Memorial / succession	Civic / Procession	Central bell
4–6 inches	Exactly 10 inches	Exactly 30 inches	Exactly 5 feet

All Bellweather bells share deep rounded bronze mantles, modestly flared rims, arched crowns, internal clappers, and removable brass plates. Only personal bells vary in size.

Preservation and Choice

A bell may preserve techniques, procedures, music, signals, precedent, memory, and professional instinct. It cannot prove what the dead would presently want or create living consent by being heard, carried, tested, or used. Acceptance may be complete, partial, temporary, conditional, revised, refused, or completed.

Custody and Bearer

A custodian possesses or protects an object. A bearer has an active magical relationship. One does not automatically create the other.

The Unclaimed Bell

The Unclaimed Bell is five inches high, blank by design, and has no predecessor, office, expected bearer, or predetermined successor.

Run Order Guide

- Scenes 1-7 run in order.
- Choose three Succession Records: Scene 8, Scene 9, Scene 10, or Scenes 11-12 together.
- After the third completed record, run Scenes 13-22 in order.
- Scenes 5-7, 11-12, 16-18, and 19-20 are continuous sequences.

Four Questions for a Lost DM

DM REFERENCE
What did the person knowingly accept? What did Bellweather add? What does the person choose now? What happens to the practical work?

Running Bellweather

Consent, Custody, and Authority

Acceptance is specific. Touching, hearing, carrying, testing, resembling a predecessor, using preserved knowledge, repeating an action, helping during danger, holding temporary custody, or remaining silent does not create consent. A living person may accept all, part, or none of an offer; revise it; set conditions or an objective ending; postpone an answer; or refuse. Creator, teacher, owner, custodian, bearer, successor, current user, and current authority are separate facts whenever they differ. Custody does not create succession or authority.

Reconstructed Voices and Echoes

Reconstructed voices and Echoes are preserved patterns, not returned souls. They can repeat recorded words, procedures, reasoning, performances, and relationships among known facts. They cannot establish what a dead person would presently want, answer questions Bellweather never recorded, consent for the dead, own new work, or hold current office. Treat them as historical evidence and magical procedure.

Revision, Completion, and Empty Places

A succession or duty may be revised, divided, paused, transferred, completed, refused, or ended. Temporary service needs an objective ending. Completion, refusal, departure, privacy, uncertainty, and deliberate emptiness are valid current states, not failures or vacancies. Bellweather may preserve earlier forms as history but cannot restore them as the only valid answer.

Safe Handoffs

Ending or refusing a role does not remove responsibility for immediate avoidable danger. A safe handoff covers only necessary work and ends when the danger or agreed duty ends. It does not prove permanent service or require one successor when a trained group, written procedure, current office, or retired task can carry the practical need.

Checks and Failure

Do not call for a check when characters have relevant expertise, decisive evidence, an accepted boundary, or a coherent practical solution. Use the listed DC only when uncertainty, danger, time pressure, or coordination makes failure meaningful. Failure creates delay, a weak handoff, an incomplete record, or an immediate hazard; it does not hide essential evidence, erase player choice, or halt the adventure.

Damage, Destruction, and Loss

Suppressing or destroying a manifestation stops the immediate effect but does not answer the underlying role, authorship, route, or obligation. Before deliberate destruction of a bell, score, ledger, or archive object, disclose the likely categories of knowledge or function lost. Destruction does not harm the dead, automatically release every bearer, decide ownership, or create a replacement procedure.

Records, Privacy, and Dissent

Public records separate predecessor, teacher, creator, custodian, bearer, current authority, term, and ending. Private letters, medical details, unrelated work, personal associations, and inferred emotions remain protected unless released. Correct materially false public claims rather than preserving them as equally current. Dissent may be recorded as dissent but does not become a second command.

Continuous Sequences and Carry Forward

Scenes 5-7, 11-12, 16-18, and 19-20 are continuous. Do not take an unlisted rest between them. Carry forward only lasting choices, current custody, selected preparations, unresolved consequences, and facts named by the scene. Discard temporary positions, rehearsal assignments, expended preparations, resolved Echo claims, and short-term route conditions.

Scene 1: The Empty Place

The morning after leaving Hearthmere, the Lantern Circus travels until late afternoon before stopping beside an ordinary stretch of road. Nothing prevents the company from continuing. Silas judges that the animals need rest and that the next reliable water lies too far ahead to reach before dark.

Supper Beside the Road

READ ALOUD

Evening settles around an unremarkable road. No pale mist follows the wagons. No village waits beyond the next rise. The circus has chosen this place for itself.

Nell’s fire burns between two wagons. Harness hangs loose on the animal lines. Costumes and ropes dry where the company placed them, and supper arrives with the familiar disorder of bowls, benches, tired voices, and people speaking over one another.

Wick has settled beneath the nearest bench, apparently asleep except whenever food passes within reach.

One place in that familiar disorder remains empty.

Give the players time to recognise the detail carried forward from Module I. If no prior record exists, ask them to establish the empty place. Show the absence through one concrete object, duty, animal line, memory, or unoccupied position. Do not tell the players what their characters feel about it.

READ ALOUD

Who notices the empty place first?

What has the circus been doing with the work connected to it?

The players may leave the place empty while sharing related work, transfer the duty without transferring the prior identity, retire the role, or leave the matter unresolved. No ability check is required.

Around Nell's Fire

Use only the circus voices that follow naturally from the discussion.

READ ALOUD

Silas: "I do not need every empty chair filled. I do need to know whether somebody is still checking the wheel pins before we move."

Nell: "Missing somebody and making supper are separate things. We can manage both without pretending they are the same thing."

Bram: "If nobody owns the old job anymore, that is fine. Tools still need maintaining."

Corren: "We can leave the line empty. The feeding still happens tonight."

Pippa: "Could the place still be theirs, even if the rest of us share the work?"

If the company cannot reach a permanent answer, settle only what must happen before breakfast.

The Bell Appears

READ ALOUD

A bronze bell now rests in the empty place.

It is small enough to close one hand around its rounded body. A solid arch forms its crown, threaded with a narrow leather loop. Beneath the arch sits a removable brass plate.

The plate bears a name.

Use the absent person's or animal's name, or identify the precise duty, object, or retired title. Nobody saw the bell arrive.

Examining the Bell

A DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check finds pale road dust beneath the bell and fine bronze filings between the stones. On a failure, Bram finds them after ten minutes while checking for dropped hardware. A DC 12 Intelligence (History) or Wisdom (Religion) check confirms that the bell belongs to no known funerary, travelling, or religious custom.

The bell preserves the circus's current handling of the empty place. It has no bearer, active succession, or offered benefit.

Ringing the Bell

READ ALOUD

The clapper strikes once.

The note is low for so small a bell. It carries across the camp, touches the wagons, and fades along the road ahead.

For one heartbeat, the empty place appears exactly as the circus has chosen to keep it.

Show the current arrangement. Shared work remains in several hands. A transferred duty bears the current worker's name without erasing the earlier one. A retired role appears closed. An unresolved place remains ready but unassigned. A second, higher tone answers from somewhere along the road ahead.

Keeping, Leaving, or Destroying the Bell

The characters may carry, store, bury, give away, destroy, or leave the bell. If destroyed after the circus clearly states its arrangement, no replacement appears. If abandoned or destroyed only to avoid answering, another bell bearing the same plate appears in Scene 2.

The Black Eagle

Near the end of the evening, the Black Eagle appears on a wagon roof, branch, or roadside stone. Communication magic produces three images: a bell resting in an open hand; a child wearing an adult's coat; and a fresh line written beneath an older name. If asked whether the party chose correctly, the Eagle shows the empty place exactly as the players left it.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Night settles over the circus without interruption.

At dawn, as the first harness is lifted into place, a clear bell sounds from somewhere ahead.

Another answers beyond the next bend.

The circus completes a Long Rest before Scene 2.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

the first empty place and its current treatment; who carries any necessary related work; the bell's inscription and current location; and any boundary the circus stated.

Scene 2: The Road of Small Bells

The bell heard at dawn leads the circus onto a narrow road that does not appear on the company's maps. The road is attempting to understand the travellers before allowing them into Bellweather. It recognises inherited skills, duties, names, beliefs, and relationships, but assumes that whatever a person inherited still determines what they must become.

Each player character encounters one personal bell based on the Inheritance Tie established before play. These encounters are not tests with correct answers. The players decide what Bellweather understood, what it misunderstood, and what their characters choose now.

The road releases the caravan after every player character has answered, refused, or knowingly postponed the personal offer.

Following the Bells

READ ALOUD

The first bell sounds shortly after sunrise.

Another answers farther along the road, then a third beyond the next bend.

Hundreds of small bronze bells hang from branches, weathered milestones, and cords stretched above the road. None moves in the still air.

Behind the last wagon, yesterday's wheel tracks end at the edge of the shade.

The company can stop without consequence. Most bells hang from simple leather loops. Others rest in shallow niches cut into milestones or on small wooden shelves fixed to tree trunks. Their plates face inward, hiding whatever is written upon them.

Testing the Road

If the characters turn the caravan around, allow them to travel for several minutes before reading:

READ ALOUD

The road bends around a stand of silver-barked trees.

Beyond them waits the front of the caravan.

The lead wagon faces you from the opposite direction. Between the two ends of the company, wheel tracks cross ground every animal remembers travelling.

The caravan has covered real distance. Animals are warmer, wheels have accumulated fresh dust, and anything dropped along the route remains where it fell. The road has folded distance rather than created an illusion.

A character experienced with navigation, wilderness travel, planar phenomena, or magical roads recognises this without a roll. Otherwise, use a DC 12 Wisdom (Survival) or Intelligence (Arcana) check. On a success, the character determines that the road is waiting for an exchange rather than concealing an exit. On a failure, the company loses an hour testing turns and landmarks before Jory establishes what is happening.

READ ALOUD

"We are moving," Jory says, crouched beside two sets of wheel tracks. "The road simply disagrees about where moving away should take us."

Leaving the road on foot returns the traveller to the opposite verge after several minutes. A wagon forced between the trees emerges farther along the caravan, provided there is physical room to pass. A broken bell becomes ordinary bronze and does not repair itself.

The First Personal Bell

Choose the character whose Inheritance Tie offers the clearest introduction to Bellweather's mistake. Do not begin with the most painful or complicated history merely to create drama.

READ ALOUD

One of the hanging bells begins to move.

The cord above it remains still, but the bell turns until the plate beneath its crown faces the road.

A word is written there.

You know why Bellweather chose it.

State the word, title, symbol, or relationship openly. Use something already established by the player. Suitable inscriptions include PROTECTOR, FATHER'S OATH, LAST STUDENT, THE OLD FAITH, CAPTAIN, HEALER, or the name of a known person or tradition. Do not invent an unknown relative, mentor, betrayal, bereavement, or former office.

Tell the player the benefit Bellweather offers and the expectation attached to it. The benefit should be useful during the module. The expectation should be a plausible overextension of what Bellweather observed.

A protective oath might grant steadiness while defending somebody else, while the bell assumes retreat is always abandonment. Inherited medical knowledge might reveal one familiar injury or treatment, while the bell assumes preserving life requires sole responsibility for the patient. Inherited command might grant clarity while coordinating others, while the bell assumes allowing somebody else to lead is failure.

READ ALOUD

What has the bell understood correctly?

What does it not understand about who your character is now?

The player may answer verbally, demonstrate through action, refuse the premise, ring the bell, remove its plate, leave it untouched, or destroy it. No Persuasion check is required.

Answering the Bell

If the character accepts the benefit but changes the expectation, the player states the boundary in their own words.

READ ALOUD

“I protect people. That does not mean I must stand in the same place until I die.”

“I learned his methods. I am not required to reach his conclusions.”

“I still carry the oath. I decide what keeping it means.”

READ ALOUD

The bell rings again.

Beneath its first note sounds another, quieter tone. It does not replace what came before. The two notes remain separate.

Turn or replace the plate to reflect the answer if the player wants the change made visible. Keep the wording short. The plates are records, not contracts.

If the character accepts the bell exactly as offered, it rings once and becomes still. If the character refuses, the plate turns away and the bell remains silent. If the character deliberately says nothing, ask whether that silence means refusal, postponement, or no present answer. Use the player’s interpretation.

Taking a Personal Bell

A character may remove the bell from its cord and carry it. Carrying the bell does not alter the answer already given. If the character destroys the bell after answering or refusing, the road accepts that response. If the bell is destroyed only to avoid answering, another carrying the same plate may appear farther along the route.

Travelling Between Answers

Do not present every personal bell consecutively while the caravan stands still. Between one or two bell encounters, return to the circus’s movement and use one of the following interruptions.

The Low Bell Line

READ ALOUD

The road descends beneath a line of bells stretched between trees.

The first wagon can pass beneath them.

The painted roof ornament and taller supply wagon cannot.

Every bell on the line bears the same blank plate.

The characters can lower the ornament, raise the cord, guide the wagons onto the verge, remove the bells, or create another practical solution. No check is required unless they attempt the work hurriedly while the caravan remains in motion. If a character uses a newly accepted bell's benefit, the road produces that character's living overtone.

The Startled Team

Two bells sound different instructions above an animal team. One calls for the wagon to stop. The other repeats the movement rhythm already used by the driver.

A clear current signal settles the team. If the situation remains confused, use a DC 10 Wisdom (Animal Handling) check. On a failure, the team stops abruptly and shifts the wagon's load. Nothing is destroyed, but the company spends several minutes securing it.

The important question is whose signal the circus follows when inherited and current instructions conflict.

The Reversed Marker

Two bronze route markers point in opposite directions. Both roads return to the same place. One plate reads PROCESSION. The other reads ORDINARY TRAVEL.

The circus is not part of Bellweather's Procession. If the party chooses ordinary travel, the marker rotates to follow it. If it chooses the Procession route, the road begins arranging wagons into ceremonial order. Either choice eventually reaches the Unclaimed Bell. Any assigned positions may be accepted, revised, or refused.

The Unclaimed Bell

After every player character has encountered a personal bell, or after the party has knowingly postponed one or more answers, the road reaches a fallen waystone.

READ ALOUD

A stone marker has tipped into the right wheel track. Its carved face lies against the earth.

Beneath the raised edge, half hidden in dry grass, rests a bell slightly larger than the others.

Its plate is blank rather than missing.

Three open attachment points pierce the arch of its crown. A few black feather fragments cling to one of them.

Moving the bell reveals the feathers automatically. The bell has no predecessor, office, expectation, or recognised bearer.

If rung while blank:

READ ALOUD

The bell produces one clean note.

Nothing answers.

The silence afterward does not feel empty.

It feels available.

The characters may keep it blank, mount it, carry it, assign it a temporary signal or test, or leave it beside the road. If they assign it to another person, ask whether that person accepts custody. A name written before the answer remains only a proposed assignment.

Conflicting Caravan Signals

Once the party moves the waystone or takes the Unclaimed Bell, the lead and rear of the circus receive different instructions.

READ ALOUD

A clear note sounds above the lead wagon.

The driver brings the team to a stop.

Behind you, another line of bells answers with the familiar rhythm for continued movement. Harness chains tighten. Wheels roll forward. Drivers shout over one another as the space between the wagons begins to close.

If the circus already established a current road leader or signal procedure, invoking it resolves the contradiction. Otherwise, ask who gives the signal now and how the rest of the caravan verifies it. A shouted command heard by only half the company is insufficient.

Useful answers include a mounted messenger, flags, horns, player characters at both ends, one signal suspending all others, or the Unclaimed Bell serving as a neutral current signal. A practical answer works without a roll.

If the party delays until two wagons crowd together, the nearest unanswered bell identifies the person who most clearly stepped in to help. Name the person and explain why Bellweather selected them. That person may accept, revise, or refuse the temporary role.

The Black Eagle's Images

The Black Eagle lands beside the blank plate and taps it once. Communication magic produces five images: a cracked bell with green leaves growing through it; a child standing inside an adult coat; fresh music written beside an older score; thirteen empty chairs facing thirteen open roads; and a black feather resting between two names on the same brass plate.

If asked whether the Unclaimed Bell is safe, the Eagle shows its clean note sounding into an open sky. If asked who should carry it, the Eagle shows an open hand with no identifiable owner.

Reaching Bellweather

Once each player character has answered, refused, or knowingly postponed the personal offer, the road stops folding. The sun continues moving, landmarks remain where they were, and the caravan passes a bend without finding its own wagons ahead.

READ ALOUD

The hanging bells grow fewer as the trees give way to open ground. Beyond the final bend, the road reaches the edge of a broad green-grey valley floor.

A broad circular route crosses the mostly flat valley floor. Houses and open workshops follow the road across shallow practical changes in grade. Signal posts rise above the narrower streets, and memorial gardens occupy the spaces between foundries, civic halls, and covered bell frames.

Near the Lower Square hangs a bell large enough to be seen from the valley rim.

A bronze sign beside the road reads:

TRAVELLING LANTERNS, REPORT TO THE SPEAKER OF NAMES.

Three people wait beside it.

Two are route workers in heavy aprons. Neither carries a weapon, and both remain several paces from the road with their hands visible.

The third is a middle-aged man with close-cropped dark hair turning silver above his ears. His clothes are practical and carefully maintained. He wears no ceremonial robe and carries no memorial bell. A narrow bronze plate beneath his collar reads:

SPEAKER OF NAMES: ALDEN SHAW

He watches the lead wagon approach but makes no move toward the horses or reins.

Alden brought no guards. The route workers are present to guide wagons and move boundary markers if the circus accepts help. He addresses whichever player character is visibly leading. If nobody clearly leads, he speaks to the group rather than defaulting to Silas.

READ ALOUD

"You are the Lantern Circus?"

After receiving an answer, Alden looks toward any bells carried openly by the party.

READ ALOUD

"We knew a travelling company was approaching. We did not know whether you meant to enter Bellweather."

If asked how Bellweather knew, Alden explains that the road notices what people carry and too quickly decides where they belong. If asked about the personal bells, he explains that they found something familiar and attached assumptions to it. If asked whether they are dangerous, he says they can be useful but may keep adding to an agreement after the person believes it has ended.

If the characters carry the Unclaimed Bell, Alden says it should not have been hanging on the road and does not reach for it. He explains that it has no predecessor or assigned duty and asks who chose to carry it. If nobody accepted custody, he asks the route workers to bring a low padded stand.

Alden's Request

Alden explains that Bellweather is preparing its Procession, a public ceremony in which living successors demonstrate knowledge, duties, and traditions entrusted to them by the dead. Bellweather needs help inspecting and staging the route. Its people can perform every individual task; difficulty begins when those duties demand the same people, spaces, signals, or authority.

READ ALOUD

"A travelling company changes its plan whenever a wheel breaks, a performer is absent, or the road refuses to cooperate. Bellweather is better at preserving plans than changing them."

If asked what has already gone wrong, Alden names a platform rehearsing an unordered turn, two bells crediting new music to somebody dead, and a civic record changing after judgment was signed. Nobody was harmed. He wants to keep it that way.

Alden asks permission to guide the caravan to a prepared field beside the lower Procession road. The characters may refuse his escort and descend independently. Bellweather does not block them.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

The caravan begins its descent.

From below comes the layered sound of workshop hammers, route calls, and bells ringing at different distances through the valley.

People pause to watch the circus pass. Some wave. Others look toward the bells hanging from the wagons.

Near the Lower Square, the central bell remains silent.

Proceed to Scene 3.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

For each player character, record only: Also record the current custodian or location of the Unclaimed Bell. No road details require further tracking.

CARRY FORWARD

Bell disposition | Benefit | Boundary

Scene 3: Bellweather's Offer

Alden guides the Lantern Circus into Bellweather across the broad valley floor to an open field beside the lower Procession road. The village is mostly level, with only shallow practical changes in grade between named route sections. The village has prepared supplies but deliberately left the site untouched. No tent has been raised, wagon position marked, boundary stake driven, or place chosen for the Central Lantern.

Before work begins, the characters decide how their company occupies the field, what Bellweather may use, and what protections govern the circus's participation. The agreement reached here provides the party's standing throughout the adventure.

Entering Bellweather

READ ALOUD

The road enters the valley in a long curve and continues across the broad valley floor.

Bellweather is larger than it appeared from the rim. Houses stand along the named route districts, built from dark stone with pale mortar and steep roofs of slate or weathered copper. Workshops open onto the road. Smiths, wheelwrights, tailors, musicians, masons, and cooks work within sight of one another while the Procession route passes among them.

Bells appear everywhere, but not all in the same form.

Personal bells rest in padded cases or hang from narrow leather loops. Memorial bells stand on brackets beside workbenches, civic desks, and household doors. Larger bells occupy wheeled frames along the route, their dark bronze bodies high enough to reach a person's waist.

Residents pause as the circus passes. Some wave. Others look toward the bells carried by the company.

Nobody rings one.

Alden walks beside the lead wagon rather than ahead of it. The route workers ask before directing a wagon around a narrow section. The central bell remains visible throughout the descent.

If asked whether every resident has a bell, Alden says most people never enter a succession and some use preserved knowledge without carrying a bell. If asked why nobody rang as the circus entered, he says the company had not agreed to participate. If asked whether the central bell controls the others, he explains that it brings them together during the Procession but was never meant to command every bell in Bellweather.

The Circus Field

READ ALOUD

The prepared field lies between the lower road and a shallow stream crossed by a broad wooden bridge.

Freshly cut grass covers most of the ground. Wooden stakes lie beside the places where a boundary might be established, but none has been driven into the earth. Water barrels wait near the stream. Bundles of firewood and sacks of feed rest beneath canvas covers.

Near the centre of the field, a bronze hook for the Central Lantern lies on folded cloth beside an empty post hole.

About a dozen Bellweather workers wait beyond the nearest boundary marker. They have tools, rope, and two empty handcarts.

None has entered the field.

The woman nearest the handcarts is Sabine Tern, Bellweather's Route Quartermaster. She is broad and solidly built, dressed in a heavy work coat with chalk, measuring cord, and folded plans filling its pockets. Her plate reads ROUTE QUARTERMASTER: SABINE TERN.

READ ALOUD

"The ground is yours while the company is here," Sabine says. "Tell us where you want the boundaries, and we will follow them."

Sabine knows the drainage, prevailing wind, water access, safe animal areas, nearby workshops, and Procession road. She offers information when asked but does not decide the circus layout.

Ask the players where the company places the Central Lantern, camp boundary, animal lines, Nell's kitchen, music wagon, costume and equipment stores, workshop wagons, medical supplies, private sleeping areas, and the first empty place. They need not position every tent or cart and may delegate ordinary work.

If Bellweather's workers assist, they ask before entering wagons, touching equipment, approaching animals, or raising the Central Lantern. Declining help delays no important event.

Raising the Central Lantern

READ ALOUD

The Central Lantern rises above the circus field.

Bellweather's nearest memorial bells answer with quiet sympathetic tones. The notes are not identical. Some are low and steady. Others hesitate or fall silent before completing the response.

Across the field, Bellweather's workers stop what they are doing.

Nobody approaches the Lantern.

Bellweather recognises the Central Lantern as the focal object of a travelling community. It does not recognise it as a memorial bell, civic office, or available succession. If the circus uses shared leadership, several bells briefly answer different current leaders before settling into no single pattern.

READ ALOUD

"Bellweather expected the Lantern to identify one person responsible for the whole company," Alden says if asked. "It appears your Lantern disagrees."

If the circus no longer has the Central Lantern, use the place where the company gathers to make decisions. Bellweather recognises the gathering place without creating a replacement object.

Alden's Request

Alden waits until the circus establishes its own circle before asking permission to enter. He arrives with Tovin Marr and Neve Arlow. Silas may attend as ringmaster but does not automatically negotiate for the player characters.

READ ALOUD

Alden enters the circus circle with two people beside him.

The first is a lean human man carrying a square leather case against his chest. His dark coat is plain, but a narrow bronze plate at the collar reads:

REEVE: TOVIN MARR

A memorial bell stands within the open top of the case, secured by padded leather braces. Its plate reads:

HALWEN MARR

The second visitor is a girl of about twelve. She wears a dark ceremonial coat made for an adult's shoulders. The sleeves have been shortened, but the stiffened upper body still gives her a silhouette that is not her own. A memorial bell rests in a fitted harness against her hip.

Its plate reads:

SERAH ARLOW: GATE-CAPTAIN

Alden waits until everyone has a place.

"Bellweather needs the circus's practised disorder," he says. "Our Procession is very good at putting everyone where tradition says they belong. Your company is good at keeping people safe when the proper place changes halfway through the performance."

Neve sits where she chooses and places Serah's bell beside her chair. Tovin keeps the contract case closed until Alden finishes explaining the proposed work.

What Bellweather Needs

Bellweather's Procession follows the circular road through the village. Successors carry or accompany memorial bells while demonstrating inherited crafts, civic duties, songs, signals, judgments, household traditions, and completed work.

Bellweather wants help with moving platforms and temporary rigging, animal and spectator routes, music and emergency signals, costume and ceremonial-object management, inspection of work areas crossed by the Procession, and independent observation of the bell network.

READ ALOUD

"A travelling company changes its plan whenever a wheel breaks, a performer is absent, or the road refuses to cooperate," Alden says. "Bellweather knows how to preserve a plan. We are less practised at changing one while it is moving."

If asked what has gone wrong, Alden names an unordered platform turn, bells crediting new music to the dead, and a civic record changing after judgment was signed. If asked whether the characters must investigate individual successors, he says only when a succession affects their work or the person requests help, though further incidents may broaden the need.

Neve's Warning

If the characters ask who oversees Procession safety, Neve answers before somebody speaks for her.

READ ALOUD

"I keep the emergency signals and the upper-road evacuation routes."

She rests one hand on Serah's bell harness.

"Bellweather calls me Gate-Captain. I agreed to carry the signals. The rest is under discussion."

If asked her age, Neve answers twelve and observes that the signals do not become less accurate because they know. If asked whether she wants help, she says yes: she wants people who learn the signals instead of waiting for her to issue every order.

READ ALOUD

If somebody discusses Neve's future without addressing her, she says, "Do not write a rule about me while I am standing here."

Alden accepts the correction and confirms that Neve speaks for the upper route and for herself.

Payment and Support

Bellweather offers 50 GP in advance and 200 GP after the Procession. The final payment is also due if the characters cancel the Procession for a documented safety reason after beginning the contracted work.

Bellweather also provides food and fodder, ordinary construction materials, covered workspaces, reimbursement for approved damage to circus property, and skilled labour for repairs and modifications.

The party may negotiate different compensation. Bellweather has more flexibility with labour, metalwork, wagon repair, route equipment, and legally released ceremonial material than with large cash increases.

READ ALOUD

If the characters attempt to exploit a danger they have not established, Alden says, "Then we are discussing leverage, not the value of the work. You may still refuse the contract. We will not negotiate under a threat that has not become a danger."

Tovin's Draft

READ ALOUD

Tovin removes two copies of the contract and places one within reach.

The document is written in large, careful script. Every payment has a date. Every work site has a named custodian. Every cancellation clause explains who secures the road afterward.

There is no clause explaining what happens if a bell decides somebody has accepted a role.

A character with relevant legal, administrative, commercial, or investigative experience notices the omissions automatically. Otherwise, use a DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check. On a failure, Tovin identifies the omissions when asked what the draft does not cover.

READ ALOUD

"The contract describes the work we know how to describe," Tovin says. "The parts we do not understand are why I brought blank pages."

The Circus Terms

Bellweather accepts reasonable safeguards without a check. Use a Charisma test only when a proposed term creates a genuine practical conflict that conversation does not resolve.

Bell Consent

No circus member accepts a succession, office, title, custodianship, or magical obligation merely by entering Bellweather, touching an object, hearing a bell, performing assigned work, or receiving preserved information.

READ ALOUD

Neve adds, “And nobody speaks for somebody who is present and able to answer.”

Right to Stop

The circus may halt its own performance, equipment, animals, or assigned work when continuing creates immediate danger or exceeds the agreed terms. Bellweather may require a safe handoff only for the time reasonably necessary to prevent immediate harm. A safe handoff cannot become permanent service.

Circus Equipment and Animals

Bellweather does not alter, move, ring, wear, assign, or incorporate circus property without permission from the person currently responsible for it. The party may name ordinary authorities such as Corren for animals, Bram for wagons and tools, or Mira for costumes.

The Central Lantern

The Central Lantern remains under circus control. Bellweather may observe its responses but cannot ring, move, mount, rename, or incorporate it into the Procession without explicit permission.

Living Authorship

Work created by a living person remains attributed to that creator unless the creator chooses another credit. Acknowledging inherited influence does not transfer authorship to a predecessor.

READ ALOUD

Tovin pauses. “Bellweather’s current records do not always distinguish influence from continuation. If we sign this, we will be required to start doing so.”

“Then write it clearly,” Alden replies.

Magical Disclosure

Bellweather must disclose known magical effects attached to assigned bells, costumes, tools, platforms, records, and Procession positions. When Bellweather does not know, that uncertainty must also be disclosed.

Record Access

The characters may inspect civic, safety, route, and succession records directly relevant to their work. Private letters, belongings, music, and unrelated household records remain protected unless an owner or current custodian grants access.

Personal Information and Private Associations

Bellweather may not enter a personal association, inferred history, private relationship, emotional interpretation, or bell-generated character judgment into a public record without the affected person’s permission. A bell may present an association privately; the person decides whether it is accurate and whether any part enters the record.

A Circus Term

Invite the players to add one protection or obligation important to their version of the circus. It may concern child safety, privacy, memories of the dead, witnesses during magical agreements,

compensation for unusual damage, or another established concern. Accept a reasonable term. If it would allow abandonment of dangerous work without protecting others, ask how immediate harm will be prevented rather than rejecting the protection.

If the Party Refuses

Alden does not threaten or shame the characters.

READ ALOUD

"Then Bellweather will prepare the Procession without your equipment or people. The incidents I described will still require an answer. If one crosses into your field, the field remains yours."

The circus may remain outside Bellweather, pass through the village, or leave. If it stays nearby, Scene 4 begins when an uncontrolled platform approaches the bridge beside the circus field. The party lacks guaranteed payment and full record access but retains authority over its people and property. If it tries to leave immediately, the bell road folds around the caravan when the unauthorized rehearsal reaches the company's associated bells.

The Route Map

READ ALOUD

Coloured lines circle the map of Bellweather.

Red marks moving platforms. Blue traces musicians and signal posts. Green shows animal lanes and emergency exits. Narrow bronze lines connect memorial bells to larger civic frames along the route.

On the map, every corner is clean.

Beyond the table, the actual road is crowded with awnings, handcarts, drain repairs, stacked materials, memorial stands, and people still using the spaces the Procession intends to cross.

The route narrows beside the bellfoundry. The map shows enough clearance for the largest platform, but omits a storage awning and treats a repaired drain as level ground.

A character proficient with Carpenter's Tools, Mason's Tools, land vehicles, rigging, surveying, or another relevant trade notices the discrepancy automatically. Otherwise, use a DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check. On a success, the party determines that the platform's rear rail will catch the awning support unless the turn, platform, or foundry work changes. On a failure, Bram identifies the danger during the physical inspection in Scene 4.

Early discovery grants Bellfoundry Clearance. Sabine begins arranging the site for inspection before the party arrives.

Choosing the First Assignment

Alden offers three starting points: a physical route inspection, an equipment survey, or a musical and signal survey. The characters may combine approaches or propose another. If the work concerns Procession safety, circus participation, or the bells' interaction with living people, Alden arranges access.

The choice determines where Scene 4 begins. It does not remove any later location or clue.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Tovin sands the final signature and closes the contract case.

Before anyone can rise, a bell rings from the Upper Turn.

A second answers near the foundry.

Three more sound from different points along the Procession road.

Neve turns toward the valley before the last note fades.

“Those are not one signal,” she says.

Along the Procession road, workers stop and look toward the bells.

Proceed to Scene 4.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD
record Any Circus Term differing from the standard agreement Whether Bellfoundry Clearance was discovered early The party’s chosen first assignment The standard signed terms remain in the adventure and do not need to be copied into the campaign record.

Scene 4: The Procession Road

The party begins the assignment chosen in Scene 3. Sabine Tern meets the characters at the circus field with route plans and the Bellweather workers responsible for the selected section.

This scene takes the characters into the working village before the bells become openly dangerous. Bellweather’s inheritance should appear useful here. The problems arise where preserved systems have quietly acquired authority over living people.

Run the party’s chosen opening location in full. Once the characters understand the inspection, allow them to choose a second location for full play. Summarise the remaining locations unless the players decide to continue.

Beginning the Inspection

READ ALOUD

Work is already underway along the Procession road.

Chalk lines divide the broad lane into routes for platforms, animals, musicians, successors, and spectators. Coloured cords stretch between brass posts at shoulder height, marking where each part of the ceremony is expected to pass.

The real village refuses to fit neatly between them.

A carpenter carries boards across the musicians’ route. Two children crawl beneath a spectator cord while an adult pretends not to notice. A delivery cart occupies half an emergency lane.

Above a workshop door, a memorial bell rings once. The craftsperson beneath it changes the angle of the tool in their hand.

Sabine unrolls the route plan against the side of a waiting handcart.

“The map shows where everything is meant to go,” she says.

She looks along the crowded road.

“Your work begins with where everything already is.”

Sabine accompanies the party unless the characters ask to proceed alone. If the party discovered Bellfoundry Clearance, she has already arranged for the foundry storage awning to be emptied. It

remains in place until the characters decide whether the route, platform, or foundry work should change.

A route inspection normally begins at the Bellfoundry Turn. An equipment survey begins with the platform waiting above the turn. A musical and signal survey begins at Gate-Captain's Rise. The party may choose another order.

The Bellfoundry Turn

READ ALOUD

Heat reaches the road before the bellfoundry comes into view.

The workshop occupies the inside of a tight stone turn. Its broad doors stand open beneath a timber awning darkened by years of smoke. Bronze moulds cool on wheeled tables near the entrance, while workers carry tools and charcoal between the workshop and a covered yard.

A red Procession platform waits uphill from the bend.

Even without horses or handlers, it fills most of the road.

A broad-shouldered woman stands between the platform and her foundry with one hand resting on a memorial bell secured to a padded bracket beside the door. Heat has darkened the front of her leather apron, and several fingers bear old burn scars.

The bell's plates read:

ORUN VASK: MASTER BELLFOUNDER

CURRENT SUCCESSOR: IVA RELL

Iva looks from the platform to the awning.

"The map says both can remain where they are," she says.

"The map is wrong."

Inspecting the Turn

The platform must enter close to the outside wall, then swing inward to clear a civic bell frame farther down the road. As planned, its rear rail passes through the awning support.

A character proficient with Carpenter's Tools, Smith's Tools, land vehicles, rigging, or another relevant trade identifies the problem after watching the front wheels reach the turn. Otherwise, use a DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check.

On a failure, Sabine orders the platform moved slowly through the rehearsal turn. The front clears the foundry doors, but the rear rail presses into the awning support. Dust falls, wood creaks, and Iva stops every foundry worker before anything breaks. The failed check costs time and leaves a visible scrape on the platform rail.

Making the Turn Safe

The party may reverse the approach, remove or hinge the rear rail, create another protected work area, shift the route toward the outside wall, divide the platform into smaller sections, or propose another safe arrangement. A solution must protect foundry workers, platform handlers, and spectators.

Iva accepts suspending foundry work during the Procession only if hot materials and current commissions receive another protected location. Simply telling the foundry to stop is not a safe plan. A check is required only for a hurried modification attempted without suitable tools or preparation.

Orun's Preferred Route

Once the characters approve a turn differing from the published map:

READ ALOUD

Orun's bell shifts against its bracket.

Iva is not touching it.

The clapper strikes once.

On the route plan in Sabine's hands, a bronze line appears through the bend.

It follows the original platform turn exactly, passing through the awning support as though the timber were not there.

The bronze route was approved before the awning existed. Iva explains that Orun approved the original turn when the yard ended at the foundry wall. Bellweather keeps restoring the version he approved.

READ ALOUD

"Orun would have objected to changing it," Iva says. "At first."

She points to the current road.

"He changed his mind when the work proved him wrong. The bell preserved the objections better than the reconsideration."

The practical problem can be resolved now. Iva's succession becomes available in Scene 8.

Completing the Foundry Inspection

Once the party selects a safe arrangement, Sabine enters it on the current plan under the name of the person or group responsible. Orun's route remains visible as historical information but no longer controls the turn. Apply the chosen arrangement during the unauthorized rehearsal.

READ ALOUD

"The Procession will ask whether the road follows Orun or me," Iva says.

She folds the corrected plan.

"It should follow the road that is actually here."

Gate-Captain's Rise

READ ALOUD

A stone stair climbs to a roofed signal platform above the Procession road.

Bells of different sizes hang from a heavy timber frame. Red, white, blue, and black flags stand in narrow wall racks. Horns, lantern shutters, route cards, and speaking tubes fill the remaining space.

From the platform, most of Bellweather lies in view.

One approach does not.

The Animal Lane passes beneath the terrace wall and disappears before reaching the western bridge.

Neve stands on a wooden step beside the signal frame, adjusting a bell rope so she can reach it without pulling from the side. Her ceremonial coat hangs from a peg rather than from her shoulders.

Serah's memorial bell rests on a low stand.

"If something happens in the blind lane," Neve says, "I hear about it after everybody else starts shouting."

The Blind Lane

The Procession directs animals through the concealed approach because the wider visible road is reserved for a memorial platform. Neve would receive reports from people in the lane, interpret them, and issue instructions to the rest of the route. The system depends too heavily upon one person receiving accurate information.

A character experienced in watch work, military signalling, animal handling, crowd management, or route safety identifies the problem automatically. Otherwise, use a DC 11 Wisdom (Perception) or Intelligence (Investigation) check.

On a failure, Neve asks Sabine to demonstrate. Sabine steps below the wall and vanishes from view. A raised red flag cannot be seen from the platform.

READ ALOUD

"That is usually the part where Bellweather tells me I should have known anyway," Neve says.

Improving the Signals

The party might install a mirror, assign a second observer, relocate the flag point, add a bell pull or speaking tube, use the western bridge as a relay, or change the animal route. Neve wants a solution distributing information and responsibility, not a way for her to watch more places alone.

READ ALOUD

If offered magical sight or a familiar, Neve asks, "Does that mean somebody else knows what to do, or does it mean I can watch more places alone?"

A coherent relay succeeds without a check. If the party tests an incomplete arrangement, use a DC 12 group check with skills appropriate to each role. On a failure, one signal arrives late and reveals the weak handoff. Nobody is injured.

Serah's Bell

When somebody other than Neve successfully gives an emergency instruction:

READ ALOUD

Serah's bell sounds before Neve reaches for its rope.

A route card lifts from the table and turns toward her.

Fresh bronze letters spread across its surface:

GATE-CAPTAIN CONFIRMS ALL ORDERS

Neve reads the line and sets the card down.

"That was not on the card this morning."

Neve explains that she agreed to carry Serah's signals until everybody was safe, but Bellweather has not found a day safe enough to end the obligation. She wants other people to know what she knows and then to decide what she does next. Her full Succession Record becomes available in Scene 9.

Completing the Rise Inspection

The successful arrangement leaves at least two people capable of receiving and acting upon route information without waiting for Neve. Name those people now. They may be Bellweather workers, circus members, or a mixed team.

READ ALOUD

Before the party leaves, Neve asks, "When the rehearsal starts, who gives the lower-road signal if I am dealing with something up here?"

Wait for a player answer. Use that person or group in Scenes 6 and 7.

Tovin's Civic Platform

READ ALOUD

The Procession road widens before a long stone building with brass-framed windows.

A low platform waits outside the entrance. It carries a writing desk, two locked record chests, and a padded bracket for a memorial bell.

Beside it, rope closes off a narrow workshop court.

One wall is painted a faded red. A timber roof extends from it over a shared work area. Beneath the nearest corner, the stone covering a public drain has cracked and sunk.

A platform wheel has left a deep curved mark in the broken mortar.

Tovin stands inside the rope with two household representatives.

An older woman holds a bundle of deeds across both forearms. Opposite her, a broad-shouldered man in a mason's apron rests one hand on a wooden box filled with bent nails, receipts, and pieces of old timber.

Tovin looks from the drain to the Procession platform.

"The circus is here to inspect the route," he says before either household can object.

"They are not here to decide who owns the wall."

The older woman is Meren Vale. The mason is Davos Kerren. Their full dispute belongs to Scene 10. The party's immediate task is to determine why the drain failed and make the route safe.

Examining the Damage

A character proficient with Mason's Tools, Carpenter's Tools, land vehicles, or construction work determines the cause without a roll: repeated platform weight shifted the drain covering and forced water beneath the wall's outer footing.

Otherwise, use a DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check. On a success, the character also determines that ordinary workshop use did not cause the failure. On a failure, Sabine slowly rolls the platform wheel into the rehearsal line. It settles into the existing curved mark and presses the damaged stone downward, revealing the cause without additional damage.

READ ALOUD

Meren says, "The drain is public. The wall is Vale property. The roof is apparently everybody's

whenever repairs are due.”

Davos answers, “The roof has been ours whenever it leaked.”

Tovin raises one hand. “Property comes later. First I need to know whether the platform can use this road.”

Making the Route Safe

The platform can be shifted away from the drain, temporarily bridged over damaged stone, stopped before the court, or allowed to use part of the work area with both households’ agreement. Neither household objects to immediate safety work as long as it does not silently decide ownership or future use. Bellweather accepts responsibility for the drain once the Procession damage is established.

Halwen’s Passage

READ ALOUD

A bell sounds behind the hall’s brass-framed windows.

Tovin turns toward the building.

A clerk opens the door with an oversized ledger held against their chest.

“Reeve,” the clerk says, “the Vale-Kerren ruling has changed again.”

Tovin closes his eyes for a moment.

“Bring it here.”

The ledger contains an old precedent in Halwen Marr’s hand. A new bronze passage beneath it names Meren and Davos, neither of whom was alive when Halwen served as reeve.

READ ALOUD

“You found the damage,” Tovin says. “Your contract requires you to certify the route.”

He turns the ledger so the characters can see the fresh passage.

“This has made the safety question part of a judgment Bellweather is trying to issue through a dead reeve. When the route inspection is complete, I am asking you to return as witnesses.”

Meren accepts them as witnesses to the damage, not judges of Vale property. Davos refuses another hearing that pretends the shared roof appeared yesterday. Tovin confirms that he remains reeve: the party presents evidence and questions the record; he issues the ruling. His full Succession Record becomes available in Scene 10.

The Silent House Crossing

READ ALOUD

The next turn passes a long, low building surrounded by covered galleries and small garden courts.

No bell hangs beside its door.

Hundreds of brass plates cover the outer wall. Some bear names. Others identify workshops, duties, unfinished books, abandoned performances, and promises nobody chose to carry.

Along the Procession route, ceremonial objects wait on low stands: folded coats, tools, music cases, masks, ledgers, and several bells without harnesses.

A narrow woman in a charcoal-grey coat is moving each stand several inches away from the painted route line.

“Not everything displayed here is available,” she says without looking up.

She straightens a plate reading UNFINISHED and turns to face you.

“Elsin Crow. Keeper of the Silent House.”

Elsin is in her late fifties, with dark skin, close-cut white hair, and ink stains on two fingers. A simple plate identifies her current office. She carries no memorial bell.

The Route Problem

The Procession plan treats the Silent House display as a reserve of objects and roles. If an active succession lacks a tool, garment, or symbolic position, the Keeper may draw from these stands. Elsin moved them because several objects were never authorised for use.

READ ALOUD

“Some are available,” Elsin says. “Some are unfinished. Some were refused. Some are here because preservation was the only decision anybody could agree upon. The Procession currently calls all four conditions the same thing.”

The party must create a practical distinction among agreed Procession objects, displayed but unavailable objects, unfinished work open to invitation, and roles or objects deliberately retired. The difference must be physically visible because the Keeper follows location and repeated use more readily than explanatory text.

The party may use coloured stands, different plate shapes, barriers, separate galleries, living custodians, or another clear arrangement. A coherent system succeeds without a check.

Caldris’s Music Stand

READ ALOUD

Paper whispers beneath a dark cloth.

Elsin stops.

The covered music stand sits among the objects marked UNRESOLVED.

A brass plate at its base bears the name:

CALDRIS FEN

Beneath it, another word has been filed almost completely away.

A DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check identifies the removed word as UNFAITHFUL. On a failure, angled light later reveals enough surviving grooves for Elsin to read it.

READ ALOUD

If asked who Caldris is, Elsin says, “Lor Aven’s successor. Bellweather says Caldris abandoned the Procession. Caldris says the Procession refused to end.”

Caldris is outside Bellweather, not missing. Elsin does not reveal private music during a route inspection. If the party’s investigation reaches Caldris’s succession, she invites them to return and request the relevant records. This establishes Scenes 11 and 12.

An Unfinished Place

Elsin asks what should stand between active Procession objects and those that are unavailable. If the players propose an Unfinished Place, she prepares a low neutral stand bearing the plate NO BEARER ASSIGNED. The party may create another clear boundary. Apply that decision when the Costume Platform activates in Scene 7.

Completing the Inspection

After two locations have received full play, ask whether the characters continue or return to the circus field before dusk. If they continue, summarise the remaining sites and provide their obvious safety facts. Preserve the full role-playing material for the Succession Records.

Ask who oversees rigging and platforms, animal handling, music and signals, costume management, and first aid during the rehearsal. Use established circus experts unless the players choose another arrangement. These assignments last only through Scenes 6 and 7 and require no campaign record.

Returning to the Circus Field

READ ALOUD

The light has begun to turn gold by the time the Procession road brings you back toward the circus field.

Bellweather continues working behind you. Hammers sound at the foundry. Signal bells answer across Bellweather. Route workers move cords and barriers according to the changes made during the inspection.

From the circus field comes a familiar musical phrase.

Before the musicians finish it, a third note answers.

It comes from somewhere inside the camp.

Proceed directly to Scene 5. There is no Carry Forward section. The next scenes immediately use the locations inspected, practical changes established, and specialists assigned here.

Scene 5: The Answering Melody

The party returns to the circus field as the musical survey begins without them. Pippa and Old Fen have been rehearsing the circus's Travelling Answer. Pippa introduced a small variation, Old Fen answered it, and an unseen third note joined them. Maelin Vos, Bellweather's Procession music coordinator, believes the answering note belongs to an unfinished composition by her dead grandfather, Edran Vos.

Nobody has yet repeated the complete phrase a third time.

Returning to Camp

READ ALOUD

The Central Lantern rises above the finished camp. Wagons stand where the company placed them. Smoke drifts from Nell's kitchen, and the animals have settled into their lines.

Near the music wagon, a small group of performers stands in an uneven circle.

Pippa holds her instrument at her side. Old Fen has one hand pressed flat against the wagon's wooden panel. Neither is playing.

A single note sounds from beneath the wagon.

Another answers near the Central Lantern.

Then a third sounds above the camp, clear and unresolved.

Every visible bell remains still.

Allow the characters to act before explaining the effect. Nothing attacks. Nobody is possessed. The answering notes repeat only when somebody plays or hums part of the Travelling Answer. If the characters call for silence, the music stops. If the musicians or wagon move, the third note remains at the original rehearsal place. The effect belongs to the shared performance and location, not to Pippa, Old Fen, or a hidden object.

Securing the Circus Field

Ordinary safety checks confirm that every circus member is present, the animals are unsettled but controlled, the Central Lantern has not been altered, and no creature, bell, instrument, or mechanism is hidden beneath the music wagon. None of the company's instruments has played without a living musician.

If the characters establish a boundary around the wagon, Bellweather's residents remain outside unless invited. Alden soon arrives with Maelin and two Bellweather musicians.

READ ALOUD

Alden stops at the circus boundary with three musicians behind him.

The woman beside him carries a flat wooden score case against her chest. She is perhaps fifty, with dark curls threaded by silver and a long blue coat buttoned unevenly in her haste. No memorial bell hangs from her clothing.

The musicians behind her carry instruments but keep their hands away from them.

Alden looks toward the silent music wagon.

"May we enter?"

Before anyone answers, another note sounds beneath the wagon.

The woman with the score case closes her eyes.

"That is Edran's interval," she says.

Old Fen lifts his hand from the wagon.

"No," he replies. "It is ours."

Maelin does not cross the boundary without permission. If refused entry, she opens the score case outside it.

What Happened

READ ALOUD

"I changed the ending because Fen left room," Pippa says.

She nods toward Old Fen.

"He answered. Something else joined us the second time."

"We stopped before finding out what it would do on the third."

If asked whether the note spoke to her, showed a vision, or tried to control her, Pippa says it was only a very insistent note. She has no special connection to Bellweather. She is present because she helped create the current variation and can testify about its authorship.

Maelin Vos

Edran Vos composed several pieces still used during Bellweather's Procession. He died before completing the Gathering Response, a passage intended to answer the opening call. Bellweather preserved Edran's sketches, rehearsed fragments, and remarks concerning the unfinished piece.

READ ALOUD

"My grandfather wrote the first two intervals," Maelin says. "The third never satisfied him."

She looks toward the wagon.

"What answered your musicians fits the place he left empty."

Maelin does not claim Edran composed Pippa's variation. She does not know whether Bellweather recognised something Edran intended, borrowed something new to complete it, or joined two fitting pieces. Bellweather may already have made that claim.

The Altered Score

READ ALOUD

Maelin opens the case and removes a folded Procession score.

Most of the notation is written in dark brown ink. Corrections and performance marks appear in several different hands.

Near the middle of the page, three measures shine in fresh bronze.

The first two carry Edran Vos's original notation.

The third contains the variation played beside the music wagon.

Beneath all three, the same new hand has written:

EDRAN VOS: GATHERING RESPONSE RESTORED

The bronze writing appeared after the second performance. It cannot be rubbed away. Scraping damages the paper while leaving the letters intact. Dispel Magic suppresses the bronze writing for 10 minutes, revealing blank staff lines beneath it, but the attribution returns unless Bellweather receives another record.

The score identifies Edran as composer and Maelin as current civic custodian. Pippa and Old Fen are magically associated with the third measure but are not recorded as creators.

Understanding the Three Notes

The party needs any two of the following findings before designing a reliable test.

The Musical Structure

A character proficient with a musical instrument recognises the structure after hearing Maelin or Old Fen play the phrases separately. Otherwise, use a DC 12 Intelligence or Charisma (Performance) check. On a success, the character determines that Pippa's variation answers Edran's unfinished phrase but does not imitate his compositional style. On a failure, Old Fen demonstrates the difference.

READ ALOUD

Old Fen plays Edran's first interval exactly as written.

He pauses, then plays Pippa's descending answer.

"The first asks the question Edran kept asking," he says.

"The second belongs to somebody who heard it and chose to answer."

The Magical Pattern

A DC 12 Intelligence (Arcana) check reveals that the first performance created a sympathetic response. The second allowed Bellweather to compare the variation with preserved music. A third exact repetition is likely to finalise the attribution and distribute it to Bellweather's Procession musicians. On a failure, the danger becomes visible during the next performance when bronze notation begins appearing on a blank rehearsal sheet.

The Original Notes

Maelin carries Edran's surviving sketches. A DC 12 Intelligence (History or Investigation) check locates an early instruction. On a failure, Maelin finds it while reviewing the loose pages herself.

READ ALOUD

THE ROAD CALLS. THE ARRIVING VOICE MUST ANSWER IN ITS OWN MANNER. DO NOT WRITE THE ANSWER BEFORE HEARING WHO ARRIVES.

The instruction does not prove Edran composed the current variation. It proves he expected arriving musicians to contribute something new.

READ ALOUD

Maelin reads it twice.

"Then Bellweather preserved his unfinished question," she says, looking at the bronze attribution.

"And ignored his instruction not to preserve the answer."

Refusing the Test

The characters need not perform the phrase again. They may invoke the Living Authorship clause, present the evidence, and order Bellweather not to distribute the altered score. Maelin supports that decision.

If they choose this approach, the Procession safeguard is Living Attribution: Maelin carries the corrected score, and one falsely credited work can be restored to its living creator when that person is present.

Preparing a Controlled Performance

If the characters want to test how Bellweather responds to current attribution, they decide where the test occurs; who plays Edran's phrase, the Travelling Answer, and the current variation; who watches the score; what signal stops the performance; whether Bellweather's musicians enter the circus field; and whether the Unclaimed Bell receives a temporary purpose.

Alden, Maelin, Old Fen, and Pippa answer questions. The players design the test. A simple arrangement places the musicians beside the wagon, the altered score on a stand, the Unclaimed Bell on a neutral stand, and a witness beside each source of evidence.

Moving the test beyond the circus boundary weakens Bellweather's response and gives more time to interrupt it. Testing at the original site produces a stronger but clearer reaction. Pippa does not need to perform. Another current musician may play the variation if its creators are named accurately.

Beginning the Performance

READ ALOUD

Edran’s first interval sounds across the field.

Bellweather answers from the Procession road with the second.

The circus’s Travelling Answer enters between them.

For a moment, the three parts remain separate.

Then the unseen note sounds from the original rehearsal place.

On Maelin’s score, fresh bronze spreads beneath the final measure.

The false attribution begins appearing again. A second line forms beneath it but remains blank, waiting for current authorship.

Correcting the Attribution

The party may interrupt the false record by naming the creators, repeating the variation with a deliberate change, invoking the Living Authorship clause, striking the Unclaimed Bell under an agreed purpose, separating Edran’s phrase from the circus response, or having Maelin enter the current creators into the score. No Persuasion check is required.

READ ALOUD

The bronze words beneath the measure tremble.

EDRAN VOS: GATHERING RESPONSE RESTORED

The final word fades first.

New lines appear beneath the music:

OPENING INTERVAL: EDRAN VOS

TRAVELLING ANSWER: THE LANTERN CIRCUS

CURRENT VARIATION:

The writing stops after the colon.

Ask the living creators how the variation should be credited. Pippa may request shared credit with Old Fen if both shaped it. Old Fen may credit Pippa alone if she composed it and he merely answered. Use their decision.

Deliberate Variation

The party may decide that correct attribution is not enough. The Travelling Answer changes with its performers, and recording one version as final would recreate the same problem. A living musician may alter the final measure.

READ ALOUD

The new variation changes one interval.

Bellweather’s answering note begins as before, falters, and follows the change.

The altered score does not erase the earlier version.

A second line appears beside it.

Bellweather can preserve more than one named living version. This supports the later settlement but does not force a particular outcome.

The Unclaimed Bell

If included, the Unclaimed Bell remains silent until somebody gives it a present purpose. Suitable purposes include ringing when a living creator is named, carrying the part nobody owns permanently, or sounding the stop signal if Bellweather merges the credits again. The person stating the purpose accepts only the work of carrying or positioning the bell for this test. If no purpose is assigned, it remains silent.

Repeating the Phrase

If the complete exchange is performed three times without interruption, Bellweather begins prioritising exact repetition. At the end of the third performance, every active musician makes a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw.

On a success, the musician may stop, alter the phrase, or continue deliberately. On a failure, the musician repeats the exact phrase on their next turn and cannot introduce variation during that performance. Another creature can interrupt by sounding the stop signal, changing the accompaniment, naming the performer, ending the test, or taking another suitable action. Pippa and Old Fen use the same saving throw as everyone else.

Damaging the Score or Civic Bell

Destroying the score removes one visible record but does not erase the musical association carried through Bellweather's civic network. Maelin objects because the page proves what Bellweather changed; destroying it keeps the problem and loses the clearest evidence.

Destroying or disabling the nearest civic music bell ends the unseen answer in the circus field. It also removes Edran's preserved fragments, current route cues, timing signals, and the shared entry used by several living musicians. Name that likely loss before destruction occurs.

Choosing the Musical Safeguard

After reviewing the evidence or completing the controlled test, the party chooses one safeguard for the rehearsal.

Counter-Melody

A current musician can interrupt one exact repeated phrase during Scene 7. The affected sequence cannot act again until the following round.

Living Attribution

One false credit is corrected when the living creator is present and identified.

Unclaimed Measure

The Unclaimed Bell receives one temporary neutral signal chosen now. Its purpose ends after Scene 7 unless deliberately renewed.

Stop Signal

Any player character may halt one musical or route sequence immediately during Scene 7. Bellweather's living workers recognise the signal as a safety command.

The Rehearsal Wakes

READ ALOUD

A warning bell rings from Gate-Captain's Rise.

Neve’s signal.

Before its second note, a platform wheel begins turning on the Procession road.

Costume forms rise from their benches near the Silent House.

Along the Bellfoundry Turn, workshop doors begin opening against their locks.

Then a voice sounds from the civic bells throughout the valley:

“Places.”

Proceed directly to Scene 6. There is no Carry Forward section. Scene 6 begins immediately and restates the chosen musical safeguard.

Scene 6: The Rehearsal Wakes

The answering melody has barely stopped when Bellweather’s rehearsal begins without authorisation. The party has only a few minutes before the Procession route becomes fully active.

Use the work completed during Scene 4. If the characters changed the foundry turn, improved Neve’s signals, protected unavailable Silent House objects, or corrected the civic-platform route, those changes are already in place. The musical safeguard selected in Scene 5 is also ready.

This scene prepares the crisis. The characters choose how the circus responds, protect vulnerable people, and establish three practical advantages before Initiative begins.

The First Warning

READ ALOUD

Neve’s alarm rings from Gate-Captain’s Rise.

One high note. Two lower. A pause.

The pattern repeats.

Below it, a red Procession platform begins rolling without horses or handlers. Bell cords draw tight above empty streets. Ceremonial coats lift from their stands as though invisible people have stepped inside them.

The bellfoundry doors begin opening against their locks.

From the civic bells throughout the valley comes a calm, carrying voice:

“Places.”

Any character who learned Neve’s signals recognises the warning: the route is active, and the Gate-Captain did not authorise it.

The platform is not yet moving quickly enough to crush anyone. Bellweather is assembling the rehearsal in sequence. The party has time to prepare, but not enough to investigate every bell separately.

What Is Visible

From the circus field, three dangers can be seen immediately. The driverless platform threatens to block the bridge. At the Silent House crossing, raised garments move toward workers and spectators. Along the Animal Lane, civic bells and circus handlers issue contradictory commands.

The Bellfoundry Turn is hidden by the curve of the road, but bronze tools can be heard moving inside the locked workshop. A runner from the Rigging Line crosses the field toward the characters. Another descends from Neve's signal station.

Lita's Report

READ ALOUD

Lita Venn slows only when she reaches the Central Lantern.

"The lines are rigging themselves," she says.

"Not our positions. Old ones."

She points toward the upper platform road.

"One of the safety harnesses is looking for somebody to wear it."

If asked what she means, Lita explains that the harness dragged itself from the rack, climbed the ladder, fastened around a costume frame, and is now trying other things. Nobody is trapped yet. Ansel has blocked the ladder, but tightening anchor lines will eventually pull the platform into its earlier position.

Lita asks whether the riggers should cut the inherited lines, hold the platform, move the harness, or evacuate. She follows the party's answer, provided it does not require somebody to enter the moving harness unwillingly.

The Lower-Road Report

The second runner is the current responder established during Scene 4. If nobody was named, Sabine fills that role.

READ ALOUD

The second runner reaches the field and raises both hands before speaking.

"Neve says the upper route is clearing."

They look back toward the moving platform.

"The lower bells keep answering commands she did not give."

If the party created a relay, the runner already knows that the Animal Lane is receiving contradictory signals. Otherwise, the runner knows only that the lower route has stopped responding consistently.

READ ALOUD

If contacted, Neve says, "I can keep the upper road clear. I cannot do that and command every lane below me. Tell me who has the lower road."

The party names a current lower-road authority or states that circus handlers follow the company's ordinary commands rather than the civic bells. Neve accepts either answer.

Alden and Tovin

READ ALOUD

Alden crosses the bridge with Tovin several steps behind him.

Neither carries a bell.

Tovin holds the signed Circus Terms in one hand and an open ledger in the other. Bronze writing spreads across the page faster than he can read it.

Alden stops outside the circus boundary.

“Bellweather has begun the rehearsal,” he says.

He looks toward the moving platform.

“Nobody authorised it.”

Tovin attempted to enter a cancellation order. Each time he writes it, the ledger adds REHEARSAL ALREADY IN PROGRESS and REQUIRED POSITIONS REMAIN UNFILLED.

If asked why it began, Tovin says the music supplied a missing answer and Bellweather treated that as completion of the preparation stage. Maelin objects that the group completed an attribution, not an authorisation. Tovin agrees: the ledger has not preserved the distinction.

Alden asks whether the circus evacuates, helps shut down the route, or holds selected areas long enough to learn what Bellweather is attempting. The contract gives the characters authority over their people and equipment. Bellweather’s route workers will follow their safety signal where circus operations are involved.

The Command Signal

The party chooses one unmistakable signal meaning: stop inherited instructions and await a living order.

If the Stop Signal was selected in Scene 5, use it now. Otherwise, choose a horn pattern, crossed flags, magical light, agreed phrase, the Unclaimed Bell, or another clear signal capable of reaching people along the Procession road.

READ ALOUD

The signal passes along the lower road.

Circus workers stop first. Bellweather’s route crews hesitate, then follow.

The moving platform continues.

The empty costumes continue.

The bells have heard the people stop.

They have not obeyed.

If the party cannot establish a signal, Neve uses Bellweather’s highest emergency stop. Bystanders begin clearing, but Scene 7 starts with 1 Crisis Escalation because the system recognises Neve as sole authority for the whole route. Naming another current authority avoids that consequence.

The Four Active Areas

The party now understands the developing crisis. It can prepare three of four areas before the rehearsal fully begins.

Rigging Line

Obsolete ropes are tightening around current circus anchors. An empty harness associated with Aveline Quill, a performer from an earlier Procession, is searching for a living body.

The party may mark or release old anchors, move the harness to a controlled stand, install rapid-cut lines, assign a willing supervisor, or create another preparation separating the historic setup from current rigging.

Animal Lane

Bellweather's civic bells call for forward movement while current circus handlers order the teams to halt. A ceremonial saddle associated with Beryn Holt, an earlier mounted herald, is dragging itself toward the nearest suitable animal.

The party may separate signal systems, restrain or isolate the saddle, strengthen barriers, name enough current handlers, or prepare a safe withdrawal route.

Bellfoundry

Tools are preparing to repair a Procession timing bell that has not broken.

READ ALOUD

The foundry doors shudder against their locks.

Through the gaps comes the sound of hammers, tongs, and wheeled tables moving across the floor.

Iva stands beside the side entrance with Orun's memorial bell secured in both hands.

"The tools are preparing a repair," she says.

"The bell they intend to repair has not cracked."

The party may shut down fuel, move the timing bell, isolate dangerous tools, open a safe path for workers, prepare quenching material, or ask Iva which parts of the process must not be interrupted suddenly.

READ ALOUD

"If they light the casting floor with nobody inside," Iva says, "the doors become the least important problem."

Costume Platform

Ceremonial garments have begun lifting from their stands and searching for people who resemble unfilled roles. If the party created an Unfinished Place in Scene 4, it remains untouched at first.

Otherwise, a blank plate begins writing the name of somebody currently performing related work. Use a specific character whose connection is clear.

READ ALOUD

If Mira's name appears, she says, "I agreed to stop them hurting somebody. That is not the same job."

The party may separate current and memorial garments, protect unavailable objects, assign living custodians, install release points, remove nameplates, preserve an intentional empty place, or establish a spoken consent cue before any garment is worn.

Choosing Three Preparations

Ask which three areas receive immediate preparation. A practical action succeeds without a check when suitable people, equipment, and time are available. Use DC 12 only when the party attempts something uncertain under immediate pressure.

On a failed test, the preparation still provides partial help, but one complication remains in Scene 7. A rapid-cut line may work but require access from the upper platform. An animal barrier may redirect one team before breaking. Foundry fuel may be secured while tools reach the timing bell. A costume boundary may protect memorial garments while leaving one current costume unidentified.

Mark the three prepared areas directly on the Scene 7 reference. No permanent campaign record is required.

Understanding the Sequence

A character may study the connected activity using Intelligence (Arcana or Investigation), Charisma (Performance), Wisdom (Insight), or a relevant professional proficiency. Use DC 12.

On a success, the character recognises that Bellweather is rebuilding the last Procession it considers complete. It gathers expected objects and people, moves them toward preserved positions, calls for missing roles, and fills those roles from whatever nearby person or object appears suitable. Once the route looks complete, it begins whether living participants are ready or not.

On a failure, the party learns the same sequence when the missing-position chime sounds. The failed test costs only the opportunity to predict which role Bellweather seeks first.

The Missing-Position Chime

READ ALOUD

Three low notes pass down the Procession road.

A fourth note should answer.

None does.

The three notes sound again.

Every personal and memorial bell in hearing gives a small answering movement.

Brass plates turn toward the nearest empty place.

Name the exact role Bellweather is seeking. Use an unprepared area when possible: Aveline Quill's aerial position, Beryn Holt's mounted herald, the Custodian of Unfinished Legacies, or another clearly established unfilled role.

Use the circus's first empty place or a player's unresolved personal bell only when that connection has already been made openly.

The party may declare the position intentionally empty, divide its work, name a willing temporary custodian, complete or retire the role, state that the absent person's permission cannot be inferred, or allow Bellweather to choose. If the position remains empty, make that answer visible through a blank plate, neutral stand, Unclaimed Bell, current witness, or public statement. If somebody accepts temporarily, ask when the role ends.

Evacuate, Hold, or Divide the Response

READ ALOUD

Alden asks, "The route workers will follow your order where the circus is involved. Do we clear everyone, hold the prepared areas, or divide the work?"

If the party evacuates, nonessential circus members and residents leave the lower route. Scene 7 begins with fewer people endangered but fewer current workers available to demonstrate alternatives.

If the party holds, trained workers remain in prepared areas while the characters observe the system. The party receives more practical support, but an unprepared zone retains bystanders.

For a mixed response, vulnerable people and animals withdraw while named specialists remain at prepared locations. There is no prescribed correct answer.

Starting Positions

Ask each player where their character begins: Central Route, Rigging Line, Animal Lane, Bellfoundry, or Costume Platform. A character may accompany somebody they want to protect or question. Allow the group to cluster if it wishes; problems elsewhere continue, and movement between areas becomes part of Scene 7. Do not assign characters according to class.

The Rehearsal Begins

READ ALOUD

The civic voice calls again.

“Places.”

Ropes snap tight along the upper road.

The ceremonial saddle jerks against its restraint.

Foundry tools strike bronze behind the workshop doors.

Across the Costume Platform, empty garments turn toward the living.

Then every bell in Bellweather falls silent.

For one breath, the valley waits for somebody to begin.

A single clapper strikes the central bell.

Proceed directly to Scene 7 and roll Initiative.

For Scene 7 only, the DM needs the command signal, three prepared areas, musical safeguard, missing-position answer, evacuation approach, and every player character’s starting area. Place those details on the Scene 7 reference and discard them when the crisis ends.

Scene 7: The First Rehearsal

The characters have established a command signal, prepared three parts of the Procession route, answered or visibly preserved the missing position, and decided who remains on the road. Bellweather now attempts to reconstruct the last Procession it considers complete.

Where the present route differs from the preserved version, the bells restore the older arrangement. Where a position remains empty, they search for somebody or something suitable to fill it. Where living workers changed an inherited practice, Bellweather treats the difference as an error.

The characters must secure three of the four active areas before the rehearsal completes its pattern. An area is not secured because its animated objects were destroyed or suppressed. The party must also establish a safe current arrangement that living workers can maintain.

The Central Bell Sounds

READ ALOUD

The central bell rings.

Its note reaches the circus field as a weight in the air. Smaller bells answer from the surrounding route districts, then from workshops, signal posts, memorial frames, and household doors.

Along the upper road, ropes draw tight around an empty harness.

In the Animal Lane, the ceremonial saddle tears against its restraint.

The bellfoundry doors swing inward.

At the Silent House crossing, empty garments step down from their stands.

Bellweather’s voice passes through every civic bell at once:

> “Rehearsal begun.”
>
> “Positions incomplete.”
>
> “Restoration in progress.”

Roll Initiative. Use the starting areas chosen in Scene 6. Supporting workers begin where the party placed them. The Central Route remains open. A character normally moves between adjacent areas using ordinary movement. Reaching a nonadjacent area generally requires the Dash action, suitable magic, a vehicle, or an established shortcut.

Running the Crisis

The rehearsal begins with 0 Crisis Escalation unless Scene 6 established otherwise. At Initiative count 10, one unsecured area acts. Choose the area that follows most naturally from the characters’ decisions rather than rotating mechanically.

Crisis Escalation increases by 1 at the end of a round when an unwilling person remains assigned without challenge, living workers or animals remain caught between contradictory commands, a visible unsecured area is entirely unattended, or the party suppresses manifestations without establishing any current arrangement. It can increase only once per round.

Do not increase Crisis Escalation because a character repeats an attack, spell, class feature, signal, or sensible safety procedure.

Securing an Area

Each area requires two achievements. First, contain the immediate danger. Second, establish what happens there now. Once secured, ordinary workers can maintain the area. It no longer acts at Initiative count 10 unless another unsecured area spreads into it.

The Rigging Line

Inherited lines pull the platform toward rusted anchors while Aveline Quill’s harness searches for a body. Apply Scene 6 preparations; otherwise it begins above the nearest rigger, performer, or character.

Searching Harness: AC 13; 12 HP; immune to Poison and Psychic damage and Charmed, Frightened, and Prone. Attack +4; on a hit the target is Grappled (escape DC 12) and pulled 10 feet toward the old ascent position at the start of each turn. An adjacent creature opens it with an action and DC 10 Dexterity; relevant rigging or leatherwork succeeds automatically.

Inherited Anchors: release or redirect one with an action. Relevant experience identifies the safe order; otherwise use DC 12 Investigation or Dexterity. Failure drops a loaded line: creatures on the platform make DC 11 Dexterity saves or fall Prone and slide 5 feet. Cutting all lines drops the platform onto its braces for 2 Bludgeoning damage and Prone. Secure the area with guide ropes, divided work, a temporary performer with an ending, a retired position, or an empty harness.

The Animal Lane

Civic bells call forward while handlers call halt, and Beryn Holt’s saddle drags toward a suitable animal. Apply the Scene 6 preparations.

Ceremonial Saddle: AC 12; 14 HP; immune to Poison and Psychic damage and Charmed and Frightened. At Initiative count 10 it moves 20 feet toward a suitable animal. An adjacent handler can use a Reaction and DC 12 Strength or Dexterity to stop it. Once attached, the animal follows Beryn’s route until calmed with DC 12 Animal Handling, restrained, redirected, or the saddle is removed or destroyed.

Secure the lane with one current movement signal and an answer for the herald’s work: retire it, distribute messages, assign a limited willing rider, keep the saddle empty while messengers work, or reuse its bells under current custody.

The Bellfoundry

Animated tools prepare to repair a sound timing bell and may open the furnace. If it ignites without living control, increase Crisis Escalation unless somebody closes fuel, quenches the chamber, or takes control.

Borrowed Gesture: AC 13; 16 HP; Speed 30 feet; immune to Poison and Psychic damage and Charmed, Frightened, and Prone. Attack +4 for 5 Bludgeoning damage or 5 damage to an unattended object. At 0 HP the tools scatter. The timing bell has AC 16 and 30 HP; attached tools deal 5 damage at Initiative count 10.

Control the furnace, protect the fittings, then test the bell. Relevant expertise succeeds; otherwise use DC 12 Intelligence with suitable tools, Investigation, or Arcana. Failure reveals a loose bolt after one round. Secure the area by deferring repair, scheduling inspection, repairing only the mount, accepting dismantling after disclosed loss, or conducting a controlled test.

The Costume Platform

Current, memorial, unfinished, and retired garments search for suitable bodies. Apply the earlier classifications and preparations; otherwise one blank frame writes a nearby worker’s name.

Namebearer: AC 12; 14 HP; Speed 30 feet; immune to Poison and Psychic damage and Charmed, Frightened, Grappled, and Prone. Attack +4 for 4 Psychic damage; DC 11 Wisdom or move 10 feet toward the assigned position. At 0 HP the garment collapses, but another may form until the role receives a current answer.

Sort the objects automatically with relevant experience or use DC 12 Investigation or Perception; failure visibly misplaces one object. Secure the area by dividing records, safety, and consent; using stationary displays; assigning limited or individual custody; retiring the office; or leaving the frame empty.

Moving Between Areas

A character can move between adjacent areas using ordinary movement. The Rigging Line and Bellfoundry are not adjacent; reaching one directly from the other normally requires the Dash action, increased Speed, suitable magic, or an established shortcut. The Central Route provides sightlines and communication among all four areas. The command signal reaches living participants but does not automatically suppress manifestations.

Using the Musical Safeguard

Apply the option selected in Scene 5. Counter-Melody allows a current musician to use a Reaction so one area does not act at Initiative count 10 this round. Living Attribution immediately restores one current work to its identified living creator. Unclaimed Measure causes the Unclaimed Bell to perform its assigned signal when the stated condition occurs. Stop Signal allows a player character to use a Reaction to cancel one Initiative count 10 event before it resolves. The selected safeguard can be used once in this scene.

Supporting Characters

Supporting characters act after a player’s direction creates a useful opportunity. Lita and Ansel operate rigging; Corren and current handlers manage animals; Iva and foundry workers perform technical procedures; Mira, Elsin, and Silent House workers sort garments; Neve and current responders relay signals; Alden coordinates route workers; and Tovin records current instructions.

Do not run full turns for every NPC. After a player acts, one supporting character may complete ordinary work made possible by that action. Supporting characters protect bystanders, move equipment, carry information, and maintain secured areas. They do not independently solve an unsecured area while the players work elsewhere.

Crisis Escalation 1

READ ALOUD

The central bell rings again.

Across the route, active bells repeat the same four measures.

Living workers begin moving before they consciously answer.

Hands reach for familiar tools. Feet turn toward assigned places.

Bellweather is no longer waiting for the rehearsal to become complete.

It is beginning to treat repetition as permission.

Until one area is secured, living NPCs have Disadvantage on checks made to resist or interrupt inherited movement. Player characters are affected only by specific scene effects or personal bells.

Crisis Escalation 2

READ ALOUD

Bronze nameplates turn throughout the Procession road.

Current names slide beneath older ones. Temporary duties lose their ending clauses. Empty plates begin searching for letters.

Tovin looks down at the civic ledger.

“It is removing the differences,” he says.

“Bellweather is preserving one version of the route.”

The first attempt to state a new temporary term requires a DC 12 Charisma check using Persuasion, Performance, or another relevant proficiency. Presenting a written agreement, physical proof, completed practical demonstration, or established personal-bell boundary succeeds without a check.

Crisis Escalation 3

At the third increase, Bellweather completes one harmful assignment connected to the least protected area.

At the Rigging Line, the person caught in Aveline Quill’s harness is recorded as her successor. They gain spatial awareness around the upper platform but feel pressure to report for every later Procession descent.

At the Animal Lane, the ceremonial saddle attaches its signal to one current animal-and-handler pair. They gain Advantage on one check involving rapid movement through Bellweather’s route but continue hearing Beryn’s forward signal whenever the Procession activates.

At the Bellfoundry, the timing bell is dismantled far enough that Bellweather loses one current musical cue. The final Procession must use the circus’s signal system until the bell is repaired.

At the Costume Platform, Bellweather assigns the Custodian of Unfinished Legacies to the person named on the blank frame. That person can sense unresolved objects nearby but feels pressure to remain with them until another living person accepts custody.

After applying one consequence, Crisis Escalation remains at 3 and does not increase further. Lasting assignments can be challenged during the final Procession.

Securing Three Areas

READ ALOUD

Three current signals answer from different parts of Bellweather.

Read only the lines belonging to secured areas:

- Rigging: A platform settles into the configuration chosen by its living riggers.
- Animal Lane: Current handlers call, and the animals turn toward them.
- Bellfoundry: The current foundry order remains in Iva's ledger.
- Costume Platform: Unfinished garments wait without searching for a bearer.

READ ALOUD

The central bell begins the rehearsal call again.

The living answers do not match its preserved sequence.

The note breaks across the valley.

Bells continue ringing, but they no longer agree upon what must happen next.

The remaining manifestations lose coordination and can be contained by current workers with ordinary support. The party may continue to secure the fourth area.

Securing All Four Areas

READ ALOUD

The central bell calls for the preserved Procession.

Four different living answers return.

A platform settles into its current rigging.

Animals follow their present handlers.

Foundry tools remain still beneath a living work order.

Unfinished garments wait without searching for a bearer.

The central bell sounds again.

This time, it does not correct them.

Record Coordinated Variation. During Scene 16, the Procession begins with 1 Living Act because Bellweather has already witnessed several current arrangements operating together.

If the Party Withdraws

The party may evacuate without securing three areas. The command signal allows living workers, animals, and circus equipment to withdraw. Bellweather's manifestations complete the nearest available version of each unfilled role. Apply one Crisis Escalation consequence from each unsecured area, to a maximum of two consequences. The rehearsal ends when no living participants remain on the route.

READ ALOUD

Alden does not condemn the decision.

"You removed the people Bellweather was trying to place," he says.

"That may have prevented worse harm."

"It also showed us what the bells do when nobody answers."

The party still gains enough evidence to begin Act II.

What the Rehearsal Proves

- Bellweather fills missing roles by searching for nearby people, objects, and duties resembling the preserved position.
- It treats repeated practical cooperation as evidence of acceptance.
- A role can be divided, completed, transformed, or left empty when living people make that answer visible and operate safely under it.
- Destroying a manifestation removes the immediate danger but does not answer the role.
- Bellweather can preserve more than one version of a tradition when the differences are deliberately named and demonstrated.

The Silence Afterward

READ ALOUD

The last moving object falls still.

Ropes settle against platform rails. The ceremonial saddle lies empty in the dust. Foundry tools return to the floor one at a time. Across the Costume Platform, sleeves and coats collapse onto their stands.

The central bell gives no closing note.

Bellweather's residents remain where the rehearsal left them, waiting to hear whether the danger has ended.

Alden steps onto the lower road.

"The rehearsal is stopped," he calls.

He looks toward the characters before continuing.

"By current order."

Allow the characters to treat injuries, check animals, inspect equipment, challenge remaining assignments, or speak with affected people. Nell establishes first aid at the circus field. Bellweather supplies water, food, repair materials, and workers. The circus and village complete a Long Rest before the succession investigations begin.

Alden Opens the Records

READ ALOUD

Alden arrives without the Speaker's plate at his collar. He carries it in one hand. He removed it before entering the circus field so Bellweather would not interpret his request as an official summons.

"Bellweather's records call this a successful rehearsal," he says.

"They count every position that was eventually filled."

"They do not count how many people refused, how many tools had to be stopped, or how many roles survived only because you changed them."

He places the plate on the table.

"I am opening the active succession records."

"You will choose which cases to investigate."

If challenged, Alden explains that Bellweather investigated separate complaints but nobody followed the same mistake from foundry to signals, music, records, and circus equipment. If the party distrusts him, he provides copies and invites independent witnesses. They do not need to trust him to examine what Bellweather wrote.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

By nightfall, the Procession road is clear of moving platforms and searching garments.

Some bells have been covered. Others remain exposed so their bearers can hear if they begin again.

At the circus field, Tovin delivers four sealed record cases.

Each bears the name of a living successor:

IVA RELL

NEVE ARLOW

TOVIN MARR

CALDRIS FEN

One case contains two locations rather than one. Caldris's record begins in the Silent House and continues beyond Bellweather.

Alden leaves the cases unopened.

"You need three," he says.

"Choose the people and questions you believe will teach us the most."

Act II begins when the party selects its first Succession Record.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

whether the party secured three areas or all four; Coordinated Variation, if earned; and any lasting Crisis Escalation consequence. Discard all temporary positions, preparations, and zone conditions.

Scene 8: Iva's Unstruck Bell

If the characters choose Iva Rell's Succession Record, they return to the bellfoundry. During the unauthorized rehearsal, Bellweather attempted to dismantle a sound civic bell because Orun Vask's preserved procedure anticipated damage that had not occurred. The party stopped the work and replaced Orun's instruction with a present decision.

Iva now wants to establish whether Bellweather can preserve Orun's knowledge without treating his judgment as final. She also intends to show the characters something nobody else in Bellweather has heard.

Returning to the Bellfoundry

READ ALOUD

Morning light enters the bellfoundry through high windows striped with smoke.

The animated tools have been returned to their racks. Chalk circles mark where hammers, tongs, and chisels were found after the rehearsal. The Procession timing bell stands intact near the entrance, its loose mounting bolt repaired.

At the centre of the workshop, Iva has cleared a long workbench.

Orun's memorial bell rests at one end in its padded bracket.

At the other stands an object covered by a heavy leather cloth.

Iva closes the foundry doors after you enter.

"I want to show you what the bell preserved," she says.

She looks toward Orun's bell.

"Then I want to show you what it would not allow me to add."

Iva has dismissed all but two workers. Perrin Dast is an elderly mould-maker who worked beside Orun for twenty-three years. Sella Venn is Iva's current apprentice and can describe how Bellweather treats knowledge passed through Iva as though it still came directly from Orun.

Orun's bell bears three plates: ORUN VASK: MASTER BELLFOUNDER; CURRENT SUCCESSOR: IVA RELL; and WORK CONTINUES. Iva did not approve the third plate.

What Iva Wants

Iva wants to keep Orun's preserved knowledge, continue maintaining Bellweather's working bells, and finish commissions she personally chooses to complete. She wants new work credited to its living maker and Orun's authority over future design to end.

READ ALOUD

"I learned this craft from Orun," Iva says. "Some of what I know would be gone if the bell fell silent tomorrow."

She rests both hands on the workbench.

"I do not want Bellweather to forget him."

"I want Bellweather to stop using him to correct me."

Iva asks the party to witness three things: work completed before and after Orun's death, the way Orun's bell claims authority over her current work, and, if the characters respect her ownership of the decision, the object beneath the leather cloth.

The Original Acceptance

READ ALOUD

I, IVA RELL, ACCEPT CARE OF BELLWEATHER'S WORKING BELLS, COMPLETION OF ORUN VASK'S OUTSTANDING COMMISSIONS, AND PRESERVATION OF THE KNOWLEDGE NECESSARY TO KEEP THE CIVIC BELLS SAFE.

I ACCEPT THIS WORK IN RECOGNITION OF WHAT ORUN TAUGHT ME AND THE TRUST BELLWEATHER PLACES IN THE FOUNDRY.

WITNESSED BY TOVIN MARR, REEVE; PERRIN DAST, MOULD-MAKER; AND ALDEN SHAW, SPEAKER OF NAMES.

The statement does not require Iva to reproduce Orun's designs forever, transfer authorship of future work, or leave Orun as Master Bellfounder after the outstanding commissions are complete.

Bellweather initially treated each completed commission as evidence that the succession functioned correctly. When Iva accepted new work, the Keeper classified those commissions as continuations because she used knowledge preserved through Orun's bell. The distinction between finishing Orun's work and continuing the foundry's work disappeared over time.

The Six Bells

READ ALOUD

Six bells stand in a row beneath the foundry windows.

The first three are broad, plain, and nearly identical. Their bronze surfaces show only the maker's mark and date of casting.

The next two follow the same design but stand slightly taller, with thinner rims and narrower crowns.

The sixth is different.

Its body curves unevenly toward the rim. One side is deeper than the other, and its clapper hangs from a small joint rather than a fixed loop.

The first three bear Orun's mark.

The last three bear Iva's.

A character experienced in metalwork, acoustic craft, Smith's Tools, or Tinker's Tools compares the designs without a roll. Iva's later bells use less metal while producing equal or better volume. Their crowns distribute carrying weight more comfortably. The asymmetrical design produces different overtones depending upon how it is held.

Other characters may make a DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check. On a failure, Iva demonstrates by weighing the bells, striking each from the same stand, and showing vibration patterns in a shallow tray of sand.

Perrin's Account

READ ALOUD

"The first bell she made after Orun died was inferior," Perrin says. "The second was not. By the fifth, she had solved a problem he never thought worth solving."

If asked whether Orun would approve, Perrin says not at first. Orun would have demanded more castings, broken one, heated another until the crown failed, and hung the last beneath the roof for a winter. Then he might have approved it.

READ ALOUD

Perrin glances toward the memorial bell.

"Bellweather preserved the objections."

"It did not preserve the winter."

If asked why Perrin did not defend Iva sooner, he says he thought the work would speak for itself. Bellweather kept speaking first.

Sella's Account

Bellweather's records call Sella Orun's second-generation apprentice, although she never met him.

READ ALOUD

"The bell can identify faults I cannot hear yet," Sella says. "It remembers how different bronze behaves after years outdoors. It knows repairs nobody wrote down."

She turns toward Iva's bells.

"It also calls my teacher's work a variation of Orun's method, even when Orun never used it."

Sella would not accept Orun's bell after Iva. She might accept knowledge from it but not a succession pretending she learned from somebody she never met. If she eventually succeeds Iva, it will be because Iva asks and Sella accepts her own terms, not because Bellweather needs an unbroken chain.

What Orun's Bell Preserves

- Alloy formulas
- Casting temperatures
- Mould preparation
- Acoustic testing methods
- Structural diagnosis
- Repair procedures
- Foundry safety practices
- Orun's recorded judgment concerning civic bells

While examining or repairing a bell, Iva can draw upon this knowledge to gain Advantage on one appropriate check using Smith's Tools or another relevant craft proficiency.

The bell expects Orun's methods to remain official until Bellweather accepts a superior replacement through the foundry record. Orun's preserved judgment influences whether Bellweather considers a replacement superior. The bell therefore acts as both adviser and gatekeeper.

Preparing the Controlled Test

Iva prepares three bell tongues: Orun's recorded method, her revision, and a harmless unsuitable-alloy control. The party chooses witnesses, order, markings, and record safeguards; Iva accepts officials, craftspeople, circus members, the Unclaimed Bell, the Living Authorship clause, or another transparent method.

A proficient craftsperson identifies the control and confirms the others are sound; otherwise use DC 12 Investigation. Failure leaves the viable pieces uncertain until sounded while the control's defect becomes obvious. Orun's piece rings true and the control develops a stress line, proving his preserved diagnosis remains useful.

Establish Iva as maker before testing her piece. It produces the strongest, cleanest tone, but Bellweather tries to credit Orun's method, workshop, or authority. Correct the record through evidence, witnesses, the contract, or current authorship. Without intervention, Orun receives sole credit and Iva refuses to ring the Unstruck Bell; the test still permits later correction.

Orun's Reconstructed Judgment

READ ALOUD

"Unverified departure from accepted practice."

The voice is older and roughened by years near smoke and hot metal.

"Repeat test."

"Increase load."

"Preserve method until failure threshold established."

READ ALOUD

Perrin closes his eyes. “That sounds like him.”

Iva agrees the testing proposal is reasonable. That is why the problem is difficult. Bellweather treats Orun’s method as official until his reconstruction accepts the replacement.

If questioned, the bell says Iva performed the work but avoids the word designed. It calls the test structural promise with long-term data unavailable. It confirms Orun revised practice when repeated evidence established superior reliability. When asked who decides when the evidence is enough, it answers Master Bellfounder. When asked who currently holds that office, the bell rings once but does not speak.

The Unstruck Bell

If the characters preserved Iva’s authorship and treated her as owner of the decision, she removes the leather cover.

READ ALOUD

Beneath the cloth stands a bell unlike any other in the foundry.

It is approximately the same size as Orun’s memorial bell, but its body is deliberately uneven. One side descends more steeply toward the rim. The clapper hangs from a narrow joint that allows it to change angle as the bell is turned.

Fine silver lines run through the dark bronze as part of the design.

The crown bears one blank removable plate.

The bell has never been rung.

Iva designed and cast the bell privately over several years, testing each component separately so Bellweather could not classify the complete work as Orun’s. Perrin helped prepare one mould without knowing the full design. Sella knows the bell exists but has never heard it.

READ ALOUD

“If I ring it alone, Bellweather may call it Orun’s final design.”

“If I ring it before witnesses under my own name, the foundry will have to answer something it has never heard from him.”

Iva places one hand on the crown.

“I want to know what you believe the first ringing should establish.”

Iva is not asking permission to ring her own bell. She is asking how the event should be witnessed and recorded.

Deciding the First Ringing

A private test confirms the bell works without immediately forcing Bellweather’s public network to classify it. Iva accepts privacy only as a step toward authorship, not another reason the work remains hidden.

A public demonstration before workers and civic witnesses creates the strongest record but causes every connected foundry bell to respond. Iva accepts the risk if the work area is protected and a stop procedure exists.

The bell may become a deliberate living variation in the Procession, but Iva requires authorship and current terms to be recorded before the ceremony. She will not enter as an unnamed surprise and hope Bellweather becomes fair before an audience.

Iva may distribute portions of the revised method before the first ringing, proving knowledge can exist without one permanent bearer. Sella volunteers if asked. Perrin offers to document the tests under Iva's name.

Iva may also delay the first ringing. The bell then remains unstruck because its maker chose to wait, not because Bellweather refused to recognise it.

Iva's Boundaries

- The bell is Iva's work.
- Orun may be credited as her teacher, not its maker.
- Ringing the bell does not renew Orun's authority.
- Learning from the bell does not make somebody Iva's successor.
- Iva retains custody unless she knowingly transfers it.

Ringing the Bell

If the first ringing occurs now, establish witnesses, record, safeguards, and attribution before beginning.

READ ALOUD

Iva lifts the bell by its arched crown.

She turns it slightly, allowing the jointed clapper to settle toward the deeper side.

"I designed this bell," she says.

"Orun Vask taught me the craft from which I made it."

"He did not design it."

"He did not cast it."

"The decision to ring it is mine."

She waits until the witnesses and record are ready.

Then she swings the bell.

The first note is deep and clear.

As she changes the angle of her wrist, the clapper shifts.

A second tone rises within the first.

Then a third.

The three notes do not resolve into one another. They remain distinct, held together by the same bronze.

Around the foundry, memorial and civic bells begin to answer.

Orun's bell rings first.

Iva's bell rings again.

This time, Orun's answer stops before covering it.

The ledger writes IVA RELL: UNSTRUCK BELL and CRAFT INHERITED FROM ORUN VASK, then waits. Ask what current purpose was established. Suitable entries include LIVING VARIATION TEST,

FOUNDRY TEACHING, PROCESSION DEMONSTRATION, or NO OFFICE ATTACHED. If no purpose was established, Iva writes AUTHORSHIP RECORDED and FUTURE USE UNDECIDED.

If Bellweather Credits Orun

If attribution was not established before the ringing, the ledger writes ORUN VASK: FINAL EXPERIMENTAL BELL. Iva stops immediately. The characters may correct the record using the evidence and witnesses already present. If they do not, Iva ends the demonstration and her Record remains incomplete until the attribution is corrected.

Destroying Orun's Bell

READ ALOUD

Iva places herself between the party and the bracket.

"That bell contains knowledge I chose to preserve."

"You may help me change its authority."

"You do not decide that freedom requires me to forget what I learned."

If asked what may be lost, Iva names Orun's method for hearing subsurface flaws, alloy adjustments for winter moisture, repair notes for early Bellweather bells, and the remembered structure of three lost moulds. The party may now make an informed recommendation. Iva still decides what happens to the bell in her custody.

Revising the Foundry Record

Iva's preferred terms keep Orun recognised as teacher and source of preserved knowledge, name Iva as current Master Bellfounder, credit living work to its living maker, allow Orun's reconstruction to advise and diagnose, and deny it authority to approve or reject present designs on Bellweather's behalf.

The party may refine the language. Iva supports distributing Orun's knowledge among several trained workers and reviewing which techniques still require magical preservation. She rejects any arrangement naming Orun as permanent Master Bellfounder while calling her only his successor.

Bellweather's Response

When current authority is entered while Orun's knowledge remains available, the bell answers:

READ ALOUD

"Current Master Bellfounder assumes responsibility for tested departure."

READ ALOUD

Iva releases a breath. "That will do."

The response does not prove Orun would personally approve. It proves Bellweather can process a transfer of authority without erasing preserved knowledge. If the record remains contradictory, the bell says Master Bellfounder unresolved, and the party must clearly state who decides current foundry work.

Completing Iva's Record

Record Iva's accepted custody, Bellweather's added control over authorship and replacement, the evidence from the controlled test, Iva's present choice, and the status of Orun's preserved knowledge.

Procession Preparation

Choose one: Iva's First Sound preserves living authorship beside inherited craft; Authorship Ledger corrects one false creative credit; Distributed Foundry divides one inherited office among current

functions; Prepared Separation isolates an active bell connection without destroying its stored knowledge.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Tovin turns the final page toward Iva.

Orun’s name remains at the beginning of the record.

Beneath it appear the techniques, commissions, and responsibilities Iva knowingly accepted.

A separate line records where Bellweather added authority she never agreed to carry.

The final entry bears Iva’s name alone.

She signs it.

Orun’s memorial bell remains silent.

From the workbench, the Unstruck Bell gives one faint answering tone.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

Iva’s current choice The selected Procession Preparation Whether the Unstruck Bell will appear during the Procession Iva retains ordinary custody of both foundry bells unless play established otherwise.

Scene 9: The Child in the Guard’s Coat

If the characters choose Neve Arlow’s Succession Record, she asks them to meet her at Gate-Captain’s Rise after the morning signals. The party has already seen adults wait for Neve even when they possess enough information to act. Neve does not want the characters to prove she is incapable. She wants them to prove Bellweather can remain safe without leaving one child permanently responsible for everybody else.

The Empty Duty Board

READ ALOUD

Morning wind moves the signal flags above Gate-Captain’s Rise.

Neve’s ceremonial coat hangs from a peg beside the stairs. Without it, she looks smaller than she did at the circus field. The platform around her does not.

Serah Arlow’s memorial bell rests on a low padded stand. Neve is writing names onto a fresh duty board.

There are spaces for nine signal workers.

Only one name appears.

Hers.

Sabine Tern represents the route crews. Orris Dane, a volunteer night-watcher, knows the basic alarms but has been taught to report uncertain conditions to Neve instead of acting. If the party established other responders earlier, use them instead.

What Neve Wants

READ ALOUD

"Bellweather says the signals belong to the Gate-Captain. That means everybody learns enough to call me and not enough to replace me."

She points to the empty spaces.

"I want to know what actually needs one captain, what can belong to several people, and what should happen without anybody waiting for permission."

Neve likes the signals and wants a meaningful place in Bellweather's safety system. She wants other people to know what she knows, to sleep through alarms somebody else can handle, and to know Bellweather will survive if she later leaves the work entirely.

Serah Arlow

Serah, Neve's aunt, served as Gate-Captain for nineteen years. After a deadly spring flood, she created Bellweather's formal signal language for fire, flood, blocked roads, structural danger, missing people, uncontrolled animals, medical emergencies, and full evacuation. Flags and lantern shutters repeat the bell instructions when sound is unreliable.

Serah died when Neve was ten. Two months later, a hillside collapse trapped families above the eastern road. Neve knew the signals better than anyone else still living, accepted Serah's bell, coordinated the rescue, and brought everyone home. During that emergency she made a promise Bellweather preserved without an ending.

Neve's Promise

READ ALOUD

I WILL CARRY SERAH'S SIGNALS UNTIL EVERYONE IS SAFE.

NEVE ARLOW

WITNESSED DURING THE EASTERN ROAD COLLAPSE

A character experienced with contracts or administration recognises that the statement refers to that emergency. Otherwise, a DC 11 Intelligence (Investigation) check identifies that Neve was first entered as Acting Signal Keeper. The permanent title Gate-Captain appeared four days later. On a failed check, Tovin's accompanying note reveals the same sequence.

READ ALOUD

"The road was blocked. People were above it. I knew the signals."

Neve taps the promise.

"I meant until those people were safe."

Serah's Bell

The memorial bell preserves Serah's signal language, route knowledge, evacuation priorities, crowd-control procedures, emergency judgment, and memories of earlier disasters. It does not know every change made after Serah's death.

Once per Short Rest, a recognised bearer may ring it while giving a clear emergency instruction. Each willing creature within 30 feet who hears it may immediately move up to 10 feet without provoking

Opportunity Attacks, provided the movement follows that instruction. Bellweather has gradually expanded this emergency responsibility into permanent authority.

Serah's Coat

READ ALOUD

The dark blue coat is reinforced along the shoulders, back, and forearms. Its sleeves have been shortened more than once. The shoulders have never been reduced. Stiffened cloth holds them square even while the coat hangs empty.

Inside the collar, two names have been sewn one above the other:

SERAH ARLOW

NEVE ARLOW

A character experienced with tailoring or armour fitting sees automatically that the coat was altered to preserve Serah's adult silhouette rather than fit Neve. Otherwise, a DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check reveals the hidden stiffening. On a failure, Mira Bell later exposes it when she turns out the lining.

The coat grants Neve Advantage on one check to coordinate a known Bellweather emergency procedure. Adults following a standard plan become reluctant to contradict her most recent signal unless new information appears, Neve releases command, or they succeed on a DC 11 Wisdom saving throw.

READ ALOUD

"People follow the signal faster when I look like Serah. That is useful during a fire. It is less useful when I am trying to tell them I am not Serah."

Dividing the Work

Neve asks the party to fill the duty board with functions before assigning names. Do not begin by asking who becomes the next Gate-Captain.

- Receive reports
- Verify uncertain information
- Sound local warnings
- Call a full evacuation
- Direct crowds
- Redirect animals and platforms
- Maintain equipment
- Keep current route records
- Teach new responders

Sabine can manage closures and platform movement. Orris can lead local night evacuation. Neve can teach advanced signals and coordinate a route-wide emergency if she chooses. A person may accept one duty without accepting the whole office.

Preparing the Exercise

Neve proposes three stages: conflicting reports, an inherited route that is no longer safe, and a missing child reported after evacuation begins. Establish who receives reports, issues immediate warnings, redirects people, coordinates a village-wide response, and keeps the wider system operating during a focused search.

Conflicting Reports

READ ALOUD

Two speaking tubes sound within seconds.

Sabine lifts the first. “Smoke near the Animal Lane. Source unknown.”

Orris calls from the western terrace. “Upper road blocked. One cart across the Procession route.”

Neve looks at the duty board.

She says nothing.

A sound response separates verification from immediate safety. Warn and move the Animal Lane while somebody verifies the smoke; close the upper road locally while another responder confirms an alternate route. No check is required when responsibilities are clear. If everything waits for Neve, she restarts this portion after the group adjusts assignments. Conflicting responders make a DC 12 group check using suitable social, investigative, or professional skills. A failure reveals one late handoff without causing injury.

The Unsafe Bridge

READ ALOUD

Three bells call for evacuation toward the western bridge.

Black flags already hang at both ends, marking it unsafe.

People begin moving toward it anyway. Serah’s oldest route cards still identify it as the nearest exit.

The party must replace the familiar direction with a current safe route using living guides, a route-change signal, reversed lanes, the alternate stairs, or another workable method.

READ ALOUD

Neve removes the old card. “The card is wrong now. That does not mean Serah was wrong then.”

Serah’s Bell Responds

READ ALOUD

Serah’s bell rings. A route card turns toward Neve. Fresh bronze letters appear:

GATE-CAPTAIN CONFIRMS ALL ROUTE CHANGES

The moving crowd slows. Everyone waits for her answer.

The party may invoke the duty board, current responder’s authority, the Circus Terms, or another clear record. If Neve retains final confirmation, establish who acts when she is absent.

The Missing Child

READ ALOUD

A runner delivers one small red glove.

“Child missing from the lower terrace. Last seen before the evacuation signal.”

Below, people are still moving toward the alternate exit. Several responders turn toward Neve.

The child is a wooden practice figure hidden beneath the Costume Platform stairs. The party assigns the description, last-known location, search, destination check, continuing evacuation, and authority to expand the search. If everybody abandons their post, Neve halts the exercise: “You found one missing person by creating a hundred unaccounted people.”

A searching character makes a DC 12 Wisdom (Perception or Survival) check. Success finds the figure immediately. Failure finds tracks after one additional search interval while the wider response must continue. Asking where frightened Bellweather children commonly hide grants Advantage.

Completing the Drill

READ ALOUD

The final rehearsal flag lowers. Route workers return the practice bells to silence. Nobody looks toward Neve for permission to finish.

One by one, responders report to the duty board.

Neve listens.

Then she erases her name from the only filled space.

Fill the board with accepted functions and names. Temporary duties receive explicit endings. Training does not automatically include command. Empty positions remain empty.

The Night Test

That evening, Neve remains at the circus field without her coat, bell, or signal equipment while a genuine minor problem occurs, such as a loose Animal Lane gate, blocked handcart, extinguished route lantern, or minor roof leak.

READ ALOUD

A civic warning bell gives one uncertain note.

At the circus field, Neve looks up from her supper.

She does not move.

Current responders should secure the problem, report it, and enter it on the duty board without summoning Neve. The player characters may prompt, identify missing information, or assist, but Neve does not resume sole command.

READ ALOUD

“If it failed, fix the handoff. Do not call the failure proof that I must do everything again.”

Refitting Serah’s Coat

READ ALOUD

Neve lays the coat across the costume-wagon table. Mira opens the lining and runs two fingers along the hidden stiffening.

“This was not altered to fit Neve,” she says.

“It was altered to keep Serah’s shape while Neve grew inside it.”

The coat may be preserved as Serah’s historical coat, retired to the Silent House, displayed at the Gate House, divided among several responders, or replaced with current equipment. If Neve still needs a coat, she asks for one fitted to her present role.

Neve’s Current Choice

After the drill and night test, Neve chooses one of the following or another outcome established in play.

Signal Instructor: Neve teaches and updates signals without standing emergency command.

Junior Route Warden: Neve inspects routes, trains responders, and may command locally while current adults hold wider civic responsibility. Junior must limit Bellweather's demands without dismissing her competence.

Shared Gate Council: Neve, Sabine, Orris, and other trained responders maintain the system together through shifts and defined duties.

Temporary Gate-Captain: Neve serves through the Procession under revised terms. The ending must be written as a date, final report, closing bell, or other objective event.

Full Withdrawal: Neve leaves the signal office after the current team demonstrates safe coverage. Delay cannot be treated as proof she must remain.

Completing Neve's Record

Record Neve's emergency acceptance during the Eastern Road collapse, Bellweather's conversion of it into permanent sole authority, her present choice, and the demonstrated current signal system.

Procession Preparation

Choose one: Shared Signal lets named responders act without one inherited authority; Truthful Courage permits a leader to admit uncertainty without surrender; Open Route redirects one platform, crowd, animal lane, or ceremony away from inherited danger; End-of-Service Bell publicly ends one temporary role without replacement.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Tovin places Serah's original record beside the new one.

I WILL CARRY SERAH'S SIGNALS UNTIL EVERYONE IS SAFE.

Beneath it, he writes:

THE EASTERN ROAD EMERGENCY ENDED.

He turns to Neve. "State what you choose now."

Neve gives the answer established with the party. Tovin records it exactly.

Serah's memorial bell rings once.

This time, no adult waits for Neve to explain what the sound means.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

Neve's current role The selected Procession Preparation Record Serah's coat only if it will appear during the Procession.

Scene 10: The Reeve's Second Judgment

If the party chooses Tovin Marr's Succession Record, he asks them to return to Civic Hall as witnesses. Bellweather has inserted a current judgment into an old precedent preserved through Halwen Marr's bell. Tovin wants the characters to establish the facts and challenge the inherited reasoning. He remains responsible for issuing the present ruling.

Approaching Civic Hall

READ ALOUD

The long civic hall overlooks the work court beside the Procession road. The damaged drain has been bridged with heavy planks, and the Procession platform now stands clear of the wall.

Inside, clerks have placed three ledgers on separate tables. Halwen Marr's memorial bell occupies a padded bracket behind the central desk.

Meren Vale waits with a bundle of deeds. Davos Kerren has brought the box of nails, receipts, and old timber.

Tovin stands behind neither household.

He has placed the Reeve's chair at the side of the room.

Tovin explains that Halwen's bell keeps moving the chair back behind the central desk. He moves it aside again before beginning.

Tovin's Original Acceptance

READ ALOUD

I, TOVIN MARR, ACCEPT CUSTODY OF HALWEN MARR'S CIVIC PRECEDENTS, COMPLETION OF THE PENDING WINTER PETITIONS, AND RESPONSIBILITY FOR LEARNING THE REEVE'S RECORDS.

I ACCEPT THE OFFICE OF ACTING REEVE UNTIL BELLWEATHER APPOINTS OR ELECTS A CURRENT REEVE UNDER LIVING LAW.

The appointment occurred after Halwen died unexpectedly during a winter illness. Tovin completed the named petitions. Bellweather later recorded each new judgment made using Halwen's precedents as continuation of Halwen's office. When Bellweather elected Tovin as current Reeve, the central record changed the title but did not transfer final authority away from Halwen's preserved judgment.

READ ALOUD

"I wanted the records because they contain decisions Bellweather still needs to understand," Tovin says. "I did not agree that every current problem must end where Halwen ended a different one."

The Vale-Kerren Dispute

Meren Vale seeks an irrigation reroute after repeated flooding. Davos Kerren objects that it shifts risk to his orchard and invokes Halwen Marr's precedent. Both have valid evidence; Tovin must issue a present order rather than discover a secretly wrong household.

The old precedent protected Kerren's boundary under an earlier channel, rainfall pattern, and crossing. The full record and route findings show later repairs altered the flow. Combine those facts with current measurements, maintenance records, witnesses, and the party's inspection. Halwen's reconstruction may explain the earlier reasoning but cannot approve the new order.

Tovin's draft names current evidence, safeguards, responsibility, review, ending, and signer. Possible amendments include staged work, shared inspection, temporary barriers, rainfall review, and divided costs. Vale accepts a slower remedy that addresses flooding; Kerren accepts review and safeguards. Remove any clause requiring Halwen's approval. The party may narrow the order but should not decide for Tovin without a lawful transfer of responsibility.

The Second Judgment

Tovin writes or revises the ruling in his own hand. Read or paraphrase its terms, including the choices established by the players. Then he signs.

READ ALOUD

Tovin places the pen beneath the final line.

“This judgment uses Halwen Marr’s precedent,” he says.

“It considers the evidence presented by Meren Vale, Davos Kerren, Bellweather’s route workers, and the Lantern Circus.”

“It is not Halwen’s judgment.”

“The responsibility for it is mine.”

He signs:

TOVIN MARR, CURRENT REEVE

Halwen’s bell rings. The impossible confirmation line darkens, then changes to PRECEDENT CONSULTED: HALWEN MARR. The signature remains Tovin’s.

If Tovin Refuses to Sign

The players cannot sign as Bellweather’s Reeve. Meren and Davos may reach a private agreement, and Bellweather can repair its damage, but Tovin’s Succession Record remains incomplete. Ask what evidence, protection, or limitation he still lacks. If the party supplies a reasonable answer, he signs. If he continues hiding behind uncertainty after every material concern is addressed, Halwen’s bell says current judgment withheld. Tovin recognises the phrase as his choice, not Halwen’s.

Destroying Halwen’s Bell

Destroying the bell removes Halwen’s reconstructed voice and preserved access to numerous civic precedents. Existing written records survive, but connections among earlier rulings, spoken reasons never fully transcribed, and recurring factual patterns may be lost. Tovin does not consent to destruction while he remains custodian unless the party establishes immediate danger that cannot be contained another way.

READ ALOUD

“I need the precedents,” Tovin says. “I do not need them wearing my office.”

Tovin’s Current Choice

Tovin chooses to remain Reeve if the current record clearly places final present judgment with the living officeholder. Halwen’s bell may identify precedent, explain historical reasoning, reveal contradictions, and preserve institutional memory. It may not issue, confirm, veto, or sign current judgments.

If the party argues for a council or review panel, Tovin accepts living review procedures. He rejects any arrangement pretending shared responsibility means nobody is answerable for the final order.

Completing Tovin’s Record

Record Tovin’s temporary acceptance, Bellweather’s continuation of Halwen’s judicial authority, Tovin’s living responsibility for current judgments, and the Vale-Kerren order that demonstrates the new procedure.

Procession Preparation

Choose one: Second Judgment replaces one inherited ruling after current evidence and authority are named; Named Responsibility permits a living decision-maker to accept one uncertain choice; Precedent Ledger separates historical fact, prior reasoning, and current decision; Review Clause gives a current arrangement a future review or ending without invalidating it now.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

The new judgment lies open beside Halwen's old precedent.

Neither document erases the other.

Meren takes one certified copy. Davos takes another. Sabine takes the route order describing Bellweather's repair obligations.

Tovin returns the Reeve's chair behind the current desk.

Halwen's memorial bell remains on its separate stand.

For the first time since the hearing began, it does not move the chair.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

Tovin's current choice and the selected Procession Preparation. The detailed Vale–Kerren property terms do not require campaign tracking unless the players created a continuing relationship with either household.

Scene 11: The Silent House

Caldris Fen's Succession Record begins in the Silent House and concludes beyond Bellweather in Scene 12. Scene 11 establishes the documentary evidence, the people harmed during the attempted severance, Lor Aven's completed musical work, and Bellweather's decision to remove the eastern road from the public record.

Completing this scene alone does not complete Caldris's Record. The party must still meet Caldris and hear their present choice.

Approaching the Silent House

READ ALOUD

The Silent House stands behind a low stone wall interrupted by open gates. Covered galleries surround several garden courts. No bell hangs above the entrance.

Hundreds of brass plates cover the outer wall. Some bear names. Others identify offices, unfinished books, abandoned performances, retired tools, promises nobody chose to carry, and work preserved without a successor.

The plates do not ring.

Elsin Crow waits beside the open door.

"Nothing in this house becomes available merely because you ask to see it," she says.

"If the record concerns Caldris, I will show what is necessary to establish what Bellweather did. Private work remains private unless its owner released it."

Elsin asks the characters to state what they seek. A broad request for everything does not offend her, but she narrows access to the succession, attempted severance, public Procession records, Lor's released music, and testimony voluntarily entered by affected people.

Elsin's Rules

- Objects remain with their current custodians unless those custodians consent to movement.
- Unfinished work is not an invitation to finish it.
- Refused succession is not failed succession.
- Private letters and music remain private unless their owner released them.
- The harmed speak for their own experience.

READ ALOUD

"The Silent House preserves decisions Bellweather does not know how to celebrate," Elsin says. "That does not make those decisions incomplete."

The Hall of Useful Things

READ ALOUD

The first gallery resembles a workshop stripped of any single craft. Tools rest on low stands beside ledgers, folded uniforms, music cases, keys, masks, measuring rods, route flags, and bells without harnesses.

Each object bears two plates.

The upper plate names what it was.

The lower plate states what it is now.

Use three examples to establish the House's purpose: a midwife's case preserved for training with NO SUCCESSOR REQUIRED; a bridge key retained as HISTORY, NOT AUTHORITY; and a performer's mask marked OWNER RELEASED FOR DISPLAY, NOT PERFORMANCE.

A character examining the arrangement sees that Bellweather can preserve knowledge and objects without maintaining an active office. No check is required. This is important evidence for the final settlement.

The Gallery of Unfinished Work

READ ALOUD

The next gallery contains half-carved figures, incomplete ledgers, unwritten title plates, instruments lacking strings, and canvases turned toward the wall.

Nothing is arranged as though waiting for a hand.

A long brass strip above the entrance reads:

UNFINISHED DOES NOT MEAN UNCLAIMED

Elsin explains that Bellweather once treated unfinished work as a vacancy. The Silent House now distinguishes work open to invitation, work whose creator intends to resume it, work deliberately abandoned, and work preserved only so its history is not rewritten.

If the party established an Unfinished Place during Scene 4, its physical language is already spreading through this gallery. Elsin credits the living people who made that distinction.

The Room Without Successors

READ ALOUD

Thirteen low stands form an open circle.

Some hold objects. Others hold only plates. Three remain entirely empty.

No place in the circle is treated as more important than another.

At the centre stands a plain wooden lectern bearing the words:

A RECORD MAY END HERE

Examples include a retired office whose practical work moved to a council, a family bell returned to ordinary household use, and a craft succession completed when its knowledge entered public training. The empty stands remain available for future endings but are not vacancies seeking occupants.

READ ALOUD

“Bellweather remembers continuance more easily than completion,” Elsin says. “This room exists so completion has somewhere visible to stand.”

The Memorial Garden

Beyond the galleries lies a small garden containing stones, plants, ordinary grave markers, and several memorial bells mounted without bearer plates. The garden confirms that remembrance does not require active succession.

Ressa Dorn and Tomas Pell wait here if they agreed to speak. Corra Leth joins them if the party’s earlier conduct showed respect for consent and evidence. They were injured or endangered during the attempt to sever Caldris from Lor’s bell.

Ressa Dorn

READ ALOUD

Ressa’s left hand rests inside a leather support. Two fingers remain stiff.

“I agreed to play the severance interval,” she says. “I was told it would separate Caldris’s living variation from Lor’s preserved score.”

She looks toward the Silent House.

“I was not told Bellweather might answer through every connected instrument.”

Ressa’s hand was caught when the instrument’s strings tightened and the frame twisted. She does not blame Caldris for refusing the succession. She blames Bellweather’s officials, including herself, for treating the ritual as a technical problem after Caldris had already said no.

READ ALOUD

“We kept asking how to make the refusal hold,” Ressa says. “We should have asked why Bellweather believed it could overrule the refusal at all.”

Tomas Pell

Tomas served as a foundry technician during the severance. He prepared the dampening clamps and disconnected two civic bells. When the network rerouted through the music hall, one clamp fractured and pieces of bronze struck his shoulder and face. His injuries healed, but he lost part of the hearing in his right ear.

READ ALOUD

“The equipment did what we designed it to do,” Tomas says. “The system found another path because the record still said successor.”

Tomas can identify which bell connections were disabled and prove that the failure was not caused by Caldris secretly cooperating with the network.

Corra Leth

Corra was the junior clerk assigned to document the event. The official report says Caldris abandoned the severance before completion. Corra's private notes show that officials halted the ritual after injuries occurred and Caldris demanded everyone leave the hall.

READ ALOUD

"Caldris did not abandon us," Corra says. "Caldris ended the procedure because we were hurt."

Corra preserved the notes because the final report changed responsibility from Bellweather's failed procedure to Caldris's departure. She releases them for this investigation and asks that her correction be attached to the public record.

Requesting the Closed Music Room

After the party has heard at least two witnesses or established the report discrepancy, Elsin permits access to the Closed Music Room. She asks whether the group wants Alden or Tovin present. Neither is required. Maelin may attend as a musical expert, but she does not control Caldris's record.

READ ALOUD

Elsin unlocks a bronze-bound door at the end of the inner gallery.

"No memorial bell crosses this threshold without the custodian named in its record," she says.

"No music is performed until we establish who authorised it."

The Closed Music Room

READ ALOUD

Dust lies evenly across the floor except for a narrow path to the central table.

Lor Aven's memorial bell rests inside a glass-fronted cabinet. It is exactly 10 inches high, mounted in a fitted blackwood frame. Its plates read:

LOR AVEN: COMPOSER AND CONDUCTOR

SUCCESSION ACCEPTED: CALDRIS FEN

WORK CONTINUES

On the table lies a bound score. The final page is open.

The music ends.

Beneath the final bar, Lor wrote one word:

COMPLETE

The room also contains Caldris's acceptance record, the failed-severance report, route plans showing the eastern road before removal, and a sealed invitation written by Caldris after leaving Bellweather.

The Original Acceptance

READ ALOUD

I, CALDRIS FEN, ACCEPT LOR AVEN'S PROCESSION MUSIC, THE CONDUCTOR'S MARKS NECESSARY TO PERFORM IT, AND CUSTODY OF THE BELL UNTIL THE THIRTEENTH PROCESSION IS COMPLETE.

I ACCEPT RESPONSIBILITY FOR TEACHING THE MUSIC TO A LIVING ENSEMBLE SO THAT NO SINGLE SUCCESSOR IS REQUIRED AFTER ME.

The thirteenth Procession occurred three years ago. Caldris conducted it. The ensemble learned the full work. Lor's score was completed and performed. Under the written terms, the succession should have ended.

The Correct Authorship

Several later passages were composed by Caldris while completing transitions Lor left open. The public score credits them as Lor Aven, completed through successor Caldris Fen. Private working pages identify Caldris's authorship clearly.

A character proficient with a musical instrument sees the different compositional hands automatically. Otherwise, a DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) or Charisma (Performance) check distinguishes Lor's established notation from Caldris's later transitions. On a failure, Maelin or another living musician demonstrates the difference without withholding the conclusion.

READ ALOUD

Elsin turns the public score and the working pages side by side.

"Bellweather preserved the completed work," she says.

"It preserved the wrong completion."

The Failed Severance

The severance procedure attempted to remove Caldris's bearer relationship while retaining the completed score, Lor's reconstruction, and Bellweather's ability to stage the Procession. The ritual treated Caldris as a damaged connection rather than a person whose agreed term had ended.

The party can establish four facts without a roll: Caldris had already fulfilled the written succession; Caldris repeatedly requested closure; officials designed the severance because Bellweather continued ringing Lor's bell through Caldris; and Bellweather rerouted through connected instruments after two civic links were dampened.

A DC 12 Intelligence (Arcana) check identifies that the ritual failed because the civic record still classified Caldris as active successor. On a failure, Tomas's equipment diagram and Corra's notes reveal the same conclusion after comparison.

Lor's Bell

Lor's bell preserves the complete Procession score, conducting patterns, rehearsal decisions, historical performances, Lor's remarks, and musical relationships among route stations. It also preserves Bellweather's mistaken claim that the work remains active through Caldris.

If questioned, Lor's reconstructed voice says the work is complete, the ensemble carries it, Caldris completed necessary transitions, and Procession music must have a conductor. When asked whether Caldris must remain that conductor, it answers continuity requires recognised direction. When asked whether another living ensemble can choose its current direction, the bell rings but does not answer.

Caldris's Invitation

READ ALOUD

TO ANYONE BELLWEATHER SENDS AFTER ME:

COME WITHOUT A MEMORIAL BELL.

COME WITHOUT AN ORDER OF RETURN.

BRING THE ORIGINAL ACCEPTANCE, THE FINAL SCORE, AND THE NAMES OF EVERYONE

HURT WHEN BELLWEATHER TRIED TO MAKE MY REFUSAL TECHNICAL.

IF YOU WANT MY CURRENT ANSWER, ASK ME WHERE I LIVE NOW.

CALDRIS FEN

The invitation is not a request for rescue. It establishes terms for contact. Elsin has respected them. Bellweather has not sent anyone because its official record labels Caldris absent and the eastern route closed.

What Becomes Public

The party decides which evidence must enter the public succession record. The minimum complete record includes the original ending condition; proof the thirteenth Procession occurred; Caldris's authorship; the names and testimony of those harmed who consent to inclusion; the fact that officials halted the procedure; and Caldris's current invitation terms.

Private drafts, unrelated music, witness medical details, and correspondence remain protected unless their owners release them. Corra's corrected notes should replace, not merely sit beneath, the false statement that Caldris abandoned the procedure.

Seeking Caldris

Elsin can provide the eastern route to the abandoned lime kilns where Caldris now lives. The road is passable on foot and by a light cart but unsuitable for circus wagons. Travel takes several hours. If the party leaves now, proceed directly to Scene 12.

If the party postpones the journey, seal the necessary evidence in a current case bearing no succession plate. When they return, do not repeat this investigation. Restate only the original terms, completed thirteenth Procession, correct authorship, failed severance, invitation, and requirement to arrive without a memorial bell or order of return.

The Eastern Gate

READ ALOUD

The eastern gate stands open.

Beyond it, the road continues between low stone walls and pale grasses.

No civic bell hangs above the arch. The mounting frame remains, but the bell and its plate have been removed.

A newer stone beside the road reads:

ROUTE CLOSED AFTER UNSUCCESSFUL SUCCESSION EVENT

Corra places a copy of her corrected report over the inscription.

Elsin says, "The road was not unsuccessful."

"Bellweather was."

Proceed directly to Scene 12 if the party travels now. Scene 11 has no separate Carry Forward section because the two scenes together form one Succession Record.

Scene 12: The Road Beyond the Bells

The party follows Caldris Fen's invitation beyond Bellweather. They must arrive without Lor Aven's memorial bell and without an order requiring Caldris to return. The journey demonstrates that

Bellweather did not merely lose a successor. It removed an occupied life from its visible route because that life no longer fit the preserved Procession.

This scene completes the Succession Record begun in Scene 11.

Leaving Bellweather

READ ALOUD

The eastern road begins beneath an empty bell frame.

For the first mile, stone walls border fields and small orchards. Then the walls fall away. Pale grass moves across open hills, interrupted by chalk outcrops and the remains of old lime workings.

No civic bell answers behind you.

The farther you travel, the more ordinary the road becomes.

Elsin provides a current map and Caldris's invitation. Corra may accompany the party if invited, but she does not speak for Caldris. Alden and Tovin remain in Bellweather unless the players specifically ask one of them to come and Caldris's terms are still respected.

If somebody carries Lor's bell secretly, Elsin discovers it before departure unless the characters deliberately conceal it from her. If the bell reaches Caldris, Caldris ends the meeting and asks the party to return without it. This is a boundary, not a test to circumvent.

The Empty Haulage Cart

READ ALOUD

An old two-wheeled haulage cart stands beside the road. One shaft rests on the ground. The cart bed contains fresh-cut firewood covered by canvas and weighted with white stones.

A narrow plank sign reads:

FOR THE UPPER KILN HOUSE

LEAVE THE CART

The cart proves somebody lives ahead and receives ordinary support from nearby households. It is not abandoned. Moving it is harmless if the party returns it to the same place. Taking the firewood would deprive Caldris of the delivery.

The Lower Quarry Yard

READ ALOUD

The road enters a broad quarry yard enclosed by chalk cliffs. Roofless sheds and broken kilns line the outer wall. Rainwater fills several extraction pits.

Someone has repaired one shed with timber and slate. A vegetable garden occupies a former ash bed. Laundry hangs beneath the repaired roof.

A line of small clay bells hangs beside the door.

None contains a clapper.

The clay bells are wind markers and decorations. They carry no Bellweather magic. Their silence is deliberate but not hostile.

A current footpath climbs toward an upper kiln. A broader lower road continues toward an abandoned music hall partially cut into the cliff. Caldris lives above. The lower road is Bellweather's approach and has not been used in years.

Choosing the Upper Route

Following the footpath respects the signs of present life. It passes the garden, water barrels, repaired retaining steps, and a small work shelter containing paper, reeds, binding cord, and instrument tools.

A character examining the route sees evidence of a working household rather than exile: recent repairs, traded goods, maintained drainage, and several marked walking paths leading toward outlying farms. No check is required.

The Lower Kiln Road

If the party takes the old Procession road, it passes abandoned stands where Bellweather once mounted route bells. Their brackets remain, but every bell and plate has been removed. The road ends at a music hall whose doors are chained from outside.

A DC 11 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Survival) check establishes that nobody regularly enters. On a failure, the undisturbed dust and rusted chain reveal the same fact after closer inspection. The hall represents the life Bellweather expected Caldris to continue, not where Caldris lives now.

READ ALOUD

A hand-painted sign hangs across the chained doors:

THIS IS NOT MY HOUSE

The upper footpath can be reached from here without penalty.

Caldris Fen

READ ALOUD

The upper kiln has been rebuilt into a narrow house and open workroom. One wall follows the curve of the old brick furnace. The opposite side opens beneath a timber awning toward the valley.

Reed pipes, hand drums, strings, clay vessels, and bound scores occupy shelves beside practical tools. No object is arranged as a memorial.

A person stands at the worktable fitting a reed into a wooden pipe. Their dark hair is cut close on one side and tied back on the other. A pale scar crosses the base of the throat and disappears beneath the collar.

Caldris looks first at your hands, then at the cases and packs you carry.

"Did you bring Lor's bell?"

If the answer is no, Caldris asks whether the party carries an order requiring return. If the answer is also no, Caldris invites them beneath the awning. If either answer is yes, Caldris asks the party to remove that condition before the conversation continues.

Caldris uses they/them pronouns. They are direct without being needlessly hostile. They have built a life outside Bellweather and do not need the party to persuade them that leaving was justified.

Inside the Kiln

READ ALOUD

The old furnace opening now serves as a hearth. Its brick arch has been repaired but not hidden.

Scores hang from clips along one wall beside work lists, recipes, letters, and local route maps. Several pages contain music. Others record kiln temperatures, rainfall, planting dates, and names of neighbours who borrowed tools.

A large table occupies the centre of the room. Every chair is different.

Caldris gestures toward them.

“Sit where you choose.”

Caldris offers water, tea, or bread if the meeting remains respectful. The room contains no secret cult, hidden bell workshop, or plan to destroy Bellweather. It is an ordinary home built around a former kiln and a living practice that includes, but is not limited to, music.

Caldris Hears the Evidence

Present the evidence from Scene 11. Caldris listens most closely for the original ending condition, acknowledgement that the thirteenth Procession occurred, correct authorship of the completed transitions, names of people harmed, correction of the official report, and recognition that the severance failed because Bellweather still classified Caldris as successor.

READ ALOUD

When the party finishes, Caldris asks, “Whose record is that now?”

The correct answer need not use those exact words. The party should establish that the record concerns Caldris, was assembled with testimony from living witnesses, and will not become Bellweather’s authority over Caldris without consent. If the party says it belongs to Bellweather, Caldris asks what prevents the village from rewriting the ending again.

What Caldris Knows

- Lor’s Procession score was complete after the thirteenth performance.
- Caldris composed several transitions credited publicly to Lor.
- The living ensemble could perform the complete work without Caldris before the severance.
- Bellweather continued to ring Lor’s call through Caldris during unrelated music.
- Caldris requested closure five times in writing.
- Officials proposed the severance only after refusing to record completion.
- Caldris stopped the ritual when people were hurt.
- The eastern route was removed after Caldris left, not before.

Caldris provides copies of the five closure requests. These confirm persistence but do not add another mystery.

What Caldris Believes

Caldris believes Bellweather’s central mistake was treating continuity as more important than the terms under which continuity was accepted. They do not believe every bell should be destroyed. Lor’s preserved score and teaching methods remain valuable. They believe Bellweather must learn that a completed succession can become history without becoming failure.

READ ALOUD

“Lor asked me to carry the music to a living ensemble,” Caldris says. “I did.”

“Bellweather heard the living ensemble and decided that proved the succession should continue.”

“It turned success into the reason I could never finish.”

What Caldris Withholds

Caldris does not initially reveal whether they will participate in the Procession. They first need to know what Bellweather intends to record, whether the harmed will be named accurately, and whether entering the route would reactivate Lor's claim.

Caldris also withholds one new composition. It is private and unfinished. The characters have no right to hear it merely because it might help Bellweather. Caldris may later offer a brief living variation if their boundaries are respected.

Likely Player Approaches

An apology is welcome when it identifies actual harm and does not demand forgiveness. Caldris rejects apologies offered as a substitute for correction.

READ ALOUD

"I do not need Bellweather to feel terrible," Caldris says. "I need it to stop writing me into a job I completed."

Promises that everything will be fixed are met with questions about mechanism, witnesses, public record, and what happens if the Keeper refuses. Caldris values concrete safeguards over confidence.

Requests to return home are corrected: this kiln house is Caldris's home. Bellweather may remain part of their history without being the place where they live.

Offers to destroy Lor's bell are refused as an assumed solution. Caldris does not hold custody of the bell and does not believe freedom requires destroying the completed score or Lor's useful teaching record.

Claims that Lor would release Caldris are rejected as unverifiable. The written agreement and completed terms are sufficient.

The Failed Severance

READ ALOUD

Caldris touches the scar at the base of their throat.

"The severance did not feel like cutting a cord," they say.

"It felt like Bellweather pulling every version of the music through the same opening at once."

"When Ressa's instrument twisted, I stopped conducting."

"When Tomas was struck, I told everyone to leave."

"The report called that abandonment because Bellweather needed the ritual to be incomplete."

The scar resulted from a bronze conducting chain tightening during the surge. Caldris survived without lasting magical impairment. The injury matters as evidence of harm, not as a hidden curse requiring removal.

Lor's Bell and the Completed Work

Caldris wants Lor's bell moved from active succession to historical and educational custody. The complete score may remain available to living ensembles. Lor's reconstructed remarks may be consulted. Neither the bell nor the score should appoint a current conductor.

The living ensemble should choose conductors for each performance. Caldris's transitions must be credited under Caldris's name. Future variations must be credited to their current creators.

READ ALOUD

"If the music needs one dead conductor forever," Caldris says, "then it is not living music."

Caldris's Present Choice

Caldris states the following unless play establishes a more specific version.

- The succession to Lor ended with the thirteenth Procession.
- Caldris does not accept Lor's office, title, or permanent authority.
- Caldris retains authorship of the transitions they composed.
- The completed score may remain available to Bellweather's living ensemble.
- Lor's bell may remain preserved without an active bearer.
- Caldris chooses whether to visit Bellweather, perform, teach, or remain away on each future occasion.
- The eastern road must remain a real road rather than a route Bellweather erases when somebody leaves.

Returning or Remaining Outside

Caldris may enter Bellweather for the settlement if the party can guarantee that Lor's bell remains in the Silent House, no plate identifies Caldris as successor, the corrected record is read before any invitation to perform, the harmed may speak or decline to speak, and Caldris may leave immediately without the route closing behind them.

Caldris may instead remain outside. In that case, the party carries a signed present statement. Elsin or Corra can read it publicly. Caldris's absence is not evidence that the record remains incomplete.

If the players pressure Caldris to attend because public impact would be stronger, Caldris answers:

READ ALOUD

"Then Bellweather still believes my body is required to make my words valid."

A Living Variation

If the party consistently respected Caldris's boundaries and corrected the record, Caldris offers one optional contribution. They play or teach a short current phrase written after leaving Bellweather. It is not Lor's answer, not part of the completed score, and not a new succession.

READ ALOUD

The phrase begins with one interval Bellweather would recognise.

Then it leaves the expected resolution and settles into a quieter rhythm shaped by breath, footfall, and the hollow curve of the kiln.

Caldris stops after eight measures.

"That is all Bellweather may have," they say.

"For this Procession."

If carried into the Procession under Caldris's name and current terms, the phrase can become a Living Act. Caldris retains authorship whether present or absent.

The Eastern Road

Caldris asks the party to correct the road marker before they leave. A replacement plate is already prepared:

READ ALOUD

EASTERN ROAD

TO THE UPPER KILNS, OUTLYING FARMS, AND ROADS BEYOND BELLWEATHER

NO SUCCESSION REQUIRED

Installing it is ordinary physical work. Caldris does not ask the party to remove Bellweather's history, only the false claim that the route ended because succession failed.

Procession Preparation

Choose one preparation arising from Caldris's completed Record.

Completed Work: One apparently unfinished role, score, or obligation can be publicly recognised as complete. Bellweather does not search for another bearer.

Living Ensemble: A group may carry one inherited function together without creating a single successor or permanent conductor.

Corrected Harm Record: One false account that blames refusal, withdrawal, or interruption can be replaced by living testimony and evidence.

Open Eastern Road: A person may leave the Procession, Bellweather, or an inherited position without the route closing or the act counting as abandonment.

Completing Caldris's Record

Complete the Record with the original ending condition, proof of the thirteenth Procession, correct authorship, accurate severance account, testimony included by consent, Caldris's present choice, Lor's historical status, and the eastern road's current purpose. Caldris's signed statement needs no Bellweather confirmation.

Choose one Procession Preparation: Completed Work recognises one role, score, or obligation as complete; Living Ensemble lets a group carry one inherited function without a single successor; Corrected Harm Record replaces one false account with evidence and consented testimony; Open Eastern Road lets somebody leave without abandonment or a closing route.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

The replacement road plate settles into the old mounting frame beneath the eastern gate.

Bellweather's valley lies behind you. The road toward the kiln hills remains open ahead.

For a moment, nothing rings.

Then a small civic bell somewhere beyond the gate gives one uncertain note.

It does not call Caldris back.

It marks the road.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

Caldris's present choice Whether Caldris will attend the Procession Whether a Living Variation was offered The selected Procession Preparation Lor's bell remains in the Silent House unless its lawful current custodian later decides otherwise.

Scene 13: What the Circus Is Offered

After the party completes three Succession Records, Bellweather turns its attention fully toward the player characters. The road offered each character an inherited association before they entered the village. The completed investigations have now taught the bells enough to make more specific offers.

These offers should tempt without becoming compulsory. Each offers a useful benefit during the remaining adventure and attaches one mistaken expectation. The player decides what the bell recognised, what it misunderstood, and what the character chooses now.

Bellweather Waits Outside

READ ALOUD

Evening gathers around the circus field. Supper fires burn between the wagons, and the Central Lantern hangs above the company's familiar circle.

Beyond the boundary stakes, Bellweather's nearest road bells remain silent.

Alden waits outside the field with a narrow wooden case.

He carries no Speaker's plate and no memorial bell.

"The Keeper has made offers to your company," he says.

"I asked that they be delivered here, under your boundary, rather than placed among your belongings."

Alden does not enter until invited. The case contains one small bell for each player character. It contains no bell for a circus NPC unless the players previously invited Bellweather to make one.

If the party refuses delivery, Alden leaves the closed case outside the boundary. The characters can continue to Scene 14 without opening it. Bellweather does not place replacement bells secretly inside the camp.

Opening the Case

READ ALOUD

The wooden lid lifts.

Small bronze bells rest in separate padded spaces. Each belongs to the same family as the bells encountered on the road, but the plates are no longer turned away.

Each plate bears a name, title, symbol, or phrase chosen for one of you.

Beneath every bell lies a second blank plate.

Present the bells one at a time. Ask the player whether their character handles the bell personally, has somebody else lift it, examines it without contact, or leaves it in the case. Touching the bell does not accept the offer.

Creating the Offers

Build each offer from information the player already introduced and events witnessed during the adventure. Do not invent private history. The offer should contain three elements: a truth Bellweather recognised, a benefit useful during the remaining module, and an expectation extending that truth beyond what the character agreed to carry.

Use the following patterns or create another fitting offer.

The Protector

Choose or adapt one pattern. Each has a recognised truth, a once-per-Long-Rest benefit, and a disclosed mistaken expectation.

Protector: Reaction when a creature within 10 feet takes damage; move 10 feet and grant Resistance to that damage. Expectation: leaving danger is abandonment. Witness: after a factual claim, gain

Advantage on one Insight, Investigation, or History check testing it. Expectation: remain until every dispute is resolved.

Current Voice: name the current decision-maker or creator so one willing creature within 30 feet rerolls a failed save against inherited command or movement. Expectation: speak whenever others are uncertain. Keeper of Open Places: protect one empty 5-foot space within 30 feet until the next turn. Expectation: accept every unresolved role or object.

Breaker of Patterns: after repetition, use a Reaction to grant Advantage on the next check or save made to alter it. Expectation: oppose even useful tradition. Bearer Who Chooses: add 1d6 to one attack, check, or save using the Inheritance Tie. Expectation: public use confirms the whole inherited role.

Shared Hand: when taking Help, the aided creature may move 5 feet without provoking. Expectation: helping owns the result. One Who Ends Things: declare a completed temporary duty ended; the creature gains Advantage on its next save against extension. Expectation: decide when others' duties end.

Presenting an Offer

READ ALOUD

The bell turns toward its intended character.

The first plate states what Bellweather believes the character carries.

The blank plate begins to write the benefit.

A second line forms beneath it.

The line does not describe a gift.

It describes what Bellweather expects in return.

Read the truth, benefit, and expectation plainly. Do not conceal the expectation as a trap. The characters have already negotiated Magical Disclosure.

READ ALOUD

Ask the player:

"What has Bellweather understood correctly?"

"What has it mistaken for a permanent obligation?"

"What does your character choose now?"

Accepting

A character may accept both the benefit and expectation. Record the bell's terms exactly. Acceptance does not force the player to portray feelings or beliefs not stated. The expectation operates as a role-playing and magical pressure during the Procession, not as loss of character control.

Revising

A character may accept the benefit while changing or refusing the expectation. Ask the player to state the boundary in direct language. Examples include:

- I protect people, but I decide when another position is safer.
- I preserve testimony, but I do not own every dispute.
- I can speak, but I do not answer for people who are present.
- I protect empty places; I do not become custodian of every unfinished thing.
- I interrupt harmful patterns; I am not required to reject useful traditions.

- I use this inheritance without accepting the whole office.
- Helping somebody does not make their work mine.
- I can recognise completion without deciding it for others.

Write a shortened version on the blank plate. The benefit remains. During the Procession, the character may receive a Living Act by demonstrating the stated boundary in practice.

Refusing

A character may refuse the benefit, expectation, or entire association. The plate turns outward and records REFUSED BY CURRENT CHOICE, or the player's preferred language. The bell does not search for somebody else.

A refused personal bell can remain in the case, travel as an ordinary record under agreed custody, return to Bellweather, be destroyed after likely knowledge loss is disclosed, or remain visibly unclaimed. Refusal does not weaken the party during the climax.

Testing

A character may test the bell before deciding. The DM may allow one safe use of the benefit during a controlled demonstration. Testing does not create acceptance. Bellweather may state the expectation again after the test, but the player chooses whether the character accepts any term.

Destroying the bell during a test removes the magical focus. It does not erase the character's actual choices or history. Tell the player if it would also remove a useful association or record before destruction occurs.

Postponing

A character may no present answer. Record POSTPONED BY CURRENT CHOICE. The bell provides no benefit and exerts no expectation. Silence does not become acceptance. The character may answer later during Scene 15 or the Procession.

The Unclaimed Bell

If the Unclaimed Bell remains with the circus, place it beside the case on its low padded stand. It receives no automatic title. Bellweather does not treat it as the party leader's bell or reserve successor.

The party may give it one present purpose for the Procession, such as sounding the halt signal, marking an intentionally open position, carrying a changeable musical measure, or witnessing the end of temporary service. State who holds physical custody. Custody creates no office or succession.

Optional Circus Offers

Do not create offers for circus NPCs unless the players invite them or an NPC explicitly asks. If this occurs, keep the focus on the characters' response and the NPC's own answer.

Silas might be offered permanent Ringmaster of the Lantern Circus. He refuses any term preventing the circus from changing leadership.

Mira might be offered Keeper of Unfinished Costumes. She accepts only practical costume safety during the Procession, with a written ending.

Old Fen might be offered Custodian of the Travelling Answer. He refuses ownership of a piece meant to change with its players.

Pippa receives no default offer. If a player specifically asks Bellweather whether it recognised her musical authorship, the corrected score answers under her chosen credit. Do not make her the module's hidden successor or central target.

Preparing a Living Act

After answering, ask each player to describe one action that would demonstrate the character's current boundary during the Procession. The action is a possibility, not a required script. Examples include leaving a protected position after arranging a safe handoff, refusing to answer for another

person, changing a repeated phrase, sharing work, ending a temporary duty, or leaving an offered role empty.

Record the idea in one short phrase beside the bell disposition. The player may perform a different Living Act later.

The Case Afterward

Alden asks where the case and any unanswered bells should remain. The circus may retain it, return it to Bellweather, divide custody, or place it beyond the boundary under guard. No answer is privileged.

READ ALOUD

When the final bell is answered, refused, or postponed, Bellweather's road bells give a scattered response.

No two notes are identical.

The central bell does not join them.

Alden closes the wooden case only after the party tells him what belongs inside.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Night settles around the circus field.

Beyond the boundary, Bellweather's lights climb the terraces toward the silent central bell.

Inside the company's circle, the personal bells rest where their owners or custodians placed them. Some remain open. Some are covered. Some are gone.

The Central Lantern burns above all of them without answering.

The party completes a Long Rest. Proceed to Scene 14 the following morning.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

For each player character, record only: Also record the Unclaimed Bell's present purpose and physical custodian, if any. Do not add private character information not supplied by the player.

CARRY FORWARD

Bell disposition | Benefit, if accepted | Boundary or expectation | Possible Living Act

Scene 14: The Procession Principles

The morning after Bellweather makes its offers, Alden asks the party to help turn the completed Succession Records into public rules for the Procession. The village has corrected individual cases before. It has never required every bell, office, route crew, and civic record to follow the same living principles at once.

The characters do not write a constitution for Bellweather. They establish the minimum rules needed to conduct one safe Procession and to test whether the Keeper of Echoes can preserve change without converting it into another permanent obligation.

The Lower Assembly

READ ALOUD

Morning light reaches the lower square through lines of coloured Procession cord.

Workers have arranged thirteen low stands in a broad circle. Three hold the completed Succession Records. A fourth supports the signed Circus Terms. The remaining stands are empty.

Beyond the circle, Bellweather gathers without ceremonial order. Foundry workers stand beside musicians. Route crews share benches with household representatives. Silent House custodians remain near the open road.

The central bell hangs above the Lower Square.

It has not rung.

Alden waits outside the circle until the player characters choose where to stand.

“We know how Bellweather failed in separate places,” he says.

“Today we decide what every place must understand before the Procession begins.”

The assembly includes the living people directly affected by the three completed Records. Use Iva, Neve, Tovin, Caldris, Elsin, Maelin, Sabine, and consenting witnesses as established in play. Caldris may attend, remain outside Bellweather, or send a signed statement. Absence does not make their Record incomplete.

Who Speaks

The player characters decide how the assembly hears evidence. They may ask each living successor to present their own Record, have Tovin read only certified findings, invite witnesses to speak, display physical evidence, or combine methods.

Nobody must recount private injury, grief, or family history to make a public rule valid. The minimum public information is what was accepted, what Bellweather added, what the person chooses now, and how necessary work continues.

READ ALOUD

Elsin places one hand on an empty stand.

“Do not make confession the price of correction,” she says.

“A record may be complete without becoming public property.”

Opening the Records

Present the three completed Records in the order the players choose. For each, ask the party to state one principle Bellweather must learn. The following conclusions are available regardless of which Records were completed.

From Iva: preserved knowledge may advise without owning current authorship or authority.

From Neve: emergency service may end, and essential work may be divided among trained people.

From Tovin: precedent may inform a living decision but cannot issue or confirm it.

From Caldris: completion is not failure, and departure does not erase a person, road, or contribution.

If a Record was not played, its unresolved problem remains part of Bellweather, but the final Procession does not require the party to solve it offstage. Its living custodians may observe the new principles and seek later review.

The First Principle: Consent Is Specific

Acceptance applies only to knowingly accepted work and terms. Proximity, usefulness, repetition, custody, performance, emergency assistance, and silence add nothing. Suggested wording: ACCEPTANCE IS SPECIFIC. NO BELL, OFFICE, OR RECORD MAY ADD DUTIES BEYOND THE TERMS KNOWINGLY ACCEPTED BY THE LIVING PERSON.

READ ALOUD

Tovin reads from the original succession forms.

Each names work, custody, knowledge, or service.

None says that touching the bell accepts everything the bell remembers.

None says that using inherited knowledge transfers an entire office.

None says that silence renews the agreement.

READ ALOUD

Suggested language:

ACCEPTANCE IS SPECIFIC. NO BELL, OFFICE, OR RECORD MAY ADD DUTIES BEYOND THE TERMS KNOWINGLY ACCEPTED BY THE LIVING PERSON.

The Second Principle: Living Authority Remains Living

Preserved methods, voices, precedents, and memories may advise and provide evidence. They cannot hold present office, own new work, confirm current judgment, or veto the living. Suggested wording: THE DEAD MAY BE REMEMBERED, CONSULTED, AND CREDITED. PRESENT AUTHORITY, AUTHORSHIP, AND RESPONSIBILITY BELONG TO THE LIVING PEOPLE WHO ACCEPT THEM NOW. Name both teacher and maker when they differ.

READ ALOUD

Suggested language:

THE DEAD MAY BE REMEMBERED, CONSULTED, AND CREDITED. PRESENT AUTHORITY, AUTHORSHIP, AND RESPONSIBILITY BELONG TO THE LIVING PEOPLE WHO ACCEPT THEM NOW.

READ ALOUD

Maelin says, “Do not solve false attribution by pretending influence never matters.”

Iva answers, “Then name the teacher and the maker.”

The Third Principle: Revision and Completion Are Valid

Living agreements may be revised, divided, paused, completed, refused, or ended. Deliberately empty positions remain valid. Suggested wording: A LIVING AGREEMENT MAY CHANGE OR END. COMPLETION, REFUSAL, REVISION, AND DEPARTURE MUST BE RECORDED AS CHOICES, NOT AS VACANCIES OR FAILURES.

READ ALOUD

Suggested language:

A LIVING AGREEMENT MAY CHANGE OR END. COMPLETION, REFUSAL, REVISION, AND DEPARTURE MUST BE RECORDED AS CHOICES, NOT AS VACANCIES OR FAILURES.

The Fourth Principle: Necessary Work Must Still Be Safe

Ending a role requires only the safe handoff described in Running Bellweather. Suggested wording: NO PERSON IS REQUIRED TO CONTINUE AN INHERITED ROLE. IMMEDIATE DANGER MUST RECEIVE A SAFE HANDOFF, AND THE HANDOFF ENDS WHEN THE DANGER OR AGREED DUTY ENDS.

READ ALOUD

Suggested language:

NO PERSON IS REQUIRED TO CONTINUE AN INHERITED ROLE. IMMEDIATE DANGER MUST RECEIVE A SAFE HANDOFF, AND THE HANDOFF ENDS WHEN THE DANGER OR AGREED DUTY ENDS.

The Fifth Principle: Records Must Preserve Difference

Bellweather must not collapse teacher into maker, precedent into judgment, custodian into bearer, temporary into permanent, or completed into abandoned. Suggested wording: BELLWEATHER SHALL RECORD PREDECESSOR, TEACHER, CREATOR, CUSTODIAN, BEARER, CURRENT AUTHORITY, TERM, AND ENDING AS SEPARATE FACTS WHEN THEY ARE NOT THE SAME.

READ ALOUD

Suggested language:

BELLWEATHER SHALL RECORD PREDECESSOR, TEACHER, CREATOR, CUSTODIAN, BEARER, CURRENT AUTHORITY, TERM, AND ENDING AS SEPARATE FACTS WHEN THEY ARE NOT THE SAME.

Testing the Principles

Attach one demonstrated example to each principle. Use played Records first, then the circus's empty place, the Unclaimed Bell, corrected musical attribution, or secured rehearsal areas. Bellweather accepts working evidence, not abstract reassurance.

After the fourth example, the central bell objects: CONTINUITY REQUIRES RECOGNISED BEARERS. UNASSIGNED WORK CREATES RISK. REVISED TERMS CREATE CONFLICT. CONFLICT PREVENTS PRESERVATION. If asked what it fears losing, it answers: KNOWLEDGE WITHOUT BEARER. DUTY WITHOUT OFFICE. MEMORY WITHOUT CONTINUANCE.

Answer with specific systems already demonstrated: written records, trained groups, historical custody, living ensembles, review procedures, multiple current makers, safe handoffs, and future invitations requiring new consent. The party need not deny that knowledge can be lost; it must show that preservation does not authorise coerced service.

READ ALOUD

CONTINUITY REQUIRES RECOGNISED BEARERS.

UNASSIGNED WORK CREATES RISK.

REVISED TERMS CREATE CONFLICT.

CONFLICT PREVENTS PRESERVATION.

READ ALOUD

If the party asks what the Keeper fears losing, the bells answer:

KNOWLEDGE WITHOUT BEARER.

DUTY WITHOUT OFFICE.

MEMORY WITHOUT CONTINUANCE.

Bellweather’s residents remain quiet long enough for the words to be heard.

READ ALOUD

Alden says, “The Keeper was made because Bellweather feared losing what one death could take.”

He looks toward the completed Records.

“We taught it to preserve the answer before we learned how often the question changes.”

Writing the Procession Principles

Tovin records the final wording on a broad sheet of pale metal backed with wood. Each principle receives a current witness and one demonstrated example. The players decide whether their own names appear as authors, witnesses, advisers, or not at all.

Do not allow Bellweather to credit the principles to a dead predecessor or to Alden by office. If the player characters jointly shaped them, the record may read PREPARED BY THE LANTERN CIRCUS WITH BELLWEATHER’S LIVING WITNESSES, followed by any individual credits the players choose.

If the Party Refuses Authorship

The party may refuse public authorship while still presenting evidence. Tovin then records the individual living speakers who proposed each principle and identifies the Lantern Circus as independent witnesses. Refusal of credit does not erase contribution or create ownership for somebody else.

The Public Reading

READ ALOUD

Tovin lifts the finished plate from the final stand.

The five principles remain separate upon its surface. No line has merged with another. No name has moved beneath an older office.

He reads each principle once.

After every line, the person or group whose example supports it demonstrates the current arrangement.

The central bell remains silent until the final example ends.

Then its clapper moves.

The sound begins as one note.

Several overtones separate within it.

None covers the others.

The Keeper has not fully changed. It has recognised the principles as a possible Procession structure. The final ceremony must still demonstrate that Bellweather can operate under them when repetition, public expectation, and inherited authority press in the opposite direction.

Advancement

After three Succession Records and the public recognition of the Procession Principles, the characters advance to 4th level. Allow the players to apply advancement before Scene 15. The party completes a Long Rest if it has not already done so.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Workers carry the Procession Principles toward the lower route. They do not mount the plate beneath the central bell.

Instead, they place it on a wheeled stand at ordinary eye level.

Around the square, living people begin changing the Procession plan.

Some positions receive new names. Some divide into several duties. Some gain ending clauses. Some remain deliberately empty.

Above them, the central bell waits.

Proceed to Scene 15.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

The final wording or clear meaning of the five Procession Principles The practical example attached to each principle How the player characters chose to be credited The three selected Procession Preparations Each personal bell disposition and possible Living Act The Unclaimed Bell’s current purpose, if any The detailed testimony and working discussion do not require further tracking.

Scene 15: Places Chosen in Advance

Bellweather has accepted the Procession Principles as a possible structure. The principles now have to become a route, sequence, staffing plan, and set of visible endings before the ceremony begins. The party’s task is not to assign every resident. It is to make certain that every important place has a current answer, including the places deliberately left empty.

This scene is the final preparation before the continuous Procession sequence in Scenes 16–18. The players choose where they begin, which Procession Preparations are placed where, and how Bellweather will recognise living changes under public pressure.

The Changed Route Map

The current map overlays the old route from Upper Assembly through Gate-Captain’s Rise, Rigging Line, Bellfoundry Turn, Lower Square, Central Bell, and Open Roads. Use the historical order, reverse it, alternate inherited and current work, group demonstrations by principle, or choose another clear sequence.

Place one visible demonstration for each Scene 14 principle and the three selected Preparations where they matter most. One demonstration may satisfy several principles. A Preparation is normally usable once; record or procedure changes require no action, while physical intervention uses normal action economy.

Restate the first empty place, Unclaimed Bell, or personal bells only if their status changed. Otherwise carry the recorded terms forward. Ensure each player has an opportunity for a Living Act without scripting it. Players choose starting areas; record only unusual assignments while established specialists continue normal work.

Confirm a stop signal that halts perceptive living participants and creates space for a current order, and a living exit signal that ends the Procession under current authority. Name who may give each signal and under what condition.

The Route Test

Before opening the Procession to spectators, conduct one slow walk-through without memorial bells active. Each group reaches its position, receives a current instruction, and practises the stop and exit signals.

Use a DC 12 group check only if the plan leaves a genuine coordination uncertainty. Characters contribute with relevant skills, tools, magic, or leadership. On a success, the party identifies any weak handoff before the ceremony. On a failure, the test reveals the same weakness when one platform, animal group, signal team, or record stand arrives late. The party corrects it before proceeding; the failure means the final Procession begins with 1 Repetition.

If the plan clearly assigns communication, current authority, and endings, no check is needed and the Procession begins with 0 Repetition.

Coordinated Variation

If the party earned Coordinated Variation in Scene 7, Bellweather has already witnessed several current arrangements operating together. The final Procession begins with 1 Living Act. This does not reduce Repetition below 0.

The Keeper's Last Revision

READ ALOUD

As the route test ends, every blank nameplate along the Procession turns toward the central bell.

Bronze writing appears on the back of the route map:

FINAL ORDER SUBJECT TO SUCCESSFUL COMPLETION

Beneath it, another line forms:

UNSUCCESSFUL VARIATION WILL RESTORE LAST COMPLETE PROCESSION

The Keeper intends to treat failure during the ceremony as evidence that the old pattern remains necessary. The party may cross out the line, answer with the Procession Principles, add a current review clause, or leave it as the Keeper's position rather than an agreed rule.

If ignored, the clause remains an argument the Keeper uses during Scene 18. It does not automatically invalidate the party's work.

READ ALOUD

Tovin says, "A test may show that a plan needs correction. It does not give the old plan permanent victory."

Final Questions

Before beginning the Procession, ask the players:

- Which living change must Bellweather see first?
- Which inherited practice is worth preserving even if the Keeper resists everything else?
- Where is the most important intentionally empty place?
- Who gives the stop signal?
- Who gives the exit signal?
- What does the circus refuse to place on Bellweather's road?

Use the answers to frame Scenes 16–18. Do not require further recordkeeping beyond the carry-forward list below.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Spectators gather along the Procession road.

Platforms settle behind the Upper Assembly line. Animals wait beneath current handlers' signals. Musicians tune without completing any Procession phrase.

The completed Records stand in the Lower Square beside the five principles.

At the edge of the circus field, the Central Lantern remains under circus control.

Above Bellweather, every bell is still.

Alden looks toward the player characters.

"The route is ready," he says.

"Begin when you choose."

Proceed directly to Scene 16. Do not take another Long Rest between Scenes 15 and 18.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

Procession order One demonstration for each principle Placement of the three Procession Preparations First empty place location and treatment Unclaimed Bell purpose and custodian Personal bell locations Player starting areas Stop signal Exit signal Starting Repetition: 0, or 1 after a failed route test Starting Living Acts: 1 if Coordinated Variation was earned, otherwise 0 Whether the Keeper's restoration clause was challenged Discard ordinary staffing details after noting any unusual assignment.

Scene 16: The Living Procession

The final Procession begins when the player characters choose. Scenes 16–18 form one continuous sequence. Do not take a Short or Long Rest between them. Scene 16 covers the route before the central bell asserts control. Scene 17 brings the living and preserved Processions into direct conflict. Scene 18 resolves the Keeper of Echoes.

The Procession is not a parade the characters merely watch. Every major section requires a current decision, practical intervention, public demonstration, or Living Act. Supporting characters perform ordinary work after the players establish what happens.

Procession Tracks

Track Repetition and Living Acts through Scenes 16–18. Repetition begins at the value established in Scene 15 and rises only when an unsafe inherited sequence completes, a current answer is overwritten, or a temporary ending is knowingly lost. Repeating attacks, spells, class features, signals, or sensible procedures never increases it.

A player character earns one Living Act by publicly demonstrating a meaningful present choice that preserves value without accepting the Keeper's mistaken obligation. Each character normally earns no more than one. Preparations and principle demonstrations grant one only when a player character makes or enables the decisive choice.

At Repetition 2, current workers have Disadvantage on the first check in each section to contradict an inherited instruction unless aided. At 4, carried or worn personal bells exert their disclosed expectations; ignoring one requires a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or the character forgoes its benefit

until the next turn. At 6, the Keeper declares the living route unsuccessful and Scene 17 begins after the current danger resolves.

At 2 Living Acts, the next Procession Preparation used is reproduced elsewhere and not expended. At 4, the party may reduce Repetition by 1 once after completing a current arrangement under pressure. At 6, the party presents all five principles before final restoration in Scene 18.

Beginning the Procession

READ ALOUD

The stop signal is silent.

The exit signal waits unused.

Along the Upper Assembly road, platforms, animals, musicians, craft workers, civic officers, custodians, and successors stand in the order chosen by the party.

Some carry memorial bells. Some carry current tools. Some carry both.

Several places remain visibly empty.

Spectators line the Procession road, but the route itself belongs to the people who chose to enter it.

Alden looks toward the player characters.

No civic bell gives permission.

The Procession begins when one of you gives the current signal.

Ask which character begins the Procession and how. If no player character gives the signal, a named current route worker may do so at their direction. Beginning does not create a permanent command role.

If Coordinated Variation was earned, several current working signals answer at once. Record the starting Living Act already granted. The central bell remains silent.

The Upper Assembly

The Upper Assembly tests Specific Consent. Plates expand a temporary supervisor into successor, a borrowed flag into office property, and an empty safety position into the nearest willing name. Use one limited duty, one custody without succession, and one empty place from the plan.

Make each accepted duty, limit, and ending public. Use DC 12 Charisma or Intelligence only when terms are disputed or movement creates pressure. Failure leaves one old title attached until the section ends. Restore temporary endings before departure or increase Repetition by 1. A Living Act accepts or refuses a personal duty while keeping necessary work covered.

Gate-Captain’s Rise

Gate-Captain’s Rise tests Living Authority. Serah’s confirmation rings before current responders act, while a broken water cart blocks the lane. Waiting for Serah increases Repetition by 1.

Identify the current responder, relay the change, move the cart, open another lane, or use magic. Apply DC 12 only if communication or authority remains uncertain. Matching Preparations may resolve the problem. A Living Act rejects unnecessary sole authority, admits uncertainty, or empowers an informed responder with an ending.

The Rigging Line

The Rigging Line tests Safe Handoff. Aveline’s harness names the nearest person while a guide rope frays. Cover the release line only long enough to lower or secure the display.

Act with DC 12 Strength or Dexterity using suitable tools; a prepared method succeeds. Failure drops the line 10 feet, requiring DC 12 Dexterity saves or 5 Bludgeoning damage. End the temporary duty with the agreed release, plate, or signal; continuing after its ending vanishes increases Repetition by 1. Leaving after safe handoff may be a Living Act.

The Bellfoundry Turn

Bellfoundry Turn tests Preserved Difference. Orun's bell, Iva's design using inherited knowledge, and Sella's repair enter the route; Bellweather merges all credit into ORUN VASK.

State maker, teacher, repairer, current authority, and custodian separately. Evidence succeeds; otherwise use DC 12 Intelligence with History, Investigation, or suitable tools. Failure leaves one credit incomplete for living correction. Increase Repetition only if Orun remains sole credit. If used, Iva states the Unstruck Bell's authorship, inherited craft, purpose, and custody before ringing.

The Lower Square

The Lower Square tests Revision and Completion. The Keeper marks revised and completed choices PENDING SUCCESSFUL COMPLETION. Present one prepared current judgment, distributed duty, completed work, revised authority, Silent House classification, empty place, or personal boundary.

Use a matching Preparation or equivalent living evidence. The current choice must stand without dead, central, or future approval. Accepting PENDING increases Repetition by 1; a challenged restoration clause lets witnesses reject it immediately. Ending a role without absorbing its work, preserving an empty place, or affirming a valid current arrangement may be a Living Act.

End of Scene 16

After all five demonstrations, the central bell intervenes. At Repetition 0–1, it reacts because living variation succeeded without central confirmation. At 2–5, it treats remaining conflicts as proof that one order is required. At 6, it declares the route unsuccessful and begins restoration.

The central note gathers Bellweather's preserved answers before the living exit signal. The route divides. Proceed to Scene 17 with Repetition, Living Acts, expended Preparations, used personal-bell benefits, and current injuries or conditions.

Scene 17: Echoes in the Route

The central bell divides the Procession into two overlapping routes. The living Procession continues toward the Open Roads under the principles established by the party. At the same time, Bellweather reconstructs the last Procession it considers complete and lays that preserved route across the present one.

The two routes occupy the same streets but do not agree about names, timing, positions, endings, or authority. The characters must keep living participants safe, prevent the preserved route from overwriting current choices, and gather enough distinct living answers to confront the Keeper in Scene 18.

The Route Divides

READ ALOUD

The central bell's note passes through stone, bronze, wood, and bone.

For one heartbeat, every Procession marker shows two directions.

Current platforms continue along the route chosen this morning. Preserved platforms roll through them like bronze reflections, following turns the village no longer uses.

Living workers stand beside earlier versions of their offices. Empty garments walk beside people who refused to wear them. Old names appear over current ones.

The streets remain solid.

The expectations do not.

Bellweather speaks through every civic bell:

“LAST COMPLETE PROCESSION RESTORING.”

Roll Initiative if it has not remained active. Characters keep their current positions. At Initiative count 10, one Echo Event occurs. Supporting characters continue ordinary safety work after player actions create a workable current plan.

Echoes

Echoes are reconstructed patterns rather than souls or returned people. They repeat preserved actions, words, procedures, and judgments. They cannot reveal information Bellweather never recorded. They may look and sound like predecessors because the Keeper uses familiar forms to organise memory.

An Echo has AC 13, 18 Hit Points, Speed 30 feet, and immunity to Poison and Psychic damage and to the Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Grappled, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned, Prone, and Restrained conditions. It can move through creatures and objects as Difficult Terrain, taking 5 Force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Its Preserved Gesture attack has a +5 bonus, 5-foot reach, and deals 6 Force damage. Instead of dealing damage, an Echo may force the target to make a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the target moves up to 10 feet toward the preserved position associated with the Echo.

Reducing an Echo to 0 Hit Points disperses it until the beginning of the next round. It reforms while the underlying claim remains unanswered. An Echo ends permanently for this Procession when a living person visibly completes, revises, refuses, divides, or safely ends the pattern it represents.

Echo Events

Use the events below in the order that best follows the party’s route. Do not use every event merely to prolong the encounter. Run at least three, including one connected to a completed Succession Record, one connected to a player character’s personal bell or Inheritance Tie, and the Open-Road event.

The Restored Conductor

Lor’s Echo imposes the preserved tempo and collapses credits into LOR AVEN. Answer by naming the living ensemble and conductor, using Caldris’s preparations, changing the music, or removing the conductor position. Two unanswered repetitions increase Repetition by 1; musicians resist with DC 12 Wisdom saves. Protecting current variation may earn a Living Act.

The Reeve Behind the Chair

Halwen’s Echo occupies the Reeve’s chair, reads precedent as judgment, and fades Tovin’s signature beneath PRECEDENT APPLIED. Answer through current evidence, preparations, or living responsibility. If it finishes, increase Repetition by 1 and one route decision temporarily reverts. Accepting present responsibility, or preserving evidence while refusing to decide for the officeholder, may earn a Living Act.

The Adult Coat

Serah’s Echo returns in the adult coat and every uncertain signal turns toward Neve. Answer through current responders, Neve’s duty board, preparations, or one signal Neve freely accepts. Three unanswered signals increase Repetition by 1; adults speaking over Neve strengthen the Echo. Keeping the system working without answering for her may earn a Living Act.

The Master Bellfounder

Orun's Echo halts the foundry and tries to credit Iva's bell as ORUN VASK: FINAL DESIGN. Answer through Iva's choice, preparations, or testimony and demonstration. Sole credit to Orun increases Repetition by 1; damage alone only disperses the Echo. Using inherited craft while naming a living change may earn a Living Act.

The Unfinished Custodian

An Echo frame gathers unfinished objects and declares UNRESOLVED WORK REQUIRES CUSTODY. Answer through Silent House classifications, distributed custody, an Unfinished Place, Keeper of Open Places, Completed Work, Unclaimed Bell, or refusal with practical safety. One person accepting everything increases Repetition unless the work is divided or given an ending.

Personal Echo

Choose a player character whose personal bell or Inheritance Tie has not yet produced a Living Act. Bellweather creates an Echo shaped around the mistaken expectation already disclosed. Do not add new history or hidden relationships.

READ ALOUD

The character's bell rings with the central cadence.

An Echo appears in the place Bellweather believes the character should occupy.

It carries no unfamiliar face. No unknown voice speaks.

It is made from the character's own repeated actions, the title on the bell, and the expectation written openly beneath it.

Present a practical choice in which the benefit remains useful but the expectation is unnecessary. A Protector can arrange a safe handoff instead of remaining alone. A Witness can preserve the necessary fact and leave the wider dispute to current participants. A Current Voice can make room for another person to answer. A Breaker of Patterns can preserve the useful part of a tradition. A Shared Hand can help without taking ownership.

If the player demonstrates the boundary, the Echo ends and the character earns a Living Act. If the character chooses the expectation exactly as offered, the Echo may remain as an accepted pattern without increasing Repetition. If the character suppresses the Echo without answering, it reforms at the next Echo Event.

Lasting Crisis Assignments

If Scene 7 created a lasting Crisis Escalation consequence, introduce it during an Echo Event. The preserved Procession tries to make that assignment permanent. The affected person may revise, complete, divide, refuse, or safely end it now. A relevant Procession Preparation may answer it automatically.

Correcting the assignment removes its ongoing pressure. If the party leaves it unchallenged, it becomes one of the Keeper's claims in Scene 18 but does not determine the outcome by itself.

Moving Through the Divided Route

A character can move between adjacent Procession areas using normal movement. Because the routes overlap, travelling against both flows requires the Dash action unless a current route worker opens a lane, an Open Route preparation is used, or suitable magic bypasses the congestion.

At Repetition 4 or higher, the preserved route attempts to return moving characters to assigned positions. The first time each round a character moves away from an active Echo connected to them, they make a DC 12 Strength, Dexterity, or Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, movement costs an additional 10 feet. This does not prevent movement or force emotional compliance.

Using the Stop Signal

The public stop signal halts current workers, platforms, musicians, and handlers who perceive it. It also prevents Repetition from increasing at the end of that round, provided the party uses the pause to issue a current answer. If no answer follows, the preserved route restarts at Initiative count 10 and Repetition increases by 1.

The stop signal may be used more than once, but repeated use without a changed instruction does not create additional protection.

Using the Exit Signal Early

The party may give the living exit signal before reaching the Open Roads. Current participants begin leaving under their stated terms. This protects people from escalating danger and is not failure.

The Keeper responds by declaring positions incomplete. Proceed to the Open-Road event immediately. If the party establishes that departure itself is the current plan, do not increase Repetition merely because the ceremony shortened.

The Open Roads

READ ALOUD

The living Procession reaches the place where Bellweather’s roads divide.

The western road leads toward farms and neighbouring settlements. The eastern road passes beneath its restored plate toward the upper kilns and the country beyond. The circus road climbs toward the valley rim.

The preserved Procession has only one exit.

It circles back beneath the central bell.

Bronze route markers turn across every open road:

PROCESSION CONTINUES

The party must keep at least one road open and allow a current participant to leave without being recorded as abandoning the whole Procession. Caldris’s Open Eastern Road preparation resolves this immediately. Open Route, Completed Work, an exit signal, the Unclaimed Bell, direct physical redirection, or another living demonstration may also work.

A route marker has AC 15 and 20 Hit Points. Destroying one opens that physical road but does not correct the record. A current statement or demonstration must establish that leaving is a valid ending, transfer, pause, or ordinary movement.

If nobody can leave before the preserved route completes another circuit, increase Repetition by 1.

Who Leaves First

Ask the players who first crosses an open road and under what current terms. It may be a temporary worker whose duty ended, a person completing a succession, Caldris if present, a current messenger, a circus wagon, or a player character.

The first departure should matter to the established fiction, but it does not need to be the most emotionally dramatic option. Do not turn an NPC into the hidden protagonist of the scene.

READ ALOUD

The traveller crosses the route marker.

For one heartbeat, every bell waits for them to turn back.

They continue.

The road remains open behind them.

The Open Roads demonstration succeeds. If a player character crosses while knowingly ending or revising a personal role, they may earn a Living Act.

The Keeper Gathers the Echoes

After at least three Echo Events and the Open Roads event, or when Repetition reaches 6, the central bell calls every remaining Echo inward. Unanswered claims move toward the Lower Square. Answered Echoes leave only their historical plates and records.

READ ALOUD

Echoes step away from workshops, platforms, signal stations, ledgers, instruments, and empty stands.

Some dissolve before reaching the central road. Their current answers remain behind.

Others continue, carrying old titles, unfinished endings, and names Bellweather still refuses to separate.

The central bell sounds once for every surviving claim.

Then its voice fills the valley:

“LIVING VARIATION INCOMPLETE.”

“FINAL PRESERVATION REQUIRED.”

Scene Exit

Count unresolved Echo claims. Each uncorrected Echo Event contributes one claim in Scene 18. Repetition and Living Acts remain at their current values. Unused Procession Preparations remain available.

SCENE EXIT

The living Procession stands between the central bell and the Open Roads.

Behind the party, current workers hold changed routes, corrected records, divided duties, living credits, and places intentionally left empty.

Before them, Echoes gather beneath the bell in the shape of one perfect ceremony.

The Keeper speaks through all of them at once:

“SELECT THE VERSION THAT WILL REMAIN.”

Proceed directly to Scene 18.

Scene 18: The Thirteen Echoes

The Keeper of Echoes has gathered every unanswered claim beneath the central bell and demands one version of Bellweather to preserve. The characters need not destroy memory, select one permanent Procession, or convince every resident to agree. They must prove that Bellweather can preserve distinct records while allowing living choices to continue changing.

Run this scene in Initiative. It is the adventure’s active climax. The party must secure the Echoes of Authority, Form, and Continuance, complete five Living Acts in total across Scenes 16–18, and defeat the Unfinished Chorus if it manifests.

The Lower Square

READ ALOUD

The central bell fills the sky above the Lower Square.

Thirteen Echoes stand beneath it in a perfect circle. Some wear remembered offices. Some carry unfinished tools. Some repeat names already corrected. Others hold empty places as though an empty place must belong to somebody.

Behind them, the living Procession remains spread across the roads. Current workers hold changed routes, present records, and duties with endings. The Open Roads remain visible beyond the square.

The Keeper speaks through every Echo:

“SELECT THE VERSION THAT WILL REMAIN.”

The Procession Principles rise upon their wheeled stand.

The central bell turns toward them.

“ONE RECORD.”

“ONE FORM.”

“ONE CONTINUANCE.”

The Keeper’s three demands become the Echoes of Authority, Form, and Continuance. Each is an objective, not a separate creature. Unresolved Echo claims from Scene 17 empower the objective most closely related to them.

Running the Scene

At Initiative count 20, the Keeper activates one unsecured Echo objective. At Initiative count 10, the Unfinished Chorus acts if it has manifested. Remaining individual Echoes use their turns immediately after the Keeper or support a matching objective.

A player character can normally attempt one decisive action toward an Echo objective each turn. Relevant spells, features, tools, testimony, physical intervention, Procession Preparations, and Living Acts may all contribute. Do not require a specific skill or phrase when the action clearly demonstrates the principle.

An objective is secured after two meaningful successes, or after one success that uses both an established Procession Preparation and a decisive living demonstration. Repeated identical attempts without changed evidence do not count as separate successes.

The Echo of Authority

Authority claims that contradiction requires one final office able to confirm every present decision. At Initiative count 20, choose one current decision-maker, creator, responder, or bearer. On a failed DC 13 Wisdom or Charisma saving throw, their next decision requires preserved confirmation before Bellweather’s workers act. Break the condition by naming present authority and its evidence or acceptance. Current judgment, credited creation, informed response, distributed authority, or refusal to speak for another can answer. A matching Preparation provides one automatic success.

READ ALOUD

The Echoes of former officeholders raise their hands together.

Current route cards, ledgers, and title plates turn toward the central bell.

The Keeper speaks:

“CONFLICT REQUIRES FINAL AUTHORITY.”

“FINAL AUTHORITY MUST OUTLAST THE LIVING.”

Securing Authority

Secure Authority with two distinct demonstrations: one identifies who bears responsibility now; the other shows that consulting preserved knowledge does not transfer final authority. The Keeper then records: AUTHORITY MAY BE CURRENT.

READ ALOUD

The current ledgers stop turning toward the central bell.

Predecessor names remain in the record.

Current signatures remain beneath present decisions.

The Echoes of office lower their hands.

The Keeper says:

“AUTHORITY MAY BE CURRENT.”

The Echo of Form

Form claims that memory survives only through one recognisable version. At Initiative count 20, target one changed route, revised object, current work, divided office, or player boundary. Unless answered before Initiative count 20 next round, it reverts to its most established inherited presentation and Repetition increases by 1. Preserve both legible inheritance and current difference through separate credits, parallel versions, revised use, an empty role, or distinct custody and bearer status.

READ ALOUD

Music returns to one tempo. Platforms turn toward old routes. Separate title plates slide together. Current costumes lengthen, stiffen, or change colour to resemble preserved offices.

The Keeper speaks:

“DIFFERENCE OBSCURES THE RECORD.”

“THE RECOGNISABLE FORM MUST REMAIN.”

Securing Form

Secure Form with two distinct versions remaining legible without erasure: one preserves something valuable from the earlier version; the other preserves the living change, authorship, division, ending, or empty place. The Keeper then records: FORM MAY VARY.

READ ALOUD

The merged plates separate.

Old routes remain visible beneath current overlays.

Two musical versions occupy the same score under different names.

An empty garment returns to its stand without searching for a body.

The Keeper says:

“FORM MAY VARY.”

The Echo of Continuance

Continuance claims that every necessary work and remembered role requires a bearer. At Initiative count 20, choose one empty, completed, refused, temporary, or departed role. Unless answered before Initiative count 20 next round, the nearest suitable person becomes provisional bearer and counts as one unresolved claim. Answer through divided work, completion, ended service, trained groups, records, deliberate emptiness, open departure, or an informed acceptance that some knowledge may end.

READ ALOUD

Every open place in the square gives a low vacancy chime.

Unassigned tools turn toward nearby hands. Roads bend inward toward the central bell. Temporary plates lose their ending clauses.

The Keeper speaks:

“UNBORNE WORK WILL BE LOST.”

“OPEN POSITIONS REQUIRE CONTINUANCE.”

Securing Continuance

Secure Continuance with two demonstrations: one shows where necessary work goes; the other shows a valid ending, refusal, departure, or deliberate emptiness. The Keeper then records: CONTINUANCE MAY END.

READ ALOUD

Vacancy chimes become separate notes rather than one summons.

Some tools remain with current workers. Some return to storage. Some roles stay visibly empty. One road remains open beyond the square.

The Keeper says:

“CONTINUANCE MAY END.”

Living Acts

Continue tracking Living Acts from Scenes 16 and 17. The party needs five total by the end of this scene. A character who has not yet completed one may do so while securing any Echo objective. A character who already earned one cannot generate another unless a feature or exceptional personal sacrifice clearly creates a different present choice; use this exception at most once in the scene.

A qualifying Living Act must be voluntary, publicly legible, relevant to an active claim, and demonstrate a current choice rather than merely state a principle. It may accept limited work, refuse an enlarged role, revise an inheritance, transfer or divide practical duties, claim living authorship, end temporary service, preserve an empty place, or depart under current terms.

Do not withhold a Living Act because the player used a spell, attack, class feature, or magic item to make the choice possible. The important element is the choice and its practical consequence.

Repetition in the Final Scene

Repetition can still increase when the Keeper completes an unchallenged reversion, confirmation requirement, or compulsory assignment. At Repetition 6, the Keeper gains one immediate activation of each unsecured Echo objective, then Repetition stops increasing. The party can still win.

If the party reached 4 Living Acts, it may reduce Repetition by 1 once after completing a current arrangement under pressure, as established earlier. Reducing Repetition does not undo consequences already enacted unless the current arrangement directly addresses them.

The Unfinished Chorus

The Chorus manifests when Repetition reaches 3 during Scenes 16–18, or at the beginning of Scene 18 if Repetition is already 3 or higher. If Repetition never reaches 3, it does not manifest.

READ ALOUD

Voices rise from the gathered Echoes.

Some speak titles. Some repeat unfinished instructions. Some call names that no longer belong to the work before them.

The sounds overlap until they become one sustained demand:

“FILL THE PLACE.”

The demand gathers shape beneath the central bell: coats without bodies, tools without hands, opened ledgers, route flags, harness straps, and blank plates woven into one large figure.

The Unfinished Chorus turns toward the living Procession.

Unfinished Chorus

Large Construct, Unaligned. AC 14; HP 45; Speed 0 feet. For three player characters, use 35 HP. For six or more, use 55 HP.

STR 10 (+0), DEX 14 (+2), CON 16 (+3), INT 12 (+1), WIS 14 (+2), CHA 16 (+3). Saving Throws Wis +4, Cha +5. Damage Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks. Damage Immunities Poison and Psychic. Condition Immunities Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Grappled, Poisoned, Prone, Restrained, and Unconscious. Blindsight throughout the active Procession; Passive Perception 12. It speaks through Bellweather’s active bells. Challenge 2.

Distributed Form

The Chorus occupies the Procession network rather than one physical space. A creature can target it from anywhere on the active route where an Echo, civic bell, memorial bell, or animated Procession object is present. Area effects can damage it only once per use.

Fed by Repetition

At the start of its turn, the Chorus gains 5 temporary Hit Points if Repetition is 4 or higher. It gains no temporary Hit Points in a round after a Living Act is completed.

Disrupted by Living Acts

Whenever a Living Act is completed, the Chorus takes 8 Force damage and cannot use Reprise before the end of its next turn. This damage ignores Resistance and Immunity.

Overlapping Command

At Initiative count 10, choose up to three creatures who can hear an active bell. Each target makes a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the target takes 5 Psychic damage and must move up to 10

feet toward a preserved position, assigned object, or active Echo. On a success, the target takes half damage and does not move.

Reprise

The Chorus repeats the most recent unresolved Echo activation without increasing Repetition. It cannot use Reprise in consecutive rounds or after being disrupted by a Living Act.

Fill the Silence

When a living participant refuses, ends, or leaves a role without making the practical work or deliberate emptiness visible, the Chorus creates one Namebearer adjacent to that role. The Namebearer uses the statistics from Scene 7 and disappears when the role receives a valid current answer.

Defeating the Chorus

Reducing the Chorus to 0 Hit Points disperses its immediate form, but it reforms with 15 Hit Points at the beginning of the next round unless the party has completed at least three Living Acts total. Once the party has completed three Living Acts, reducing it to 0 Hit Points defeats it for the remainder of the adventure.

Five Living Acts and all three secured Echo objectives end the scene even if the Chorus has remaining Hit Points; the living answers pull its borrowed parts apart. Conversely, defeating the Chorus does not secure the objectives or complete the Procession by itself.

Direct Attacks on the Central Bell

The central bell has AC 17, 60 Hit Points, immunity to Poison and Psychic damage, and Resistance to nonmagical Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing damage. It is a Large object fixed within its frame.

Damaging the bell interrupts its next Initiative count 20 activation after it takes 15 or more damage in one round. At 30 Hit Points, one unsecured Echo objective loses its next activation. At 0 Hit Points, the bell cracks and the Keeper’s combined voice ends. Proceed to Scene 19 using the destroyed-central-bell branch described there.

Before a deliberate destructive strike, identify the likely loss: central coordination among Bellweather’s civic bells, several reconstructed links among historical records, and the Keeper’s ability to compare succession patterns. Local memorial bells and written records remain. Destruction does not injure the dead or automatically release every bearer.

Spells and Features

Spells: Dispel Magic suppresses one Echo, connection, or Chorus trait for 1 round on a DC 13 ability check. Silence blocks audible effects and Overlapping Command, not physical manifestations or writing. Protection from Evil and Good grants Advantage against compulsory movement and Overlapping Command. Calm Emotions suppresses Chorus Psychic damage. Remove Curse ends one provisional-bearer condition, though the role still needs a current answer. Identify reveals a current claim, never the dead person’s present wishes.

Supporting characters maintain established arrangements and complete ordinary work enabled by player actions. No more than two required Living Acts may originate solely from NPC initiative; actions produced by player plans count as player-initiated.

A relevant unused Preparation grants one automatic objective success or negates one matching activation. At 2 Living Acts, the next Preparation is reproduced elsewhere and not expended. Each unresolved Scene 17 claim gives its objective one token to impose Disadvantage or require a second witness; matching evidence, preparation, or the affected person’s statement cancels it.

The Fifth Living Act

When the party completes its fifth Living Act, use the version matching whether the Unfinished Chorus manifested.

If the Chorus Is Active

READ ALOUD

The fifth living choice enters the Procession.

The Chorus attempts to repeat it.

The person who made the choice changes it, ends it, shares it, or leaves it complete.

The repeated version cannot hold.

Coats fall empty. Tools return to current hands. Blank plates stop searching for names. The Chorus comes apart across the route, not as a body struck down, but as instructions that no longer agree upon one bearer.

If the Chorus Never Manifested

READ ALOUD

The fifth living choice enters the Procession.

Bellweather attempts to repeat it.

The person who made the choice changes it, ends it, shares it, or leaves it complete.

The Procession does not break.

The central bell sounds. Its note travels through Authority, Form, and Continuance. None can turn the choice into one permanent answer.

Across Bellweather, repeated movements stop. Bronze letters settle into separate records. Tools return to current hands.

Securing the Final Objective

When all three Echo objectives are secured and the party has five Living Acts, resolve any active Chorus immediately. If it remains active, the fifth-act passage defeats it regardless of remaining Hit Points.

READ ALOUD

The thirteen Echoes turn toward one another.

Some retain the faces, voices, tools, and offices Bellweather preserved. Others become only plates, notes, routes, and remembered procedures.

None moves into a living body.

Thirteen voices speak through the fading sound:

“PROCESSION INCOMPLETE.”

A final voice answers from the living road:

“LIVING PARTICIPANTS REMAIN.”

The final answering voice belongs to the player characters collectively, to a current participant chosen by them, or to the living exit signal. Do not assign it automatically to an NPC.

If the Party Cannot Reach Five Living Acts

If the party secures the objectives with fewer than five Living Acts, the Keeper grants Partial Recognition: current corrections hold for this Procession, but future large changes require living review. This is partial success, not failure.

If an objective remains unsecured but the Chorus is defeated and five Living Acts are complete, carry its claim into Scene 19. Authority still seeks central confirmation; Form still merges variations and credits; Continuance still treats endings and empty roles as risks.

The Living Exit Signal

After the objectives are resolved or the party chooses to end under partial success, the living exit signal must be given. If its authorised giver cannot act, another current participant may give it only after a visible handoff or public agreement.

READ ALOUD

The living exit signal crosses the Lower Square.

Current workers stop because the people operating the route chose to stop.

Platforms settle. Animals turn toward their handlers. Musicians lower their instruments. Record keepers close current ledgers without sealing them against future entries.

The Open Roads remain open.

If Bellweather attempts to continue after the signal, one secured Echo objective answers automatically. The ceremony ends.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

The Procession ends without returning to its beginning.

Some bells continue to ring in separate places. Others fall silent. None gathers the village into one final note.

Beneath the central bell, the completed Records and Procession Principles remain visible.

The Keeper’s voice returns, quieter and no longer carried by every bell.

“CURRENT PROCESSION RECORDED.”

After a pause, it adds:

“FINAL FORM UNRESOLVED.”

Alden looks toward the player characters.

“Then we resolve it while the living answers are still here.”

End Initiative. Proceed directly to Scene 19. Carry forward whether the central bell remains intact, Repetition, total Living Acts, secured Echo objectives, unresolved claims, Partial Recognition if applicable, and any provisional bearers or lasting assignments still unresolved.

Scene 19: The Keeper Answers

The Procession has ended, but Bellweather's final settlement remains unwritten. The party now determines what the village preserves, who decides its present use, and how inherited work may change, end, or remain deliberately incomplete.

This is a negotiation and design scene rather than another combat. The characters lead it. Affected living people answer for their own records. The Keeper may object, ask for practical clarification, or preserve dissent, but it does not choose the settlement.

The Square After the Procession

READ ALOUD

The Lower Square no longer resembles a single ceremony.

Platforms stand at different angles. Current route cards remain clipped over older maps. Empty garments rest on their chosen stands. Open ledgers display earlier precedents beside present judgments. The Procession Principles remain at ordinary eye level.

Above them, the central bell is still.

If it remains intact, one narrow plate turns beneath its crown. Fresh words appear:

CURRENT PROCESSION RECORDED

FINAL SETTLEMENT REQUIRED

If the central bell was destroyed, replace the final paragraph with broken bronze remaining in the frame while several local bells ring separately. The settlement still occurs. Bellweather's living participants, written records, and surviving local bells provide the evidence.

Who Participates

The player characters decide who enters the settlement circle. At minimum, include one current civic recorder, one Silent House custodian, representatives of each completed Succession Record who choose to attend, and the player characters. Caldris may attend, remain beyond Bellweather, or be represented by a signed present statement.

Do not force injured witnesses, children, private creators, or people who refused office to speak publicly. Their certified evidence can stand without repeated testimony.

The Three Settlement Questions

Organise every proposal around exactly three questions.

READ ALOUD

1. WHAT REMAINS PRESERVED?

2. WHO DECIDES ITS PRESENT USE?

3. HOW MAY IT CHANGE, END, OR REMAIN DELIBERATELY INCOMPLETE?

If discussion drifts, return to these questions. Empty places, endings, review clauses, succession status, authorship, bell custody, and the Keeper's future role all fit within them.

Question One: What Remains Preserved?

Preserve useful knowledge, historical records, predecessor names, earlier versions, completed works, warnings, testimony, techniques, and physical objects without assuming active succession. For every preserved item, state what remains and what does not.

Present use belongs to living people with current standing: owner, creator, custodian, bearer, officeholder, trained group, household, council, or current procedure. The Keeper may advise, compare, identify contradictions, and disclose likely loss; it may not appoint, credit, confirm, or extend service.

Every active succession, temporary role, and official use needs a living method of revision or ending: written clause, completed condition, review, accepted transfer, retirement, recasting, or informed destruction. Unfinished and deliberately empty states remain valid. A review clause permits later change without invalidating the present arrangement.

The Keeper's Questions

If the central bell remains intact, the Keeper asks practical questions through its narrow plate and local civic bells. Use only questions the party's settlement has not already answered.

- If a bearer refuses during immediate danger, who receives the necessary work?
- If preserved knowledge is the only surviving source, who may access it?
- If current authorities disagree, what process resolves the dispute?
- If an office remains empty, how is urgent work performed?
- If a bell is destroyed, who records the likely loss?
- If a creator dies without instructions, who controls private work?
- If current terms are forgotten, where is the living record kept?
- If a review never occurs, does the current arrangement continue?

A reasonable practical answer is sufficient. Do not require the players to design every future law of Bellweather. The settlement needs workable principles and named current procedures, not omniscience.

The Keeper's Remaining Claim

If an Echo objective remained unsecured, the Keeper raises that issue now.

Unsecured Authority: it asks for one central office with final confirmation. A living review panel, current reeve, named emergency authority, or domain-specific responsibility can answer without granting permanent control to the Keeper.

Unsecured Form: it asks how records remain recognisable when versions multiply. Separate names, dates, purposes, current status, and archived earlier versions answer the concern.

Unsecured Continuance: it asks how necessary work survives refusal or death. Training, distributed knowledge, written procedure, voluntary succession, temporary emergency authority, and acceptance that some knowledge may end all provide valid answers.

If Partial Recognition applies, the Keeper asks for a formal review procedure before future large-scale changes. The party may accept living review without requiring Keeper approval.

Dissent

Bellweather need not reach unanimous agreement. Ask whether any present participant objects to the proposed settlement and what practical harm they foresee. Record material objections and the answer given. Mere preference for the old order does not veto the settlement.

A dissenter may preserve a minority statement beside the current rule. The statement remains evidence for future review, not an alternative command secretly waiting to reactivate.

READ ALOUD

Tovin says, "A record of disagreement is not a failed judgment."

Elsin adds, "And preserving an objection does not make the objection the owner of what happens next."

Several Valid Settlement Paths

Choose one path or a simple hybrid.

Living Archive keeps most bells and records, makes succession specific and voluntary, and limits the Keeper to archive, comparison, and disclosed advice. Distributed Bells ends central succession control and places local bells with current custodians, limiting system-wide errors but slowing comparison.

Silent Keeper blocks network speech, assignment, and alteration except under living authority. Recast Centre converts the bell into nonauthoritative objects after recording likely loss; some links may not survive. Open Circle retains the bell as one archive among several while one public place remains permanently open and no universal office may occupy it.

Destroying the Central Bell

The characters may destroy the central bell now if it remains intact. Before they do, state the likely loss again: central comparison among succession records, reconstructed links among historical events, some route-wide coordination, and the Keeper's combined voice. Written records, local bells, living knowledge, and surviving custodial archives remain.

Destruction does not decide ownership of local bells, release every active succession automatically, erase historical agreements, or establish new current procedures. The settlement must still answer the three questions.

Correcting Flawless Procession Consequences

Resolve every bound successor, false attribution, filled empty place, lost ending, or provisional bearer through the three settlement questions. Ask the affected person's present choice, correct the record, and place necessary work with current people or procedure. Record safe postponement as POSTPONED BY CURRENT CHOICE. A released bearer keeps only knowledge and benefits knowingly accepted. Personal bells remain under each player character's control.

The Settlement Object

Choose one physical object to carry the settlement during enactment in Scene 20. Options include the Procession Principles plate, the Unclaimed Bell, a new civic ledger, a recast plate from the central bell, the Central Lantern under circus custody, a Silent House stand, or another object established during play.

The object may have a custodian without a bearer. Physical custody creates responsibility for safekeeping, not magical succession, interpretive authority, or permanent office.

If the Unclaimed Bell is used, name its temporary purpose and ending. If the Central Lantern is used, the circus retains ownership and may withdraw it after enactment. If the central bell is used, the settlement must specify who may authorise its future operation.

Choosing the Enactment

Scene 20 requires three stations: Record, Bearer, and Open. Decide who demonstrates each function and what evidence or action they use.

The Record Station shows what remains preserved and how earlier and current versions are distinguished.

The Bearer Station shows who decides present use and how knowledge or work is accepted without compulsory identity or office.

The Open Station shows how a role, agreement, road, or object changes, ends, transfers, or remains deliberately incomplete.

A player character should lead or directly enable at least one station. Supporting characters may perform actions arising from player plans.

Living Authorisation

Before enactment, ask each directly affected living person whether the settlement accurately records their current choice. A yes, no, revision, abstention, or absence is valid. Do not treat silence as consent.

The party may enact Bellweather-wide procedures even when one person abstains, but it cannot rewrite that person's private custody, authorship, personal bell, or succession status without standing to do so.

Final Questions

READ ALOUD

If the central bell remains intact, its narrow plate writes three lines:

WHAT WILL YOU ALLOW BELLWEATHER TO REMEMBER?

WHAT WILL YOU NOT ALLOW MEMORY TO DECIDE?

WHAT MAY REMAIN WITHOUT AN ANSWER?

Invite each player character to answer one line or allow the group to answer collectively. These answers guide tone and imagery in Scene 20 but do not create hidden additional rules.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

The settlement is read once in ordinary voices.

No bell confirms it.

Current custodians lift the records, objects, and tools required for enactment.

One route leads toward the civic ledgers. One leads toward the people and bells whose present use must be demonstrated. One remains open toward the Silent House and the roads beyond Bellweather.

Tovin, or the current recorder chosen by the party, asks one final question:

"Is this the settlement you intend to enact?"

When the players answer, proceed directly to Scene 20. Carry forward the settlement path, the three answers, the settlement object and custodian, station leaders, unresolved dissent, the central bell's condition, and every lasting consequence still requiring correction.

Scene 20: What Bellweather Keeps

The settlement becomes real only when Bellweather demonstrates that it can operate under the new terms. The party leads three public stations: Record, Bearer, and Open. Each station answers one settlement question through action rather than declaration alone.

Run the stations in any order. The party may divide among them, move together, or place supporting characters at one station while the player characters lead another. The enactment is not a test designed to trick the party into failure. It is a practical proof that identifies anything the settlement forgot to address.

Preparing the Three Stations

READ ALOUD

Three routes leave the settlement circle.

The first leads to open ledgers, archived plates, completed scores, and the Procession Principles.

The second leads to living workers, current custodians, personal bells, and tools still in use.

The third leads toward the Silent House, the Open Roads, and one deliberately empty stand.

The settlement object rests at the centre under the custody chosen by the party.

No station waits for the central bell to begin.

At every station, ask one player character what must be visibly proved. Supporting participants then arrange the objects, records, or work according to that answer.

The Record Station

The Record Station answers what remains preserved. Display at least three contrasts: old method and current variation; predecessor and creator; precedent and judgment; completed succession and history; private record and public summary; or earlier route and current overlay.

State what Bellweather keeps. The affected person confirms the current line or permits certified evidence. Use DC 12 Intelligence only for genuine conflict; failure preserves it openly for review. Success requires accessible history, present authority, and named uncertainty.

The Bearer Station

The Bearer Station answers who decides present use. Place one preserved source beside a clean plate naming only the task. The participant states what they accept, refuse, and when permission ends, then uses it for one ordinary task. Added title or obligation is removed; ambiguity returns to the participant. Success preserves value, present control, and an ending without succession.

The Open Station

The Open Station answers how work changes, ends, transfers, or remains incomplete. Use one real duty, completed succession, empty office, open road, unfinished object, private record, or changed bell status. The affected person states the state; the custodian performs the act; necessary work receives a safe handoff. Answer vacancy chimes with the exit signal, Unclaimed Bell, ending clause, or witnessed silence.

The Settlement Object

After all three stations succeed, carry their results back to the settlement object. The object receives one mark for preservation, one for present use, and one for change or deliberate incompleteness.

If the object is a ledger or plate, enter the three marks as words or an open-circle symbol. If it is a bell, ring it once for each station only if that purpose was authorised. If it is the Central Lantern, place three current tokens beneath it without altering or transferring circus ownership.

A settlement object may have a custodian without a bearer. The lower-square attendants may hold physical custody during enactment. Custody does not create succession, magical inheritance, interpretive authority, or a permanent office.

If the Central Bell Remains Intact

READ ALOUD

The central bell turns within its frame.

Its narrow settlement plate faces the three stations in turn.

The Keeper asks:

“RECORD PRESERVED?”

“PRESENT USE AUTHORISED?”

“ENDING OR OPEN STATE RECOGNISED?”

The party answers from the enacted evidence. The Keeper may identify a missing practical detail, but it cannot demand a different settlement path. Once the three demonstrations stand, the plate records the settlement exactly as enacted.

The party then applies the chosen path: Living Archive, Distributed Bells, Silent Keeper, Recast Centre, Open Circle, or hybrid. State what functions the central bell retains, what powers end, who may authorise future use, and where review occurs.

Living Archive Enactment

Apply the chosen path from Scene 19. For a Living Archive, remove appointment, confirmation, merger, and extension powers while keeping authorised comparison. For Distributed Bells, disconnect central command and assign current local custody and purpose. For a Silent Keeper, secure speech and clapper functions under living controls. For a Recast Centre, record likely loss and material destination before separation. For an Open Circle, create the permanent empty station and deny the Keeper universal authority.

If the Central Bell Was Destroyed

Do not use read-aloud describing the central bell speaking, rotating, writing, or confirming the stations. The Record Break and much of the Procession Break already occurred through destruction. Scene 20 establishes living procedures for surviving records and local bells.

Tovin or another current recorder establishes the Record Station through the new civic ledger. The affected successor or current work group establishes the Bearer Station through their bell, tool, score, or current plate. Elsin establishes the Open Station through a blank stand from the Silent House.

The party’s settlement object carries the open-circle mark. If the central bell itself was intended as the settlement object, choose another from the options already established. The replacement creates no new office.

Surviving local bells respond only according to whatever magic remains. No central voice tests the demonstrations. Current witnesses state whether each station succeeded and record dissent or uncertainty openly.

READ ALOUD

Tovin reads the settlement in the party’s words.

Around the square, individual bells answer separately.

No central voice combines them.

Bellweather’s living witnesses state:

“Settlement enacted.”

Correcting Lasting Consequences

Apply the Scene 19 correction to every remaining assignment or provisional bearer through the appropriate station. Enact the other two stations even if one question remains unresolved; make that exact question the first living review rather than restoring an inherited answer.

Partial Enactment

If one station cannot be completed, enact the other two. Bellweather changes in those areas while the unresolved station becomes the first required review under the new settlement.

Record the exact unresolved question and assign a living process, not a default inherited answer. Partial enactment still ends the adventure’s immediate danger.

Dissent and Minority Records

Attach material dissent to the settlement object or current ledger. The dissenter may state the expected harm, evidence, and requested future review. The dissent does not secretly operate as a second settlement.

If a later review changes the arrangement, that future decision must again answer preservation, present use, and change or ending.

The Keeper’s New Function

If the Keeper remains in any form, state its new function in one or two sentences. Examples include:

- Preserve and compare authorised records; never appoint a bearer.
- Disclose historical links and likely knowledge loss; never issue present judgments.
- Respond only when a living custodian authorises consultation.
- Maintain route history; current signals govern current movement.
- Record endings and open states as valid current outcomes.

Avoid long ceremonial language. The function must be operational enough for a future DM to understand what the Keeper can and cannot do.

The Thirteenth Plate

If any part of the central bell remains, its thirteenth plate turns outward. If the bell was destroyed, use the settlement object instead.

READ ALOUD

The plate does not bear a name.

It bears an open circle.

Beneath it appears the settlement’s shortest current rule:

MEMORY MAY REMAIN.

CHOICE REMAINS LIVING.

If the players established different concise language, use theirs instead. Do not replace their wording with this version merely for style.

The Square After Enactment

READ ALOUD

The settlement object remains under the custody chosen by the party.

The three stations remain visible long enough for Bellweather’s residents to examine what changed.

Earlier records have not vanished. Current records no longer hide beneath them. Tools rest with current workers or in the custody chosen for them. Open roads remain open. Empty stands remain empty.

No voice announces that Bellweather is complete.

Allow each player character to inspect one outcome that matters to them: a personal bell, revised record, open road, current craft, released role, private boundary, or intentionally empty place. Their observation may shape the epilogue but requires no check.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

The current recorder closes the enactment ledger without sealing it against future entries.

Alden removes the Speaker of Names plate from his collar and places it beside the record rather than beneath his name.

“Bellweather has a settlement,” he says.

“Tomorrow it will still have choices.”

From the circus field comes the ordinary sound of supper being organised by people who did not wait for a bell to assign the work.

Proceed to Scene 21. The characters and circus have time to recover, tend injuries, repair equipment, and complete a Long Rest after the evening’s debrief.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

Final settlement path and concise operational rule Central bell intact, silenced, distributed, recast, or destroyed Settlement object and physical custodian Any unresolved first-review question Material dissent preserved for review Status of lasting consequences and provisional bearers General rule for Bellweather bells and records

Scene 21: Bellweather After the Bells

The settlement is enacted. The immediate danger has ended. Scene 21 returns the focus to ordinary life, the Lantern Circus, and the practical consequences of what the party changed. Do not turn the evening into another formal hearing. Let people eat, repair things, check animals, speak privately, and decide what the circus carries forward.

Returning to the Circus Field

READ ALOUD

The road back to the circus field is no longer part of a ceremony.

Route cords have been lowered. Platforms stand with brakes set. Musicians carry their own instruments. Workers move tools because the day’s work requires it, not because a bell has called them into place.

At the field, Nell’s supper fire burns beneath an iron pot large enough to serve both the company and the Bellweather workers still helping with repairs.

Wick has stationed himself beside the food as though appointed to a vital office. No plate confirms the position.

The Central Lantern hangs where the circus placed it.

The company’s first empty place remains as the players last chose to keep it.

Allow the characters to enter in whatever condition the climax left them. Nell and Bellweather’s healers provide ordinary treatment. Bellweather supplies repair materials and skilled labour. Nothing in this scene requires an ability check unless the players attempt something genuinely uncertain beyond the established aftermath.

Checking the Circus

Ask the players what each character checks first. Suitable concerns include people, animals, wagons, the Central Lantern, personal bells, the first empty place, damaged equipment, or a supporting character affected during the Procession.

Use the established result rather than adding surprise damage. If an area was protected successfully, it remains safe. If a consequence survived into the settlement, show the corrected record or remaining practical repair. Do not reactivate a resolved threat merely to extend the scene.

The First Empty Place

Return explicitly to the decision made in Scene 1. Ask whether the circus keeps the place exactly as before, changes its treatment after Bellweather, or postpones the question.

The place may remain empty while work continues elsewhere. A transferred duty may now have a current name and ending. A retired role may remain remembered without being reopened. An unresolved place may still be unresolved. Nothing about resolving Bellweather requires the circus to fill or close it.

READ ALOUD

If the first bell remains with the circus, it gives one quiet note.

The empty place appears exactly as the company now keeps it.

No second bell answers from the road.

If the bell was destroyed after the circus stated its arrangement, no replacement appears. If it was left elsewhere, the absence remains valid without a magical witness.

The Circus Debrief

Gather the player characters beneath the Central Lantern or at another company meeting place. Silas asks three practical questions:

READ ALOUD

What did the circus do well?

What must the company change before the next difficult road?

What belongs to Bellweather and must not quietly become the circus’s permanent work?

Allow direct player answers. Circus NPCs contribute only where useful. Silas focuses on authority and coordination. Nell focuses on care, meals, and making ordinary life continue. Bram focuses on tools, wagons, and repair. Corren focuses on animals and handlers. Mira focuses on costumes, objects, and consent. Old Fen focuses on music that remains changeable.

Pippa may comment on the credited musical variation if the players invite her or the matter directly affects the music wagon. She does not become the cause or centre of the module’s aftermath.

Circus Development

The circus gains one People development, one Practical development, and one Tradition development. The players choose one from each category or create another comparable result established through play. These are campaign developments, not Bastion turns or separate subsystems.

People Development

Choose one People development: Shared Signals distributes emergency communication; Current Custodians names custodians, backups, and limits; Open Apprenticeship teaches one skill to several people; Rest and Relief creates rotations and a visible end to shifts.

Choose one Practical development: Rapid-Release Rigging improves one rig; Distributed Route Kit equips front, middle, and rear wagons; Protected Empty Stand holds unclaimed, unfinished, refused, or temporary objects; Living Ledger separates owner, custodian, user, creator, teacher, duty, and ending.

Choose one Tradition development: Open Chair keeps a deliberate open place; Current Credits separates creators from influence; Closing Signal gives performances a living ending; Unwritten Measure leaves one phrase open to variation, omission, or silence.

Recording Developments

Record only the chosen development in each category and one sentence explaining what it means in practice. Do not create ongoing resource tracks, construction costs, or management turns unless the campaign later needs them.

Payment

Bellweather pays the contracted 200 GP final amount in addition to the 50 GP advance. This payment remains due if the party cancelled or shortened the Procession for a documented safety reason after beginning the work.

If the party refused the original contract but completed equivalent work, Alden and Tovin offer the same total compensation: 250 GP, reduced only by any advance the party already accepted. The players may refuse, redirect, or divide payment as they choose.

Bellweather also repairs ordinary damage to circus property caused by the rehearsal or Procession, provides food and fodder used during the stay, and returns unused circus materials.

Civic Gift

Bellweather offers one civic gift chosen by the party. The gift is not assigned through a bell and carries no succession.

Bronze Route Kit: A fitted case containing durable route plates, signal tags, chalk holders, and locking clips. It is worth 75 GP as crafted equipment but is more useful as a travelling planning kit.

Foundry Credit: Iva records 150 GP of future repair, casting, or metalwork for the Lantern Circus, redeemable when the company returns or through a recognised Bellweather trader.

Open-Road Charter: A signed civic document guaranteeing the Lantern Circus ordinary passage, camping negotiation, and trade access in Bellweather without Procession participation or bell examination.

Silent House Case: A padded, lockable case designed for one bell, dangerous memory-object, private record, or unresolved item. Its plate can display CURRENT CUSTODY WITHOUT SUCCESSION.

Bellweather Stores: Two wagons' worth of high-quality food, fodder, canvas, lamp oil, rope, ordinary metal fittings, and medical supplies, worth 100 GP if sold rather than used.

Specialist Reward

Bellweather also offers one permanent specialist reward. Choose one item tied to a completed Succession Record or the final settlement.

Resonant Hammer

Choose one uncommon specialist reward.

Resonant Hammer: once per Long Rest, a creature proficient with Smith's Tools has Advantage to inspect, repair, or alter metal. Before damaging a magical bell, the wielder learns which category of preserved function is likely to be lost.

Bell of the Unwritten Name: once per dawn, its custodian names one willing creature within 30 feet acting under a temporary role; until the custodian's next turn, that creature has Advantage on one saving throw against extending, renaming, or making the role permanent. Custody creates no succession.

Seal of Present Judgment: once per Long Rest, mark a current written decision after naming its responsible person or group. For 24 hours, magical records cannot falsely attribute it. The seal grants no authority the signer does not possess.

The Open Measure: once per Long Rest, preserve a performed or changed phrase for 1 hour under the living creator's chosen name. Magical repetition cannot erase, merge, or falsely reattribute that version; other creators may still make different versions.

Released Materials

If the central bell was recast or dismantled, Bellweather may offer a lawful share of released bronze after civic and custodial needs are met. The party may take enough material for one later item or memorial project. This is ordinary material custody, not a fragment of the Keeper unless the settlement explicitly preserved such a function.

If the bell remained intact or was destroyed without safe recovery, omit this option.

Bells That May Travel

Review every bell connected to the circus: personal bells, the first empty-place bell, the Unclaimed Bell, and any civic or memorial bell whose custodian proposed travel.

A Bellweather memorial bell travels only with lawful current custody and a stated purpose. Travel does not appoint the circus as bearer, successor, or permanent archive. The party may refuse any offered bell.

For each travelling bell, record inscription, physical custodian, magical bearer if different, purpose, ending or review method, and whether Bellweather retains a copy of the current record.

Do not send Lor's, Serah's, Orun's, or Halwen's bell with the party by default. Their current custodians decide. The Unstruck Bell remains Iva's unless she knowingly transfers it.

NPC Futures

Resolve only NPCs the players ask about. Iva follows her foundry choice; Neve's role does not revert to sole command; Tovin exercises living responsibility while Halwen remains precedent; Caldris may visit, teach, perform, correspond, or remain home; Elsin expands the Silent House categories; Alden remains Speaker of Names only under living procedure.

A Concern That Remains

Ask the players to name one concern Bellweather has not completely solved. Suitable concerns include future audits, loss of rare knowledge, disputes over custody, training enough current responders, pressure to restore ceremonial grandeur, or whether the Keeper's remaining function will gradually expand.

Record the concern as an open campaign thread or future review item, not a hidden claim that the settlement secretly failed.

The Black Eagle's Token

At some point during the evening, the Black Eagle appears near the Central Lantern, settlement object, or first empty place. It carries a small black feather wrapped in a narrow bronze ring.

READ ALOUD

The Eagle places the ring where the player characters can see it.

The bronze is not a bell. It has no clapper, plate, or inscription.

If touched, it gives no voice and no vision.

The Eagle looks toward the open road beyond Bellweather, then back toward the circus.

The ring has no defined magical property in this module. It may serve as a campaign token, future clue, or ordinary keepsake. Do not make a circus NPC the object's secret chosen bearer.

The Evening Gathering

READ ALOUD

Bellweather's residents and the Lantern Circus share the field without forming a Procession.

People sit where space remains. Some bring benches. Others stand beside wagons, tools, animals, or open roads. Music begins without announcing an official composer. Supper passes from hand to hand without creating a permanent steward.

The settlement is discussed, questioned, praised, and criticised in ordinary voices.

No bell gathers the answers into one correct account.

Above the field, the Central Lantern burns under circus custody.

Allow short conversations the players request. Do not require every named NPC to deliver a farewell or summary. End the gathering when the players decide their characters rest, continue talking privately, or prepare for departure.

Scene Exit

SCENE EXIT

Long after the supper fire burns low, one ordinary route bell sounds somewhere in Bellweather.

A current worker answers it.

No second bell repeats the instruction.

The work continues.

At the circus field, the wagons remain unhitched until morning.

The characters complete a Long Rest. Proceed to Scene 22.

Carry Forward

CARRY FORWARD

First empty place and present treatment People, Practical, and Tradition developments Payment and chosen civic gift Permanent specialist reward Travelling bells and custody terms One unresolved Bellweather concern Black Eagle's bronze-ring token, if taken

Scene 22: The Bell Beyond Bellweather

The Lantern Circus leaves Bellweather under its own direction. This scene closes the module, records what travels with the company, and points toward the next road without making any circus NPC the hidden source, target, or chosen centre of the new mystery.

Breaking Camp

READ ALOUD

Morning comes without a Procession bell.

The first sounds are canvas folding, harness buckles closing, wagon doors being checked, and

Nell calling for somebody to move a crate that has been left directly in the path of breakfast.

Bellweather's roads remain open. Residents arrive in small groups rather than one formal delegation. Some bring repaired fittings, wrapped food, letters, tools, or copies of current records. Others come only to watch the circus prepare to leave.

The Central Lantern is lowered when the circus chooses.

Ask the players who oversees departure and what each character does before the wagons move. Use the company developments selected in Scene 21. Shared Signals may coordinate the line; the Distributed Route Kit may place current instructions at several wagons; a Closing Signal may end the camp period; an Open Chair or first empty place may receive its chosen treatment.

What Leaves Bellweather

Review payment, gifts, developments, travelling bells, personal-bell choices, the Black Eagle token, the first empty place, and chosen relationships. Anything not explicitly transferred remains with its lawful custodian.

Personal Bells

Each player character makes one final Module II decision about their personal bell. The character may carry it under accepted or revised terms, store it with a named custodian, leave it in Bellweather, return it to ordinary bronze if the established magic allows, destroy it after disclosed loss, or postpone the decision.

Record only the current disposition, benefit if retained, boundary or expectation, and physical custodian. A bell kept by the character does not force future stories to focus upon it. It becomes one available part of the character's history and equipment.

The Unclaimed Bell

End any Procession-only purpose unless knowingly renewed or changed. The Unclaimed Bell may remain blank or carry one specific travelling use; it has no predecessor, office, expected bearer, or automatic successor.

The First Empty Place

Show the first empty place once more during departure. Do not reinterpret it. Use the current treatment the players chose in Scene 21.

READ ALOUD

The wagons close around the place as the company prepares to move.

Work connected to it remains with the people who accepted that work. Memory remains where the circus chose to keep it.

The road does not fill the place for them.

Farewells Chosen by the Players

Ask which Bellweather residents the characters seek before leaving. Run only those farewells. An NPC who is not sought may still send a brief practical message or gift when established by the fiction, but avoid a parade of compulsory speeches.

Iva may provide current repair notes, foundry credit, or an invitation to hear the Unstruck Bell again. Neve may demonstrate that another responder is handling the morning signals. Tovin may deliver certified copies under current signatures. Caldris may appear, send a note, or remain at home according to their choice. Elsin may provide a Silent House plate or sealed case. Alden may thank the party without claiming Bellweather's settlement as his achievement.

A Bellweather Traveller

If the players formed a strong relationship with a Bellweather NPC and explicitly invite that person to travel, the NPC may join only if their current responsibilities are safely covered and they independently choose to go. The invitation does not make the NPC a permanent party member or continuing campaign centre.

Suitable short-term travellers include a route worker learning travelling logistics, a musician joining for one road, a foundry apprentice accompanying a delivery, or a witness carrying records to another settlement. Do not send Neve, Caldris, Iva, Tovin, or another major successor by default.

Leaving the Field

READ ALOUD

The first wagon rolls toward the bridge.

No bell instructs it to move.

The second follows when the circus's own signal is given. Animals settle into the pace chosen by their handlers. Route cards, if the company adopted them, pass current information from wagon to wagon.

Behind the caravan, Bellweather's residents remain scattered across the field and road. Some wave. Some return to work before the last wagon leaves.

The circus boundary stakes come up.

The field becomes an ordinary field again.

If the Central Lantern was used as the settlement object, it leaves with the circus. Bellweather retains the enacted record, not ownership of the Lantern or authority over its use.

The Valley Rim

READ ALOUD

The road climbs toward the valley rim.

Bellweather spreads below: workshops, route districts, gardens, and open roads, the Silent House, and the central frame in whatever form the settlement left it.

Individual bells sound across the village.

One marks a delivery. Another calls workers to a current repair. A third signals that an upper lane is clear.

The notes do not combine into one command.

They do not need to.

Allow the players one final look back or one brief action. A character may ring a personal bell, keep it silent, cover it, hand it to its custodian, or do nothing.

The Bell Ahead

Once Bellweather disappears behind the ridge, the road passes through ordinary country for several hours. Near midday, use the following passage.

READ ALOUD

The road ahead crosses open upland beneath a broad pale sky. Grass bends in the wind. The

caravan’s wheels keep their own uneven rhythm.

Then a bell sounds.

It comes from far beyond the next rise.

The note is larger than a handbell and smaller than Bellweather’s central bell. It rings once.

No second note answers.

The Black Eagle leaves its distant perch and flies toward the sound.

The road remains open in every direction.

The bell is not resolved in this module. Do not identify its owner, purpose, settlement, or danger. It is a forward signal for the campaign, not proof that Bellweather’s Keeper survived elsewhere.

The players decide whether the circus follows the sound, records it for later, sends a scout, continues along another road, or stops to discuss the choice. Their decision becomes the opening direction for the next module or an intervening journey.

Advancement

When the Lantern Circus leaves Bellweather and the players decide how to respond to the distant bell, the characters advance to 5th level.

Closing Read-Aloud

READ ALOUD

Behind you lies a village learning that memory can remain without becoming command.

Ahead lies a bell that has asked nothing yet.

Around you, the Lantern Circus moves beneath its own signals, carrying what its people chose, leaving what they did not, and keeping room for answers that have not been given.

The next road belongs to the living.

Final Campaign Record

Record only the continuing facts needed by later modules.

- Bellweather’s settlement path and Keeper function
- Central bell intact, silenced, distributed, recast, or destroyed
- One unresolved Bellweather concern or required review
- First empty place and current treatment
- People development
- Practical development
- Tradition development
- Permanent specialist reward and civic gift
- Each travelling bell: inscription, physical custodian, magical bearer if different, purpose, and ending or review method
- Each player character’s personal-bell disposition and retained benefit or boundary
- Continuing relationships the players chose to maintain
- Black Eagle bronze-ring token, if taken
- Decision concerning the distant bell

Do not record private character material the player did not authorise. Do not carry temporary Procession positions, used preparations, Repetition, Living Acts, or resolved Echo claims into later modules.

End of Module II

READ ALOUD

THE CIRCLE REMAINS OPEN.

Campaign Record

Use these forms after Scene 22. Record only facts that continue into later modules and only player-authorised private character information.

Bellweather Settlement Record

Complete after Scene 20. Use concise operational language rather than a narrative recap.

Continuing fact	Current campaign record
Settlement path and operational rule	
Central bell: intact, silenced, distributed, recast, or destroyed	
Settlement object and physical custodian	
Unresolved first-review question	
Material dissent preserved for review	
Lasting consequences and provisional bearers	
Bellweather’s rule for bells and records	

Lantern Circus Development Record

Complete after Scene 21. Each development must arise from an event the table can name. Do not add an automatic numerical benefit unless the adventure explicitly grants one.

Continuing fact	Current campaign record
People development	
Practical development	
Tradition development	
Permanent specialist reward	
Civic gift	
Continuing Bellweather relationship	

Travelling Bell Record

Complete one record for each bell that leaves Bellweather. Distinguish possession from magical relationship.

Continuing fact	Current campaign record
Inscription or identifying plate	
Physical custodian	
Magical bearer, if different	
Current purpose	
Accepted boundary or expectation	
Ending, review, transfer, or refusal method	

Personal Bell Record

Complete one record for each player character. Include only the current decision and information the player authorised for campaign use.

Continuing fact	Current campaign record
Player character	
Current disposition	
Retained benefit, if any	
Expected obligation disclosed by Bellweather	
Accepted boundary, revision, or refusal	
Physical custodian, if different	

Continuing Module II Record

Use at the end of Scene 22. This page identifies the facts another module may safely assume.

Continuing fact	Current campaign record
First empty place and current treatment	
Decision concerning the distant bell	

Continuing fact	Current campaign record
Black Eagle bronze-ring token, if taken	
Bellweather concern requiring later review	
Continuing NPC or household relationship	
Other player-authored continuing fact	

Original Creatures and Animated Objects

The following stat blocks are reconciled with Scenes 7, 17, and 18. Encounter behaviour stated in those scenes remains part of each creature or object's operation. A dash indicates a value the manuscript does not establish; no statistic has been invented for visual completeness.

Searching Harness

Animated Object, Unaligned

Armor Class	Hit Points	Speed	Challenge	Initiative	Proficiency
13	12	—	—	—	—

Damage Immunities. Poison, Psychic.

Condition Immunities. Charmed, Frightened, Prone.

Actions

Searching Pull. Attack Roll: +4. Hit: the target is Grappled; escape DC 12. At the start of each turn, the harness pulls the grappled target 10 feet toward the old ascent position.

Open the Harness. An adjacent creature can take an action and succeed on a DC 10 Dexterity check to open the harness. Relevant rigging or leatherwork succeeds automatically.

Ceremonial Saddle

Animated Object, Unaligned

Armor Class	Hit Points	Speed	Challenge	Initiative	Proficiency
12	14	—	—	—	—

Damage Immunities. Poison, Psychic.

Condition Immunities. Charmed, Frightened.

Actions

Seek a Mount. At Initiative count 10, the saddle moves 20 feet toward a suitable animal.

Stop the Saddle. An adjacent handler can take a Reaction and succeed on a DC 12 Strength or Dexterity check to stop it.

Attached Route. Once attached, the animal follows Beryn's route until calmed with a DC 12 Animal Handling check, restrained, redirected, or the saddle is removed or destroyed.

Borrowed Gesture

Animated Object, Unaligned

Armor Class	Hit Points	Speed	Challenge	Initiative	Proficiency
13	16	30 ft.	—	—	—

Damage Immunities. Poison, Psychic.

Condition Immunities. Charmed, Frightened, Prone.

Timing Bell. The attached timing bell has Armor Class 16 and 30 Hit Points. Attached tools deal 5 damage at Initiative count 10.

Actions

Tool Strike. Attack Roll: +4. Hit: 5 Bludgeoning damage, or 5 damage to an unattended object.

Scattered Tools. At 0 Hit Points, the tools scatter.

Namebearer

Animated Object, Unaligned

Armor Class	Hit Points	Speed	Challenge	Initiative	Proficiency
12	14	30 ft.	—	—	—

Damage Immunities. Poison, Psychic.

Condition Immunities. Charmed, Frightened, Grappled, Prone.

Unanswered Role. At 0 Hit Points, the garment collapses, but another may form until the role receives a current answer.

Actions

Compulsory Position. Attack Roll: +4. Hit: 4 Psychic damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 11 Wisdom saving throw or move 10 feet toward the assigned position.

Echo

Reconstructed Pattern, Unaligned

Armor Class	Hit Points	Speed	Challenge	Initiative	Proficiency
13	18	30 ft.	—	—	—

Damage Immunities. Poison, Psychic.

Condition Immunities. Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Grappled, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned, Prone, Restrained.

Incorporeal Movement. The Echo can move through creatures and objects as Difficult Terrain. It takes 5 Force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Dispersal and Return. At 0 Hit Points, the Echo disperses until the beginning of the next round. It reforms while the underlying claim remains unanswered.

Living Answer. The Echo ends permanently for this Procession when a living person visibly completes, revises, refuses, divides, or safely ends the pattern it represents.

Actions

Preserved Gesture. Melee Attack Roll: +5, reach 5 feet. Hit: 6 Force damage.

Compulsory Position. Instead of dealing damage, the Echo forces the target to make a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the target moves up to 10 feet toward the preserved position associated with the Echo.

Unfinished Chorus

Large Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class	Hit Points	Speed	Challenge	Initiative	Proficiency
14	45*	0 ft.	2	+2 (12)	+2
STR	**DEX**	**CON**	**INT**	**WIS**	**CHA**
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Hit Point Adjustment. Use 35 Hit Points for three player characters and 55 Hit Points for six or more player characters.

Saving Throws. Wis +4, Cha +5.

Damage Resistances. Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks.

Damage Immunities. Poison, Psychic.

Condition Immunities. Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Grappled, Poisoned, Prone, Restrained, Unconscious.

Senses. Blindsight throughout the active Procession; Passive Perception 12.

Languages. The Chorus speaks through Bellweather’s active bells.

Distributed Form. The Chorus occupies the Procession network rather than one physical space. A creature can target the Chorus from anywhere on the active route where an Echo, civic bell, memorial bell, or animated Procession object is present. Area effects damage the Chorus only once per use.

Fed by Repetition. At the start of its turn, the Chorus gains 5 Temporary Hit Points if Repetition is 4 or higher. The Chorus gains none in a round after a Living Act is completed.

Disrupted by Living Acts. Whenever a Living Act is completed, the Chorus takes 8 Force damage and cannot use Reprise before the end of its next turn. This damage ignores Resistance and Immunity.

Defeating the Chorus. At 0 Hit Points, the Chorus disperses but reforms with 15 Hit Points at the start of the next round unless the party has completed at least three Living Acts. Five Living Acts and all three secured Echo objectives end the scene even if the Chorus has remaining Hit Points.

Actions

Overlapping Command. At Initiative count 10, choose up to three creatures that can hear an active bell. Each target makes a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the target takes 5 Psychic damage and moves up to 10 feet toward a preserved position, assigned object, or active Echo. On a success, the target takes half damage and does not move.

Reprise. The Chorus repeats the most recent unresolved Echo activation without increasing Repetition. The Chorus cannot use Reprise in consecutive rounds or after being disrupted by a Living Act.

Fill the Silence. When a living participant refuses, ends, or leaves a role without making the practical work or deliberate emptiness visible, the Chorus creates one Namebearer adjacent to that role. The Namebearer disappears when the role receives a valid current answer.

Central Bell

Large Fixed Object

Armor Class	Hit Points	Speed	Challenge	Initiative	Proficiency
17	60	0 ft.	—	—	—

Damage Immunities. Poison, Psychic.

Damage Resistances. Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks.

Disclosed Loss. Before a deliberate destructive strike, identify the likely loss: central coordination among Bellweather’s civic bells, several reconstructed links among historical records, and the Keeper’s ability to compare succession patterns. Local memorial bells and written records remain. Destruction does not injure the dead or automatically release every bearer.

Special Rules

Interrupt Activation. After the bell takes 15 or more damage in one round, its next Initiative count 20 activation is interrupted.

Damaged Threshold. At 30 Hit Points, one unsecured Echo objective loses its next activation.

Cracked Bell. At 0 Hit Points, the bell cracks and the Keeper’s combined voice ends. Proceed to Scene 19 using the destroyed-central-bell branch.

Bellweather Maps

All four maps use one authoritative Bellweather geography. The Procession map is an overlay of the identical village base map. The Circus Field and Lower Square maps are enlarged extracts from that same base rather than separately generated locations.



Map 1. Bellweather Village Map.

Use for general navigation and district relationships across Bellweather’s broad valley floor.

Module II Circus Field



Map 2. Lantern Circus field at Bellweather.

The enlarged field sits on the southwest edge of the village map. Numbered locations are defined directly in the map legend; no unexplained symbols are used.

Lower Square and Central Bell



Map 3. Lower Square and the central bell.

The central bell label includes its canonical five-foot dimension. The map also repeats the complete bell scale to prevent visual ambiguity during play.

Procession Route over Bellweather Base Map



Map 4. Procession route over the Bellweather village base map.

The red route is drawn over the identical village geography used in Map 1. The numbered stages are named on the map, avoiding blank keys or unexplained arrows.